SUNDAY
October 4, 2026

CHENNAI
CITY EDITION
32 Pages ₹ 10.00

THE HINDU ON SUNDAY

INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

www.thehindu.com
Vol. 149 • No. 40
Regd. TN/ARD/68/2012-2014
RNI No. 1019/1957

To subscribe, give a missed call at 9828331787 or scan QR code

Printed at » Chennai » Coimbatore » Bengaluru » Hyderabad » Madurai » Noida » Visakhapatnam » Thiruvananthapuram » Kochi » Vijayawada » Mangaluru » Tiruchirapalli » Kolkata » Hubballi » Mohali » Malappuram » Mumbai » Lucknow » Cuttack » Patna

FIVE-STAR SHOW

Archer Kumkum leads gold rush

The men's cricket and hockey teams, golfer Pranavi, and wrestler Aman swell India's yellow metal tally

SPORT » PAGE 22

Crisis in Keralam BJP over councillor's 'exit'

SOUTH » PAGE 13

'Attacker on flydubai was flagged for extremism'

WORLD » PAGE 21

Iraq's militias within the military

PROFILES » PAGE 20

Protests persist as Rahul calls for joint 'resistance'

Around 150 detained in Delhi as political leaders, activists, youth groups continue protests seeking removal of CEC Kumar; Kharge demands dissolution of Lok Sabha, Assemblies over 'illegal' polls

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Rising voices: Supreme Court advocates Prashant Bhushan and Kapil Sibal, activist Yogendra Yadav, and AISA leader Neha Bora take part in the protest near Jantar Mantar on Saturday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

As Opposition leaders, civil society activists, and youth organisations on Saturday continued their protests seeking the removal of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and suspension of the special intensive revision of electoral rolls, the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, launched the 'Satyagraha' digital platform to map resistance movements across the country.

In a video posted on his social media handle, Mr. Gandhi said truth was being suppressed and that, as the Leader of the Opposition, it was his responsibility to help resist this.

Meanwhile, the Delhi Police on Saturday detained around 150 protesters, including All India Students' Association (AISA) leader Neha Bora, activists Yogendra Yadav and Anjali Bharadwaj, and Supreme Court advocate Prashant Bhushan, as they marched towards Jantar Mantar to demand the removal of the CEC.

Independent Rajya Sabha member and senior Supreme Court advocate Kapil Sibal also joined the march but was not detained.

In his post on X announcing the 'Satyagraha' initiative, Mr. Gandhi said people across the country were fighting for their rights and were "too often fighting alone". He listed Gen Z, students, farmers, Adivasis, Dalits, and women among those involved in different struggles. "'Satyagraha' is an initiative to bring these voices together on one map," he said, urging people fighting what they considered injustice to register their movements on the platform.

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh linked the launch of the 'Satyagraha' platform to the protests against Mr. Kumar. Referring to the police action during Friday's demonstrations, he said the "Home Minister's police" had displayed "barbarity" against people peacefully protesting on the path shown by Mahatma Gandhi.

Escalating the face-off with the Narendra Modi government over the sanctity of the electoral process, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge demanded the dissolution of the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies, saying that "all the elections were illegal". He also said that Prime Minister Modi, Union Home Minister Amit Shah, and Chief Ministers of States were "illegal" occupants of their posts.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 14
RELATED REPORTS ON » PAGE 14

Plan to shuffle Mumbai flight operations irks airlines

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

A dispute is brewing between the Adani group-run Mumbai International Airport Ltd (MIAL) and airlines over a proposed operational reshuffle from October 26 for a phased redevelopment project.

The plan involves moving domestic traffic from Terminal 1 to Terminal 2, while shifting some international services to the more distant Navi Mumbai International Airport.

While MIAL has said that several airlines failed to submit transition plans as requested, the International Air Transport Association has opposed what it described as a forced relocation of airlines, saying any transfer should be voluntary and backed by airline consultation.

FULL REPORT ON » PAGE 17

Boiler blast at Sri City pharma unit kills five

Shock wave: Officials inspect the site of the explosion in Sri City, Andhra Pradesh, on Saturday. K.V. POORNACHANDRA KUMAR

N.S. Chowdary
TIRUPATI

Five workers were killed and one was severely injured in a boiler explosion at a pharmaceutical manufacturing unit in the Sri City Special Economic Zone (SEZ) in Tirupati district of Andhra Pradesh on Saturday. The cause of the accident is not known yet. The explosion occurred at a unit of Tablets India Limited, which caters to exports.

The deceased were identified as Gourab Roy (35) of West Bengal; Chinna Mastan (48) of Cheviri in Andhra Pradesh; Ramesh (52) of Madharapakkam in Tamil Nadu; Mohan (28), the boiler operator and a native of Naidukuppam in Tamil Nadu; and Vasu (32) of Tada in Andhra Pradesh. While Vasu died during treatment at a hospital in Chennai, the other four died on the spot.

Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu directed the district administration to provide all support to the victims and expedite relief operations.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 14

NEARBY

CM slams Stalin for his remarks against candidate

CHENNAI
Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Saturday condemned DMK chief M.K. Stalin for his alleged body-shaming remarks about the TVK's Dharapuram bypoll candidate. » PAGE 10

EPS questions TVK's claim to be corruption-free

CHENNAI
AIADMK chief Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Saturday questioned the TVK's claim of providing a corruption-free regime. » PAGE 10

CLASSIFIEDS » PAGES 11, 12 & 13
MAGAZINE » 8 PAGES
DOWNTOWN » 8 PAGES (TABLOID) (IN SELECT AREAS)

Veeramani booked in yet another POCSO case

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Central Crime Branch (CCB) of the Greater Chennai Police, which is probing the sexual assault cases against Gem Granites founder Veeramani, 84, has registered yet another case against him under the provisions of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act based on a complaint from a woman in Chennai.

This is the fifth case filed against him.

TVK's petition to police

Meanwhile, the legal wing of Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) on Saturday petitioned the Greater Chennai Police and the Special Investigation Team probing the case, seeking an expanded probe into the alleged suppression and cover-up of complaints of sexual assault on minor girls, including the roles of former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin, former Law Minister S. Regupathy, and senior police officers.

The petition seeks to ascertain whether the complaint reached Mr. Stalin, who held the Home portfolio, and whether any directions were issued.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 10

ADVERTISEMENT

A Tamil Voice at the United Nations

GLOBAL PERSPECTIVE • TAMIL HERITAGE • FUTURE-READY COMMUNITIES

At the Second World Summit on Sustainable Health and Well-Being 2026, Dr. Sathish Kumar Santhanam brought a distinctly Tamil perspective to the global dialogue on resilience, sustainability and human well-being.

Speaking on "From Our Roots to Our Future: Building for Generations," he highlighted how the built environment can shape healthier, safer and more resilient communities for the future.

Mr. Balamurugan, Director, DAC Developers, and Mr. Sathish Kumar Santhanam, Managing Director, DAC Developers.

REFLECTIONS FROM THE ADDRESS

• **Kallanai** — Built for Generations A lasting example of foresight, engineering excellence and public purpose.

• **Brihadisvara Temple** — Precision that Endures A testament to scientific knowledge, architectural intelligence and timeless design.

• **A Timeless Tamil Thought** Recalling former President of India, Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam, who invoked "Yaadhum Oore; Yaavarum Kelir" in his address to the European Parliament, Dr. Sathish Kumar Santhanam echoed the same words in his own address. Written by Kaniyan Pungundranar, they mean: "Every place is our home. Everyone is our kin."

"யாதும் ஊரே; யாவரும் கேளிர்"
-Kaniyan Pungundranar

"The next leap in human longevity will not come from medicine alone. It will come from the built world we choose to create today."
-Dr. Sathish Kumar Santhanam

Mr. Sathish Kumar receiving the prestigious **Global Change Maker Honour Award 2026** from Dr. Giovanni Jing, UNESCO, Italy.

As Founder and Managing Director of DAC Developers, Dr. Sathish Kumar Santhanam underscored a larger vision: to create resilient, inclusive communities that strengthen society and contribute meaningfully to the nation's future.

INBRIEF

DGP holds review meeting on law and order situation

Director-General of Police (DGP)/Head of Police Force Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal conducted a review meeting of the law and order situation at the Avadi Commissionerate office on Saturday. Avadi Commissioner T. Senthil Kumar, Joint Commissioner R. Sivakumar, and Deputy Commissioners participated. The DGP reviewed criminal cases, and measures to curb narcotic substances, road accidents, and cybercrime.

Inspector C. Mahesh Kumar placed on vacancy reserve

Inspector C. Mahesh Kumar, who was the investigating officer with the Immoral Trafficking Prevention Unit when a complaint was filed against R. Veeramani of Gem Granites, has been placed on vacancy reserve with immediate effect on administrative grounds, sources said.

CUMTA prepares detailed plan for upgrading city's MRTS network ahead of CMRL takeover

It has formulated 12 measures and recommendations for the takeover, and shared them with CMRL; bids will be floated to rope in firms for security services and housekeeping; CMRL is also expected to replace malfunctioning lifts in MRTS stations, following which fresh train sets will be ordered

TRACK TALES

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

From the formation of an exclusive Mass Rapid Transit System (MRTS) division at the Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL) to hiring firms for security and housekeeping, the Chennai Unified Metropolitan Transport Authority (CUMTA) has chalked out a detailed plan for upgrading the city's MRTS network.

The CUMTA, which has played a pivotal role in the city's urban mobility ecosystem over the past few years, is working to kickstart the CMRL's takeover of the MRTS.

This project, which was in limbo for nearly 15 years, got a fillip in July last year, when the Railway Board gave its consent for the takeover.

Nearly 60% of the station area will be earmarked for refurbishment, and the rest will be for business development. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

With the Memorandum of Understanding expected to be signed shortly and the takeover only a few months away, the CUMTA has formulated 12 measures and recommendations for the takeover, and shared them with CMRL.

At first, the CMRL must create a dedicated MRTS division with a separate set of officials to quickly get the initial work started, officials said.

"Since the phase 2 project involves a lot of work and a majority of CMRL officials are occupied with it, establishing an exclusive division for MRTS upgradation is essential," an official said. Following this, the CMRL should begin work to enhance the security and cleanliness of the stations, he added.

Meanwhile, plans are already under way to float bids first for two firms – one for security services and the other for housekeeping.

"Nearly 60% of the station area will be earmarked for refurbishment immediately, and it will be spruced up for passengers at first. The rest will be for business development," another official said.

The CMRL should identify non-functional lifts and escalators and repair them at first. Later, it can replace the facilities wherever needed, the CUMTA said.

Following this, a fresh set of trains will be ordered, which will take nearly two years to be delivered.

"This upgradation will be a mammoth task considering how starkly different the CMRL and MRTS stations are. The CMRL will have to put in a huge effort to transform the network over the next few years," another official said.

Technical glitch

Due to a technical glitch, commuters couldn't buy QR tickets in CMRL stations for a brief period on Saturday. Sources said the problem lasted from 8.45 a.m. to 10 a.m.

"We received quite a few complaints from passengers, as they were unable to buy the QR tickets during this period. As a result, the staff had to issue handwritten tickets to passengers," a source said. The issue arose as the server was down, but it was later resolved, another source said.

CMRL posted on X: "Due to a technical glitch, online tickets (QR tickets), including those purchased through the mobile app, are temporarily unavailable. Passengers are requested to purchase tickets from the Metro Station ticket counters until further information. Rectification works are in progress. CMRL regrets the inconvenience caused."

Rohheeth, a commuter, posted: "@cmrlofficial your server is down. But the ticket amount is debited. The staff are charging the full amount and no 20% off. At the counters, they are giving handwritten tickets. Not acceptable at all."

Direct container service from Chennai to Vietnam, Malaysia, and China launched

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

In a boost to containerised trade and Chennai Port's access to important Asian trade markets, HAIAN CVI, a new monthly container service, has begun from Chennai to Haiphong (Vietnam), Port Klang West (Malaysia), and Nansha (China).

The first call of the service began onboard the vessel, *M.V. Haian Beta*, and the route was Chennai-Port Klang West-Haiphong-Nansha, according to a press release.

Sachin S. Kurve, chairperson, Chennai Port Authority, said, "The commencement of HAIAN's CVI service provides exporters and importers with an additional regular shipping option connecting Chennai with Vietnam and the wider Southeast Asian and South China markets. Chennai Port – with its strong industrial hinterland, established container terminals, and continued focus on trade facilitation – is well-positioned to support the growth of this important trade corridor."

The inauguration of HAIAN CVI could boost containerised trade and improve Chennai Port's access to important Asian trade markets.

Against the backdrop of the growing India-Vietnam merchandise trade and both countries agreeing to explore ways to achieve a bilateral trade target of $25 billion by 2030, there is great potential to strengthen containerised trade through Chennai Port.

During the inauguration onboard *M.V. Haian Beta*, a ceremonial flag exchange took place between the Chennai Port Authority and Hai An Lines. Representatives from Chennai Port Authority, Hai An Lines, Samsara Shipping, and DP World Chennai were present.

Singeetham Srinivasa Rao passes away at 95

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Legendary cinema director and writer Singeetham Srinivasa Rao passed away on Saturday evening at Kauvery Hospital in Chennai, according to family and friends. He was 95.

Singeetham Srinivasa Rao

Born in Gudur in Nellore district, he made his mark in the film industry at the age of 41 with his writing and direction of *Neeti Nijayiti*, a Telugu film, in 1972. But before that, Singeetham began as a dialogue writer to filmmaker K.V. Reddy and assisted him in the Telugu film *Mayabazar* (1957).

From then onwards, he directed films in multiple languages, including *Pesum Padam* without any dialogue, starring Kamal Haasan and Amala.

He went on to form a formidable partnership with Mr. Haasan.

Among the notable films he helmed or had a role in bringing to screen were: *Raja Paarvai, Apoorva Sagodharargal, Michael Madana Kama Rajan, Magalir Mattum, Kaathala Kaathala, Mumbai Xpress, and Chinna Vathiyar,* and multiple films in Telugu and Kannada. He acted in some films and even composed the movie score.

His last film, *Sing Geetham*, a musical-fantasy comedy that he directed and wrote the script for, was released in June 2026.

Building resilience: With young people facing increasing mental health challenges, creating spaces for expression has become vital.

'Wall of Hope', mental health initiative led by youth, unveiled in city

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 'Wall of Hope', a youth-led initiative by the Schizophrenia Research Foundation (SCARF) and its Department of Youth Mental Health, was unveiled at the IIT-Madras Research Park in Taramani on Saturday, a press release said.

With young people facing increasing mental health challenges and suicide remaining a concern, creating spaces for expression and help-seeking is vital.

The mental health campaign, which began on October 10, 2025, encourages young people aged 10-25 to express, share, and reflect upon their personal reasons for living, through brief messages of hope.

Adolescents and young adults across the country were invited to write the purpose of life on colourful post-it notes. More than 20,000 responses from across six States have been collected.

Additionally, 400 volunteers have been trained to conduct this activity, which is voluntary and anonymous, to foster conversations around mental health.

Justice N. Anand Venkatesh, Madras High Court judge, and Lakshmi Vijayakumar, founder of suicide prevention organisation SNEHA, participated in the event, besides SCARF vice-chairperson R. Thara and director Sridhar Vaitheswaran.

(Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on the State's health helpline 104, Tele-MANAS 14416, and Sneha's suicide prevention helpline 044-24640050)

CINEMA ❖ ARTS ❖ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

Naada Inbam, 24992672.
Perumal Memorial Concert. G. Ravi Kiran, Madan Mohan, B. Sivaraman, Dr. S. Karthick. Today 6.15pm at Ragasudha Hall.

Narada Gana Sabha
Ph: 24993201
Today Mini Hall Swami Haridhos Giri Hall - 6.30 pm - Music - Oothukadu Venkatakavi Day - Samanvi & Archana (Vocal), C.S.Chinmayi (Violin), Aduthurai Guruprasad (Mridangam), Hari Kishore (Kanjira) All are welcome.

Sabhas LIVE by Sumanasa Foundation Adambakkam Sapthaswaralaya, Adambakkam. Ph: 94445 39450
Today at 6.30 pm at Sri Karpaga Vinayagar Pandurangan Saradambal Temple, Shanti Nagar, Adambakkam. Ashwath Narayanan - Vocal L. Ramakrishnan - Violin Sumesh Narayanan- Mrdangam. All are welcome. Supported by Sumanasa Foundation

Sri Thyaga Brahma Gana Sabha (Regd.) Vanimahal. Ph: 28152166
Today 10.00 am at Vani Mahal Veena Competition in memory of Sri.V.V.Subramanian & Smt.Kamala Subramanian and Music Competition on Muthuswamy Dikshitar Kritis and Papanasam Sivan Kritis. All are welcome.

The Indian Fine Arts Society, Ethiraja Kalyana Nilayam, 87 TTK Road, Alwarpet, Chennai - 600018. (Phone:7845755481)
Today ANNUAL MUSIC COMPETITION PRIZE Distribution & Sri Muthuswamy Dikshithar Day Celebration : 2.00 p.m. Srijith Poosarla (Mandolin) - Shreeya Ananth - Anghiras Mahadevan - Shrinidhi Raghunandan: 4.00 p.m. PRIZE DISTRIBUTION BY Sangeetha Kalaiskhamani Shri N Vijay Siva: 6.00 p.m. S.Nithyashree (Veena) - Poongulam Subramaniam - B.S.Purushothaman: All are welcome; THAMBURA PRIZE Donated by Sri G.Sampath Bangalore, Venue Narayana Guruviah Chetty's Estate and Charities, Chennai. Chavala Rangiah Chetty's Charities:

To advertise visit
www.thehinduads.com
044-28576300 Toll Free: 1800 102 4161

THE HINDU GROUP

CELEBRATING THE MAHATMA, BEYOND HIS TIME

We commemorate not just the man, but the radical thinker in him, whose ideas and philosophy traversed the world and remain relevant even today.

In collaboration with Zepto, The Hindu brings you special reprints of its archival editions.

Explore the ideas that made Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi, Mahatma Gandhi.

Get your collector's edition on zepto

Scan the QR or visit https://newsth.live/zepto-Oct2

Published by Nirmala Lakshman at Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002 on behalf of THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. and Printed by Ra Babu Vijay at THG PUBLISHING PVT.LTD. Plot B-6 & B-7, CMDA Industrial Complex, Maraimalai Nagar, Chengalpattu Taluk, Chengalpattu Dist., Pin 603209. Editor: Suresh Nambath Chandrasekar (Responsible for selection of news under the PRP Act).
ISSN 0971 - 751X

SAVEETHA

INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL AND TECHNICAL SCIENCES
(Declared as Deemed to be University under Section 3 of UGC Act 1956)

A HAT-TRICK OF GLOBAL EXCELLENCE

RANKED NO. 1

AMONG PRIVATE UNIVERSITIES IN INDIA

THE World University Rankings 2027

326 - 350
in World Rank

2025 | 2026 | 2027

THREE CONSECUTIVE YEARS, ONE LEGACY
IN 20 YEARS OF EXCELLENCE.

250+ UG| PG | Ph.D Programmes in

Medicine | Dentistry | Engineering | Law | Management | Nursing | Physiotherapy | Occupational Therapy | Pharmacy | Physical Education | Architecture and Designing | Allied Health Sciences | Liberal Arts & Sciences | Hospitality & Tourism | Natural & Physical Sciences | Education

NIRF Rankings 2025

2	11	13	13	19	23	45	63	11/50
Dental	Medical	Research	University	Law	Overall	Engineering	Management	Innovation

Toll Free: 1800 123 746287
044 2680 1050
admission@saveetha.com
www.saveetha.com

Thandalam Campus :
Saveetha Nagar, Thandalam, Chennai - 602 105

Poonamallee Campus:
162, Poonamallee High Road, Chennai - 600 077

In full swing

The TVK government has posted Ministers and officials for flood-mitigation measures in view of the northeast monsoon. It has also ordered that desilting and stormwater drain projects be completed as early as possible. The Municipal Administration and Water Supply (MAWS) Department has asked local bodies across Tamil Nadu to complete monsoon-related projects by October 10

COLLECTORS SHOULD ENSURE THAT

- Adequate chlorination of drinking water is done up to the tailend
- Generator sets are kept in good condition at head works, booster stations, water supply and STP facilities as well as pumping stations of UGSS
- The Collectors of Villupuram, Tiruvarur, Pudukottai, Salem, Tiruppur, Chengalpattu, Tiruvannamalai, Madurai, Coimbatore, and Kancheepuram districts must expedite the desilting of the stormwater drains
- All stormwater drains, channels, and culverts are thoroughly desilted before the onset of the monsoon to ensure free flow of stormwater
- All manholes are desilted and kept free from blockage. Measures should be taken to ensure that no overflow occurs during the monsoon
- Dengue prevention and anti-larval activities are intensified in all vulnerable areas
- Tree pruning is undertaken to minimise the risk of falling branches
- Dead and hazardous trees are identified and removed to minimise the risk of damage to life and property

On a war-footing: The Water Resources Department has deployed about 400 machines to clean the waterways, including the Adyar, the Cooum, the Kosasthalaiyar, the Araniyar, and the Buckingham Canal, and also clear sand bars at river mouths. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

The Monsoon Test

The northeast monsoon is at the doorstep. The India Meteorological Department has predicted normal rainfall this monsoon and a strong El Nino may strengthen further towards the end of the year. Historically, November and December have long been months to remember in Chennai, where the rain can be unpredictable. With the monsoons becoming shorter and intense, successive Dravidian governments had grappled with mitigation measures only for the city to be flooded time and again. Backed by the urban vote, the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam swept the polls in Chennai and neighbouring districts in the May 2026 Assembly election at the expense of the DMK, for which the city was a stronghold for decades. Is the new government prepared to face a heavy monsoon, or will Chennai have to brace for another deluge? **R. Aishwaryaa** reports

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, who also holds the Municipal Administration portfolio, has already posted Ministers and senior officials to take up flood mitigation works way ahead of the northeast monsoon. Now, he has instructed that all the desilting and stormwater drain (SWD) works be completed as early as possible.

Official data show that the flood-vulnerable locations in the Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) have dropped from nearly 800 in 2015 to 389 in 2023, and 219 for the 2026 northeast monsoon. The list of vulnerable locations is being continuously reviewed based on field-level assessments, rainfall patterns, and the effectiveness of completed flood-mitigation works, said Chennai Corporation officials. The micro-level SWD works are 95% complete, but there are severe capacity constraints along the Buckingham Canal, Adyar, and Sholinganallur, officials said.

Corporation Commissioner G.S. Sameeran said the civic body is coordinating with the Railways, Chennai Metro Rail Limited, and other agencies for implementing drainage and flood-mitigation works. “Some major infrastructure works may take longer. The GCC has implemented temporary solutions such as pumping facilities for managing the monsoon,” he said.

No consultation

Mr. Sameeran and his team have been inspecting various works across the city almost daily. But there are voices against lack of consultation and transparency in the flood mitigation works. MDMK councillor S. Jeevan of Ward 35 in Perambur said, “Elected representatives do not know what is happening during flood preparedness inspections. I have not been able to meet the assistant engineer for 10 days to discuss residents’ complaints. The flood risk is high this year owing to delays in the desilting of canals such as the Kodungaiyur Canal.”

Federation of North Chennai Residents Welfare Association president T. Shanmugam said residents were worried as officials had not shared details of flood preparedness. Haris Sulthan, an activist at Padi, said most waterbodies in and around Chennai and its suburbs remained largely dry, with the five drinking-water reservoirs together holding 4.5 tmc against their capacity of 11.7 tmc. He said routine annual works were being carried out, but no major new flood-mitigation projects had been undertaken in many areas, including Medavakkam, Chitlapakkam, Hasthinapuram, Kadaperi, Ambedkar Road, Jothi Nagar, and Sunnambu Kolathur, where prolonged inundation was reported earlier. He appreciated the cancellation of the tenders for “cosmetic lake-front development” works by the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam government and called for further desilting, removal of water hyacinth, and increasing lake depth.

Urbanisation challenge

According to a senior Corporation official, Chennai’s monsoon vulnerability, particularly in the south of the city, is largely due to unchecked urbanisation, and flooding in many parts such as Perumbakkam is “100% man-made”. Pointing to the built-up space and encroachments around the Pallikaranai marsh, Perungudi, and the Information Technology Corridor, he said natural watercourses are choked, and canals at T. Nagar and Mambalam are heavily polluted because the “entire waterway has become a sewer owing to illegal sewage connections”.

> There are 4,100 lakes in the three adjoining districts of Tiruvallur, Chengalpattu and Kancheepuram, besides numerous temple tanks and ponds that can help augment surface water and improve groundwater recharge
>
> **S. JANAKARAJAN,** president, South Asia Consortium for Interdisciplinary Water Resources Studies

K.P. Subramanian, an urban planner, highlighted that while flood resilience at Velachery has improved, areas such as Kuber Nagar, Karthikeyapuram, and parts of Madipakkam still face risks owing to urban development and accumulation of silt in drains. He recommends regular desilting and zoning regulations to designate flood plains, river, and lake margins as no-development zones.

D. Raghunandan, a climate researcher at Delhi Science Forum, said the SWD network in Chennai and its suburbs must be redesigned to handle extreme rainfall events such as 100 mm-200 mm or more in just a few hours, rather than an evenly distributed amount of rain. Instead of haphazard urbanisation, buildings, roads and flyovers must be planned to ensure natural drainage and the connectivity of SWDs to the three major rivers running through the city and into the sea is not affected.

Chennai must protect its wetlands and lakes such as at Perumbakkam and Pallikaranai, and the depth of Cooum and Adyar Rivers has also come down, compared with yesteryears. Increasing the capacity of waterbodies would help store excess rainwater or drain it naturally into the sea, he suggested. “This is a long and costly overhaul that has to be addressed systematically over time; it would offset the losses during frequent urban floods,” he noted, adding that similar measures were needed in all major cities, not just Chennai. S. Janakarajan, president, South Asia Consortium for Interdisciplinary Water Resources Studies and former professor at Madras Institute of Development Studies, said water conservation must be prioritised since short heavy downpours are the new normal.

He said 70%-80% of rainfall runs off into the sea because departments drain water without coordination. He suggested that the State focus on conservation to mitigate floods and droughts. “There are 4,100 lakes in the three adjoining districts of Tiruvallur, Chengalpattu and Kancheepuram, besides numerous temple tanks and ponds that can help augment surface water and improve groundwater recharge. Temporary ponds could be created at educational institutions, parks, playfields, and government land, while large private land parcels could also be considered for creating sponge parks,” he said.

WRD desilting exercise

The Water Resources Department is set to complete the first phase of its annual desilting exercise in a week. But vast swathes of water hyacinth hindering the free flow of floodwater in waterways remain a challenge this year too. While the department has accelerated work to clean the major and minor waterways ahead of the northeast monsoon, residents of various parts of the city have urged the authorities to coordinate with other agencies to prevent sewage entering the waterways. The department has deployed about 400 machines, including floating excavators, to clean the waterways, including the Adyar, the Cooum, the Kosasthalaiyar, the Araniyar, and the Buckingham Canal, and also clear sand bars at river mouths.

Officials noted that the ₹42-crore project would help minimise floods in rivers during monsoon and backflow into micro-drains by 70%-80% during the monsoon. The rivers would be able to handle the flows without spillover even in the event of 200 mm of rainfall in a day.

To reduce sewage-related complaints during the northeast monsoon, Metrowater has completed the second phase of cleaning the city’s sewer network. The network was cleaned through 41,996 manholes between July and September. As floodwater often enters the sewer network during heavy rain, the water agency plans to undertake a third phase of cleaning between October and December to minimise blockages and prevent sewer network failures, officials said.

Nearly 417 sewage pumping stations and treatment plants have been equipped with IoT-based monitoring systems to help detect and prevent sewage stagnation and overflows. Robotic equipment is also being used to detect leaks and damage in drinking water pipelines.

Power infrastructure

The Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited (TNPDCL) handles flood mitigation works under 22 categories. The monsoon preparatory works are carried out on a massive scale this year, said a senior official of TNPDCL.

Tree branch clearance was completed at 6.75 lakh locations, exposed underground cables were buried at 1,762 places, damaged insulators were replaced at 85,000 locations, and low-sag overhead lines were rectified at 54,387 places. Maintenance is going on at 2,650 sub-stations and 3,840 pillar boxes. TNPDCL is also replacing 40,000 damaged concrete poles and worn-out conductors at 2,500 locations. Distribution transformer structures are maintained at 60,000 places, according to the data shared by TNPDCL.

Maintenance works are nearly complete across all distribution regions, except Chennai North, Central, West and South-I. Over 90% of the monsoon preparatory works are being done in Chennai South-II, Kancheepuram, and Tiruvallur, according to the data. The works are being expedited in central Chennai (T. Nagar, Anna Salai, Teynampet, Royapettah, Triplicane, and Mylapore), where only 52% have been completed. In the western region covering Ambattur, Avadi, Maduravoyal, Anna Nagar, and Kolathur, 56% of the works are complete.

‘Early preparedness is key’

“Local bodies across Tamil Nadu have been directed to complete monsoon works by October 10. In Chennai, desilting has been under way for two-and-a-half months, with one cycle covering nearly one lakh silt catch pits completed. The second cycle is under way. Similar instructions have been issued to other corporations, municipalities, and town panchayats,” said Municipal Administration and Water Supply (MAWS) Department Secretary Gagandeep Singh Bedi. “Very high rainfall in short duration and rainwater inflow from adjoining suburban areas would place more pressure on the SWD systems, so early preparedness is key,” he told the department heads at a recent meeting.

(With inputs from K. Lakshmi, R. Srikanth, and Aloysius Xavier Lopez)

A challenge: Vast swathes of water hyacinth hindering the free flow of floodwater in waterways remain a challenge this year too. The Water Resources Department has accelerated the work on cleaning the major and minor waterways ahead of the northeast monsoon. The photograph shows the desilting of the Adyar at Manapakkam. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

185+ STORES Since 1971
55 Years of Trust

GIRIAS SUPER SUNDAY
UP TO 70% OFF on All Products

GIRIAS®
THE CONSUMER DURABLE PEOPLE
Since 1971

iPhone 15 (128 GB)
MRP ₹79,900
EFFECTIVE PRICE
₹45,991*
FREE: ZEBRONICS Sound Bar worth ₹11,999

Shop & Win a GOLD COIN*
Get 100%* FREE Shopping

PRICE HIKED! GRAB IT TODAY AT THE OLD PRICE!

04th OCT, 2026 | 9 AM to 11 PM | ONE DAY OFFER*

ALL LEADING BRANDS & PRODUCTS UNDER ONE ROOF

Authorised Reseller
airtel AKAI ASUS AGARO BLUE STAR BAJAJ boAt BOSCH Butterfly Crompton DAIKIN AIR CONDITIONERS DELL EUREKA FORBES FABER FIRE-BOLTT Godrej Haier hp HITACHI IFB
KAFF KENSTAR KRATOS Lenovo LG Livpure mi xiaomi MILTON Itreo morphy richards MOTOROLA NOKIA NOTHING ONIDA GENERAL ONEPLUS onsitego oppo orient electric PHILIPS Prestige Panasonic
PORTRONICS Preethi Racold realme Redmi SAMSUNG Symphony SIEMENS SONY TCL TATA SKY ULTRA VENUS V-GUARD VIJAYALAKSHMI vivo VOLTAS VOLTAS beko VEGA Whirlpool ZEBRONICS

DELL LAPTOP
INSPIRON 3520/D560865WIN9B/D560871WIN9B/I5-1235U/8GB+8GB/512GB/15.6 FHD/W11+OFF 2021
14% Off
MRP ₹69,999 SSS PRICE ₹59,999

ASUS LAPTOP
P1511CEA-BR763 /15.6 HD/i3-1115G4/ VGA CAMERA/4GB/256GB PCIE/DOS/ GREY
6% Off
MRP ₹38,400 SSS PRICE ₹35,999

hp LAPTOP
15s-du3614TU / i3-1115G4/8/ 1+256/W+O/JB/NB (6N041TA)
8% Off
MRP ₹49,990 SSS PRICE ₹45,999

180 DAYS + UPTO 90%
SCREEN PROTECTION DISCOUNT
ON ACCESSORIES ALONG WITH MOBILE PURCHASE
Authorised Reseller SAMSUNG ONEPLUS oppo realme NOKIA xiaomi vivo MOTOROLA NOTHING

MOBILE PHONE
EASY EMI @ NO EXTRA COST

75" SMART Google TV
58% Off
MRP ₹2,05,990 SSS PRICE ₹85,940

65" QLED TV
59% Off
MRP ₹1,19,000 SSS PRICE ₹48,840

55" QLED TV Google TV
37% Off
MRP ₹54,390 SSS PRICE ₹34,510

43" SMART TV
61% Off
MRP ₹35,900 SSS PRICE ₹14,020

40" SMART TV
62% Off
MRP ₹32,900 SSS PRICE ₹12,460

32" LED TV
65% Off
MRP ₹20,900 SSS PRICE ₹7,260

24" LED TV
61% Off
MRP ₹14,990 SSS PRICE ₹5,830

596 LTRS SIDE BY SIDE REFRIGERATOR
47% Off
MRP ₹1,01,990 SSS PRICE ₹53,720

230 LTRS FF REFRIGERATOR
57% Off
MRP ₹42,990 SSS PRICE ₹18,650

185 LTRS REFRIGERATOR
60% Off
MRP ₹27,490 SSS PRICE ₹11,090

7.5 KG FL WM (BUILT-IN-HEATER)
49% Off
MRP ₹35,490 SSS PRICE ₹17,990

6.5 KG TL WM
51% Off
MRP ₹24,990 SSS PRICE ₹12,230

7.0 KG SA WM
34% Off
MRP ₹12,990 SSS PRICE ₹8,560

DRYER
30% Off
MRP ₹27,790 SSS PRICE ₹19,430

DISH WASHER
41% Off
MRP ₹25,990 SSS PRICE ₹15,400

225 LTRS FREEZER
47% Off
MRP ₹35,490 SSS PRICE ₹18,880

1.5 TON (3 STAR) INVERTER AC
41% Off
MRP ₹46,990 SSS PRICE ₹27,730

1.0 TON (3 STAR) INVERTER AC
40% Off
MRP ₹42,990 SSS PRICE ₹25,680

1.5 TON (3 STAR) SPLIT AC
54% Off
MRP ₹59,990 SSS PRICE ₹27,620

20 LTRS AIR COOLER
58% Off
MRP ₹9,690 SSS PRICE ₹4,030

PEDESTAL FAN
57% Off
MRP ₹6,590 SSS PRICE ₹2,810

ELECTRIC CHIMNEY
70% Off
MRP ₹31,990 SSS PRICE ₹9,700

1.25 LTR GRINDER
44% Off
MRP ₹5,570 SSS PRICE ₹3,110

ELECTRIC KETTLE
74% Off
MRP ₹1,495 SSS PRICE ₹390

23 LTRS OVEN TOAST GRILLER
59% Off
MRP ₹9,490 SSS PRICE ₹3,870

WATER HEATER
59% Off
MRP ₹5,490 SSS PRICE ₹2,260

GAS STOVE
41% Off
MRP ₹3,000 SSS PRICE ₹1,760

AIR FRYER
59% Off
MRP ₹7,995 SSS PRICE ₹3,290

AUDIO-X BOOM
49% Off
MRP ₹5,490 SSS PRICE ₹2,800

WATER BOTTLE
44% Off
MRP ₹355 SSS PRICE ₹200

NON STICK TAWA
67% Off
MRP ₹999 SSS PRICE ₹330

DOUBLE LAYERED MILK FROTHER & EGG WHISK
51% Off
MRP ₹999 SSS PRICE ₹490

CASSEROLE
38% Off
MRP ₹485 SSS PRICE ₹300

CHOPPER
78% Off
MRP ₹914 SSS PRICE ₹200

SHAVER & TRIMMER
25% Off
MRP ₹1,945 SSS PRICE ₹1,460

MOBILE PHONE STAND
65% Off
MRP ₹399 SSS PRICE ₹140

WIRELESS KEYBOARD
72% Off
MRP ₹1,199 SSS PRICE ₹330

AIR PODS
79% Off
MRP ₹2,499 SSS PRICE ₹520

TYPE C BRAIDED CABLE
80% Off
MRP ₹799 SSS PRICE ₹160

ADAPTOR (TRAVEL CHARGER SOCKET)
76% Off
MRP ₹999 SSS PRICE ₹240

NECK BAND
82% Off
MRP ₹1,199 SSS PRICE ₹210

TABLET
27% Off
MRP ₹14,999 SSS PRICE ₹10,999

GIRIAS®
THE CONSUMER DURABLE PEOPLE
Since 1971

MAHALINGAPURAM: NO 25, RAMANATHAN STREET, MAHALINGAPURAM MAIN ROAD, CHENNAI - 34. PH: 8939970745 / 70746

REDHILLS: NO.88/3A1B BYPASS ROAD, REDHILLS, CHENNAI - 600 052. 8939767222 / 8939787222 | MANNIVAKKAM (MUDICHUR): NO.65, ANNA STREET, MUDICHUR ROAD, MANNIVAKKAM, CHENNAI - 48. PH: 8939848222 / 8939878222 | MKB NAGAR (VYASARPADI): NO.317/1,2,3 WEST AVENUE ROAD, MKB NAGAR, VYASARPADI, CHENNAI - 600039. PH: 8939949222 / 8939969222 | NANGANALLUR: 4TH MAIN ROAD, NEAR VENUGOPALA SWAMI THIRUKOVIL, PH.: 8939917222 / 18222 | KUNDRATHUR: THIRUNAGESWARAM VILLAGE, (NEAR MADURAI PANDIYAN HOTEL) PH: 8939913222 / 8939914222 | ROYAPETTAH: PETERS ROAD, PH: 8939560222 / 8939570222 | ANNA NAGAR: NEAR CHINTHAMANI SIGNAL, PH: 8939970741/742 | ADYAR: LB ROAD, PH: 8939887222/0222 | AMBATTUR: M.T.H.ROAD, PH: 8939970743/744 | AVADI: OPP AVADI MUNICIPALITY, PH: 8939109777 | CHENGALPATTU: THIMMARAJAKULAM PH: 8939707222 / 8939701222 | EGATTUR: OPPOSITE TO HIRANANDANI APPARTMENT, PH: 8939314222/8939315222 | GUDUVANCHERRY: GST ROAD, PH: 8939970747/48 | GUMMIDIPOONDI: GNT ROAD, PH: 8925866556 / 8925866557 | KOLATHUR: VELAVAN NAGAR, PH: 8939941222/8939951222 | KEELKATALAI: MEDAVAKKAM MAIN ROAD, PH: 8939970359 | KELAMBAKKAM: ANNA NAGAR, OPP TO POLICE STATION, PH: 9962063333/ 9962093333 | PALLAVARAM: AMMAL MAIN ROAD, PH: 8925866563 / 8925866564 | MOGAPPAIR: KAMBAR SALAI, PH: 8939974222/64222 | MANALI: KAMARAJAR SALAI, PH: 8939858222 / 8939868222 | MEDAVAKKAM: VELACHERY MAIN ROAD, PH: 8925866569 / 8925866570 | POONAMALLEE: PH: 8939748222/8939758222 | PORUR: NO.69, ARCOT ROAD, PH: 8939254222/ 8939253222. | PONNERI: ADHAVULLASHA STREET, PH: 8939839222 / 8939859222 | R A PURAM: VENKATAKRISHNA ROAD, PH: 8939970356/357 | T.NAGAR: MAHALINGAPURAM MAIN ROAD, PH: 8939970745/746 | TAMBARAM: RAJAJI ROAD, PH: 8939907222/4222 | TIRUVALLUR: JN ROAD, PH: 8939970352/353 | THURAIPAKKAM, (OMR): RAJIV GANDHI SALAI, PH: 8939067222 / 8939068222 | TONDIARPET: THIRUVOTRIYUR HIGH ROAD, PH: 8939034222/8939038222 | VIRUGAMBAKKAM: ARCOT ROAD, PH: 7824028333 | VELACHERY: THARAMANI LINK RD, PH: 8939970349 | VANAGARAM: POONAMALLEE HIGH ROAD, PH: 8925866565 / 8925866566.

Store Locator

*Conditions apply. Products shown are indicative. Offers are applicable only till stock last. All the models may not be available at all the stores.

INBRIEF

175th year anniversary fete held at College of Fine Arts

The 175th year anniversary celebration and alumni meet of The Government College of Fine Arts, Chennai, were held on its campus on Saturday. The celebration commemorated the 175-year journey of the institution, its rich artistic heritage, and the remarkable contributions of former students in the field of art and society. The programme was held under the chairmanship of eminent art director Thotta Tharani. Famous alumni including Trotsky Marudu, Maniam Selvan, actor Sivakumar, former principals, faculty and students participated. K. Pugazhendhi, principal, presided over the event.

Persons with disabilities participate in walkathon

Around 150 persons with disabilities participated in the 'Special Children Walkathon' conducted by TRM Surya Foundation on Friday. They also raised slogans on anti-drug awareness. "We have multiple walkathons happening, but we wanted to conduct an inclusive one where persons with disabilities could participate. We also wanted to address an important concern," said Prabha Gurumurthy, founder of TRM Surya Foundation.

Work on reservoir project has affected key habitat for migratory waterbirds: trust

A survey of the Mamallan reservoir project area recorded around 3,500 waterbirds; 51 species, including 25 protected under the UN Convention on Migratory Species, were found, it says

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Kovalam-Nemmeli wetland is an important stopover site for birds arriving along the Central Asian Flyway during the August-September migration season, according to Palluyir Trust. M. SRINATH

The ongoing dredging and bund work for the proposed Mamallan reservoir in the Kovalam-Nemmeli backwaters has affected a crucial habitat for migratory waterbirds, according to the Palluyir Trust for Nature Education and Research.

In a representation to the Water Resources Department (WRD), the trust said four naturalists and zoologists surveyed the project area on September 29 and recorded around 3,500 waterbirds.

The team recorded 51 species, including 25 migratory species protected under the UN Convention on Migratory Species.

More than 1,500 garganey ducks, which migrate from temperate regions including Russia and Mongolia, were recorded foraging within the project site. More than 700 greater flamingos were also seen.

Stopover site

The trust said the Kovalam-Nemmeli wetland was an important stopover site for migratory birds arriving along the Central Asian Flyway during the August - September migration season. It said the presence of thousands of foraging birds indicated that the area comprised biologically active mudflats, although this had not been recognised in the coastal zone management plan. According to the trust, dredging and bunding for the reservoir had removed brackish and halophytic vegetation that had previously provided a buffer between waterbirds and traffic and human activity.

The Palluyir Trust raised concerns over the project's potential implications for flood drainage in southern part of the city

Blocking tidal flow

The blocking of tidal flow could also affect the movement of marine organisms during high tide and reduce prey availability for waterbirds, the trust said.

The organisation also raised concerns about the project's potential implications for flood drainage in south Chennai.

Citing warnings by scientists from Anna University's Centre for Climate Change and Disaster Management about extreme weather and the possibility of severe cyclonic events in the Bay of Bengal, it said blocking a crucial flood channel could increase flood risks in the region around OMR.

The alliance seeks to bring diabetic foot prevention and limb preservation into global and national health policy.

Global organisations form alliance for diabetic foot survival and limb preservation

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Eight organisations from different parts of the world have come together to form the Global Alliance for Diabetic Foot Survival and Limb Preservation.

The announcement was made at the national conference of Diabetic Foot Society of India (DFSI), which was held in Bengaluru on Friday.

The founding organisations also signed a joint declaration calling for diabetic foot ulceration to be recognised as a global public health priority.

The eight organisations are the DFSI, King's College London, the International Association of Diabetic Foot Surgeons, D-Foot International, the Pan African Diabetic Foot Study Group, the American Limb Preservation Society, the International Federation of Podiatrists, and the Podiatric Surgeons' Society.

A 2023 review cited in the alliance proposal estimated that about 18.6 million people worldwide are affected by diabetic foot ulceration annually. It reported a five-year mortality of about 30% following a diabetic foot ulcer and over 70% following a major amputation.

The proposed alliance will focus on research, workforce training, comparable data collection, and advocacy with the World Health Organization and national governments to secure greater policy recognition of diabetic foot disease.

The proposed framework also emphasises the involvement of people living with diabetes, those who have experienced foot ulcers, and people living with amputation or disability in decision-making and programme design.

Heat to ease as rain activity set to pick up in parts of T.N. from today

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Much-needed respite: Chennai has chances of light rainfall in some areas during evening or night hours on Sunday. C. VENKATACHALAPATHY

October has begun on a warm note, with unrelenting heat continuing in parts of interior Tamil Nadu. The Regional Meteorological Centre (RMC) has predicted heavy rainfall in some Western Ghats districts and moderate rain in interior parts till October 6. The wet spell is likely to cool temperature levels in various parts of the State from Sunday, according to the RMC.

Three minor weather systems would influence wet weather and thundershower activity in the State for the next few days. While a cyclonic circulation that lies over Comorin and the adjoining area would influence rainfall activity in the State, another weather system over southeast Arabian Sea would trigger rainfall over parts of Western Ghats districts.

The presence of another weather system over south coastal Andhra Pradesh would also have mild impact on the State.

On Saturday, maximum temperatures remained slightly above normal, compared with Friday. Chennai's Meenambakkam recorded 36.2 degrees Celsius, which was the highest temperature recorded in the State for the day.

Chennai also has chances of light rainfall in some areas during evening or night hours on Sunday. While the day temperature may be around 35-36 degrees Celsius on Sunday, it may drop on Monday owing to thundershower activity, officials said.

On Sunday, isolated places in Theni, the Nilgiris, and the ghat areas of Coimbatore are likely to receive heavy rainfall with gusty winds reaching a speed of 40-50 kmph.

The RMC has forecast moderate rainfall in various interior and southern districts, including Tirupattur, Erode, Ariyalur, Tenkasi, and Kanniyakumari. A similar trend may continue till October 6, after which moderate rainfall may continue in some interior districts till October 9.

Citing the October weather outlook, V.R. Durai, head, Regional Weather Forecasting Centre, RMC, said the maximum and minimum temperatures may remain above normal this month. Strong El Niño conditions are among the reasons for the above average temperatures in various districts.

However, the prevailing weather systems may bring rainfall and aid a fall in temperature levels in areas experiencing wet weather. When the weather system over the Comorin area moves westwards, the maximum temperature in interior parts such as Erode may begin to drop, he said.

Modalities worked out for engaging private manpower agencies to read electricity meters

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

TNPDCL officials have drawn up a broad framework to employ private contractors for meter reading

Initiating the proposal to outsource the reading of domestic electricity meters as a temporary arrangement, the Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Limited (TNPDCL) held a meeting on September 29 to finalise the tender procedures for engaging manpower agencies and operational arrangements for deploying private assessors.

The meeting was attended by senior officials of the Finance Department and the Distribution Director.

The discussion revolved around clarifications on tender notices to be issued by Executive Engineers (EEs), determining the manpower required for each division, the reallocation of staff to guide outsourcing contractors for meter reading, the training mechanism for agency staff, the compliance with safety protocol, and finalisation of firms and agencies suitable for participation in the tenders, TNPDCL officials said.

Based on the discussion, TNPDCL officials have drawn up a broad framework for employing private contractors for meter reading. The EEs nominated to appoint the outsourcing agencies will assess the requirement for outsourced staff and determine the minimum manpower to be notified in the tender documents, an official said.

Manpower requirement

The EEs must assess the manpower requirement at the divisional level, rather than for individual section offices. As part of the process, they must identify manpower service providers, including those without prior experience, who may be invited to participate in the tender process to ensure adequate competition. To ensure transparency and avoid confusion among the bidders, the EEs will hold a pre-bid meeting, before finalising the award of the contract, to clarify the scope of work and tender conditions.

Officials notified

The TNPDCL has notified a hierarchy of officials to train the assessors in the various types of meters installed, meter-reading procedures, and the use of the mobile application to upload the assessed readings. The training will be provided by assessment officers, inspectors of assessment, revenue supervisors, and assistant EEs.

The officials should also check the assessments carried out by the outsourced meter readers through the manual-entry option in the mobile application within a week of the assessment. The EEs must procure the necessary Bluetooth transmitters or optical probes for meter-reading operations and training private meter assessors, officials said.

Consumer activist T. Sadagopan, while welcoming the move, called for rigorous security checks and proper training for the personnel in meter reading and in interacting with consumers.

A senior TNPDCL official said the tenders for procuring smart meters would soon be called, as the final scrutiny of documents was under way after the Board's approval last week.

Man held for taking away motorcycle

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

An employee of a motorcycle showroom was arrested for entering a house in M.K.B. Nagar and taking away a motorcycle, along with ₹43,000 kept in its storage compartment, over an alleged instalment default.

The accused was identified as Arun. The police are searching for his colleague Gopi, who allegedly accompanied him. According to the police, Sam Murthy, 21, had purchased the motorcycle in his sister's name from the showroom in June and was paying the monthly instalments. On September 24, Arun and Gopi allegedly went to Murthy's house and demanded that he hand over the motorcycle, claiming that the instalments were not paid properly.

An argument ensued, following which the duo allegedly abused the siblings and took the motorcycle. Murthy later realised that ₹43,000 was kept in the vehicle.

After the employees of the showroom claimed that the motorcycle was being taken due to an instalment default, the police found that Murthy had missed one monthly payment. Based on Murthy's complaint, the M.K.B. Nagar police filed a case and arrested Arun.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

MRS. R. Shyamala, wife of Mr. V. Rangaswamy, Retired AEE (Civil), TNEB, and daughter of Late Mrs. Lakshmi and Late Mr. R. Sankaran, Retired SE (Civil), TNEB, left for heavenly abode on Sept. 12, 2026 at Thennur, Madurai. May her soul rest in peace. Om Shanti. Grieving husband and family members. Phone Number: 84548 29468.

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

FIRST DEATH ANNIVERSARY

C. V. Santhanakrishnan (Alias) Mutha
(Retd. Manager, Central Bank of India)
DOB: 12.11.1947 - DOD: 04.10.2025
"Gone from our sight but never from our hearts"
Fondly remembered by
Brother: Ramani
Sisters:
Lakshmi, Soundaram & Jayanthi

REMEMBRANCE

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES

To dedicate a space in this section,
Please contact: **044-28576300** from 10.00 a.m. to 6.00 p.m.
Toll Free: 1800 102 4161 from 10.00 a.m. to 10.00 p.m.
For Placing Advertisements Online log on to www.thehinduads.com

DONATE EYES - GIFT SIGHT

BIRTH CENTENARY

RERA NO: TNRERA/29/BLG/0184/2026
WWW.RERA.TN.GOV.IN

YOUR PIECE OF HEAVEN
ONE RARE OPPORTUNITY

LAUNCHING | CASAGRAND VIENNA | LB ROAD

ADYAR'S PRIDE

"VISUALS SHOWN ARE ARTISTIC IMPRESSIONS FOR REPRESENTATION PURPOSES ONLY. | *T&C APPLY"

98 SIGNATURE 3 & 4 BED RESIDENCES & DUPLEX HOMES ON LB ROAD

₹5.10 CR* ONWARDS

1.5-ACRE COMMUNITY | 70% OPEN SPACE | 30 LIFESTYLE AMENITIES

16-FT-WIDE MASTER SUITES | BALCONIES OVERLOOKING THE CITY & SEA

The Setting

A premium community with Singapore-inspired elevations across 4 towers | 70% open space with lush, landscaped greenery

The Residence

16-ft-wide Master suites, beyond conventional standards | Panoramic views through full-height windows | Convertible balconies for 3X light, ventilation & views

The Experience

30 World-class amenities | 7,100sq.ft. Grand clubhouse | 3,200 sq.ft. Rooftop swimming pool with elevated city & sea views

The Details

Luxury specifications, from Italian marble flooring to designer bathware fittings | Grand main doors with digital door locks | 2,000+ quality checks for lasting precision

TYPE	SIZE
3 BHK	2192 - 2665 sft.
4 BHK	2784 - 3101 sft.
DUPLEX	4677 sft.

AVAILABLE UNITS: 73
UNITS SOLD: 25

HANDOVER IN DEC 2029

Scan for Walkthrough

Scan for Location Map

CREDAI

98848 30000

EXCLUSIVE SITE VISIT AVAILABLE

PROMOTER ADDRESS: NPL DEVI, NEW NO. 111, LB ROAD, THIRUVANMIYUR, CHENNAI 600041

CASAGRAND
building aspirations

Casagrand Premier Builder Limited is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offer of its equity shares and has filed a draft red herring prospectus ("DRHP") with the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"). The DRHP is available on the website of our Company, at www.casagrand.co.in, the SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in as well as on the websites of the book running lead managers Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited and DAM Capital Advisors Limited at www.motilaloswalgroup.com and www.damcapital.in respectively, and the websites of the stock exchange(s) at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com, respectively. Any potential investor should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see "Risk Factors" of the RHP, when available. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI for making any investment decision.
The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended ("U.S. Securities Act") or any other applicable law of the United States and, unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are being offered and sold outside the United States in "offshore transactions" as defined in and in compliance with Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdiction where those offers and sales occur.

A CH-CHE

Will Madurantakam fall to TVK's popularity this bypoll?

Maragatham Kumaravel won the constituency, an AIADMK bastion, for the party in 2021 and 2026 despite the DMK and the TVK emerging victorious in those elections. She now seeks re-election as the TVK's candidate after resigning as AIADMK MLA barely three weeks after the 2026 result; while some voters are undecided, some say they may not vote for the TVK despite the CM's popularity

Saptarshi Bhattacharya
CHENNAI

In the 2021 Assembly election, the ruling AIADMK was swept away by a DMK wave in the KTCC districts (Kancheepuram, Tiruvallur, Chengalpattu, and Chennai), barring one single seat – Madurantakam.

Maragatham Kumaravel, a seasoned AIADMK leader and a Lok Sabha member for the party during 2014-2019, stood tall among the ruins. She regained the seat in the 2026 election amid a TVK wave in the region, giving rise to claims that it was an AIADMK bastion.

New avatar

Then came the twist. Barely three weeks after the declaration of results, Ms. Maragatham, along with five of her colleagues, resigned from the Assembly and joined the TVK. She is now recast as the TVK candidate for the Madurantakam by-election scheduled for October 6.

On Friday, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay held a four-and-a-half-hour-long roadshow in the constituency.

People lined up in large numbers all along the route, which criss-crossed the constituency touching about three dozen villages.

If the turnout of people translates to votes for the party, the TVK would win. But often, what is apparent isn't real, warns Ashok, a grocery store owner in Ayyanar Nagar. "Not all those who gather at Vijay's rallies would vote for TVK. I went there too to catch a glimpse of him but I may not vote for them," he states.

PMK's role

In the course of a chat, Mr. Ashok lets out a crucial fact that could well decide the fate of the election: the PMK's position.

The party had announced that it would stay neutral during the by-elections, after a fallout with its alliance partner AIADMK over the choice of candidates. While there are unconfirmed reports of possible backchannel negotiations between the PMK and the TVK, Mr. Ashok says that the supporters on ground aren't aware of what the party's stand is as yet. "Last two elections (2021 and 2026), the PMK was in alliance with AIADMK and the candidate won. So, whoever the PMK supports will have an advantage," he asserts.

Final push: TVK president and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay taking part in a roadshow on Friday, seeking support for the party's candidate Maragatham Kumaravel, ahead of the by-election in the Madurantakam Assembly constituency. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

There may be some meat in this argument, especially since Vanniyars, the prime support base of the PMK, constitute more than 30% of the electorate. They are the largest group after the Scheduled Caste communities, which constitute a little over 40% of the electorate. Madurantakam is a constituency reserved for Scheduled Caste (SC) candidates.

As campaigning draws to a close on Sunday evening, the Opposition candidates seem to have strung a common tune: the election has been forced upon the people of Madurantakam.

P. Suganthi, the CPI(M) candidate, said that people voted for the TVK with the hope of a change, but the switchover of AIADMK MLAs soon after the election showed that the party wasn't much different from the BJP at the Centre.

The Opposition candidates seem to have strung a common tune: the election has been forced upon the people of Madurantakam

On her campaign trail on Friday, she encountered unsavoury comments from DMK supporters in Athimanam village, perhaps an indication of tensions between the two former alliance partners.

'Voters betrayed'

Taking a similar stand, B. Valarmathi, former AIADMK Minister, said that the people of the constituency felt betrayed with the resignation of Ms. Maragatham within 21 days of the declaration of results.

S. Kanitha Sampath, the AIADMK candidate, recalled the days when she helped Ms. Maragatham during her electoral debut in the 2014 Lok Sabha elections, and said that people will respond to her "betrayal" on October 6.

'Unnecessary election'

I. Paranthamen, the DMK candidate, said this was an unnecessary election thrust on the people in an undemocratic way and they would respond wisely. "People are angry. They are reeling from price rise, increase in electricity tariff, and change of terms of the rural employment guarantee scheme," he maintained.

Close to the bus stand, a group of white-clad individuals, adorning red stoles, went about distributing pamphlets. They were members of the United Communist Party of India (UCPI) and were canvassing for votes for the DMK. "Though from the Left ecosystem, we are not with the CPI and the CPI(M), and believe that the DMK is the only powerful ally to take on the might of communal forces in Tamil Nadu," said UCPI State secretary Bhaskaran.

While campaigning was in its last leg, 72-year-old Babyamma sat under a banyan tree in Mettupalayam watching the rigmarole. Asked who would she vote for, she said that she hasn't made up her mind, although she had voted for *irattai ilai* (two leaves, the poll symbol of AIADMK) in the past. Asked if she liked Chief Minister Vijay, she replied, "He came [to power] and prices went up."

'Govt. will stand by Kavin's family until justice is secured'

The Hindu Bureau
THOOTHUKUDI

Minister for Social Justice Vani Arasu on Saturday said that the government would continue its legal battle and stand with the affected people, until they get justice, and not merely a verdict. He made the remarks while addressing the media in Arumugamangalam here, along with the parents of caste killing victim C. Kavin Selvaganesh.

Kavin's parents had been protesting in front of their house for the past three days condemning the quashing of the final report against the parents of prime accused S. Surjith in the murder case.

Addressing the media, the Minister and VCK MLA said Surjith's father and mother, who were involved in Kavin's murder, are police officers. "Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi had been continuously demanding their arrest. His mother Krishnakumari was not arrested. We continued to raise the demand, and it was only after this government came to power that she was arrested."

He noted that it was a big shock that they (Surjith's parents) had been discharged from the chargesheet. He pointed out that Law Minister C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar had said that an appeal would be filed on behalf of the State government.

Kavin's mother Tamilselvi said, "Since Mr. Arasu gave us an assurance, we have accepted his request and are calling off the protest."

MLA drives bus without valid licence; govt. to conduct probe

The Hindu Bureau
VELLORE

The Transport Department will conduct an inquiry into an incident in which K.V. Kuppam TVK MLA E. Thendral Kumar was seen driving a TNSTC bus at the new terminus here, during the launch of the 'Vettri Payanam' scheme on Friday.

The action comes in the wake of public outcry after a video of the incident went viral on social media. The video showed Mr. Kumar driving the government bus with around 30 commuters in Vellore, after the launch of the scheme by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at Koyambedu bus terminus in Chennai.

"As per norms, only those drivers who have a licence to drive heavy vehicles are eligible to drive buses. A probe will be conducted," said a transport official.

K.V. Kuppam MLA E. Thendral Kumar inside a TNSCTC bus at the terminus in Vellore town.

"It was scary, as the bus that was driven by the MLA was moving faster at the terminus where many commuters, including women and children, were waiting to board buses," said a commuter.

Initial inquiry revealed that after the District Collector flagged off the buses, Mr. Kumar volunteered to drive the vehicle on the premises of the terminus, from the main entrance to a distance of around 100 metres. In the video, he was reportedly seen asking the bus driver about operating the gears.

Transport officials said that licence holders of light vehicles were eligible to drive only cars, maxi cabs, vans, and tractors.

Penalty clause

"Mr. Kumar might not have had the required licence and badge to drive heavy vehicles like buses. As a result, the violation will attract a penalty," said a transport official.

As per norms, such a violation by the driver will attract a fine of ₹5,000 under the Motor Vehicles Act (MVA), 1988. A fine of ₹10,000 will be imposed on the owner of the vehicle. Transport officials said necessary action will be taken based on the findings of the probe.

9 Rameswaram fishermen held by Sri Lankan Navy on poaching charge

The Hindu Bureau
RAMESWARAM

Nine fishermen from Thangachimadam in Ramanathapuram district, who had ventured into sea for fishing, were arrested by the Sri Lankan Navy personnel on charges of poaching on Saturday.

Fisheries Department officials said they had issued tokens to 339 mechanised trawlers. On Saturday, the Sri Lankan Navy personnel, who were on surveillance, claimed that a mechanised trawler had indulged in poaching. After a mid-sea interrogation, they detained the vessel and nine fishermen with the catch.

Community leader Jesu Raja said the Centre should immediately intervene to ensure their release.

The names of the arrested fishermen were given as Mathias, 22; Mobis, 21; Abisten, 27; Antony Bruts, 42; Episton, 29; Steevenson, 22; John Jason, 24; Antony Pradeep, 26; and Subartan, 24. The boat owner was identified as Edin.

Two held for posing as railway staff, robbing passenger near Perambur

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Two men were arrested for allegedly posing as railway employees, luring passengers with promises of reserved tickets, and robbing them at secluded spots near Perambur.

The accused were identified as Ajit Bhagat, 21, and Sanjeev Kumar, 32, both from Bihar.

The police said Rupesh Kumar, 24, arrived at the Perambur railway station on September 4 to travel to Bihar.

The accused allegedly offered to help him secure a reserved ticket. They took Rupesh to Bandar Garden in Perambur, where they threatened him and fled with gold jewellery worth around ₹2.5 lakh, a mobile phone, and ₹7,000 in cash.

The police suspect the duo may have targeted passengers from northern States in at least four similar incidents.

Timings
CHENNAI

SUNDAY, OCT. 04		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:57
RISE	00:00	SET 13:15
MONDAY, OCT. 05		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:57
RISE	00:56	SET 14:07
TUESDAY, OCT. 06		
RISE	05:59	SET 17:56
RISE	01:56	SET 14:54

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	35	24
Chennai Airport	35	27
Chennai City	34	26

Chennai Airport Today
37°C The weather will be dry. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night will also be uneasy.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
38°C The weather will be dry. Day will be slightly hot and uneasy. Night will also be comfortable.

© Copyright Skymet Weather 2026
All rights reserved.

THE HINDU
DISCLAIMER: Readers are requested to verify and make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

idco Your power to grow | ODISHA NEW OPPORTUNITIES
ISO 9001 & 14001 Corporation

File No. HO/Civil/T&E-E-5298/01/2025 28106, Dt.23/09/2026
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (CIVIL)-III,
IDCO, IDCO TOWER, BHUBANESWAR
Bid Identification No.Civil/EST/30/26-27

NOTICE INVITING TENDER UNDER NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement

1. Name of the Work : Construction of Swimming Pool in the district of Malkangiri, Odisha.
2. Value of the Work : Rs.1716.00 Lakhs (Approx.)
3. Period of completion : 12 (Twelve) Calendar Months
4. Availability of tender online for Bidding :
   i. Start Date : 18:00 Hours of dt. 05.10.2026
   ii. End Date : 17:00 Hours of dt. 26.10.2026
   iii. Opening date : 11.30 Hours of dt. 27.10.2026.

Tender details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: www.tendersorissa.gov.in. Corrigendum or Addendum if any will not be published in newspapers and can be seen in e-procurement portal as well as in IDCO website.

Chief General Manager (Civil), IDCO, Bhubaneswar
4001/344/2627 OIPR-4001/4075/1/26-27/0124

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
Lokseva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
HE-SCH-PLAN-0037-2026/ 53052/HE., Bhubaneswar, Dated:03/10/2026

Corrigendum-II

NOTICE INVITING RFP FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION & COMMISSIONING OF LABORATORY EQUIPMENT & ITS ACCESSORIES FOR RAVENSHAW UNIVERSITY, KATAKA UNDER REGIONAL DIRECTORATE OF EDUCATION, BHUBANESWAR APPROVED UNDER PM-USHA

RFP No. PM-USHA:03/2026 Date: 31.08.2026

Sl. No.	RFP Cl.No.	Page No.	Description as per RFP	Modified vide Corrigendum I, dated 18.09.2026	Now Modified Provisions
1	DATA SHEET (Sl. No.7 & 8)	4	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 22/09/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 07/10/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 26/10/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)
2		4	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 24/09/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 08/10/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 27/10/2026 at 4:00 PM

All other terms and conditions of the RFP remain unchanged.

Joint Secretary to Govt. & SPD, RUSA/PM-USHA
11001/355/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0066

DELHI ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION
Viniyamak Bhawan, C-Block, Shivalik,
Malviya Nagar, New Delhi – 110 017
Telephone: No. : 41080416, 41080417

ADDENDUM TO RECRUITMENT NOTICE

In continuation of the Recruitment Notice published on 26.09.2026 by the Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission (DERC) for filling up key leadership and administrative positions through Deputation Basis only it is hereby notified that the following position is also added:

S. No.	Name of the Post	No. of Posts	Pay Level (7th CPC)	Pay Scale
17	Joint Director (Administration)	01	Level–13	₹1,23,100–2,15,900

For further details, such as eligibility, qualifications, experience and other terms & conditions of appointment including compensation, facilities etc. please refer to DERC website link https://www.derc.gov.in/regulations/management-and-development-human-resources-regulations and for submitting the application https://www.derc.gov.in/app/home/openings

The last date for submission of application is **26.10.2026.**

Sd/-
Prashasti De,
Dy. Director (Pers.) DERC

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0240/25-26

SHOP MORE! SAVE MORE! CELEBRATE MORE!

FURNITURE EXPO

BIGGEST DUSSEHRA FESTIVAL SALE UPTO 70% OFF

LAST 2 DAYS

2 | 3 | 4 | 5

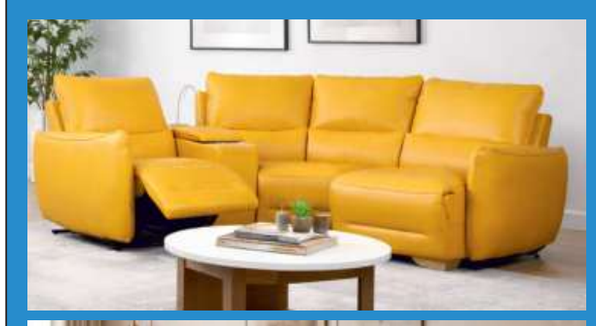
OCTOBER 2026

10.00 AM TO 8.30 PM

CHENNAI TRADE CENTRE

LOCATE US

NANDAMBAKKAM, CHENNAI



• LIVING ROOM • DINING SET • BEDROOM • OUTDOOR FURNITURE • HOME DECOR • BRASS & ARTIFACTS
• RECLINER SOFA SETS • CARPET & CUSHIONS • MATTRESSES • CURTAINS • WATER FOUNTAINS

www.iadsandevents.com exhibitions_iadsnevents iadsnevents ENTRY FREE +91 7448767203

AN EVENT BY iads & events COMPLETE BUSINESS SOLUTIONS

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

CORRIGENGUM

Ref.:- 1. E-TENDER NOTICE NO: NIT/14//26/34, Date: 18 AUGUST 2026.
2. CPR/SECR/10(26-27)/AN/360.
3. E-TENDER NOTICE NO: NIT/14//26/36, Date: 01 SEPTEMBER 2026.
4. CPR/SECR/10(26-27)/AN/387.

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Closing Date & Time	Read As	Qty	Remark
1.	05265088	24.09.2026 At 10:30 Hrs	09.10.2026 At 10:30 Hrs	3438 Kilometre	NIT-34 CPR/10/360
2.	05265015	09.10.2026 At 10:30 Hrs	27.10.2026 At 10:30 Hrs	590 Kilometre	NIT-36 CPR/10/387

Railways reserves the right to issue any Corrigendum to the tenders. Corrigendum & Important Notice to vendors may be seen in the link **www.ireps.gov.in**

CPR/10/PHI/432 *For Principal Chief Materials Manager/Bilaspur.*

South East Central Railway @secrail

MSME TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT CENTRE CHENNAI

Government of India Autonomous Body
CFTI, 65/1, G.S.T. Road, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032
3 Weekend Online Training Program on
Certified Professional Course on
Digital Marketing Expert with AI - Powered Tools

Date : 10th, 11th, 17th, 18th, 24th & 25th Oct. 2026 Time : 2.00 p.m. to 6.00. p.m.

Contents : Introduction to Digital Marketing, Understanding marketing fundamentals, 4Ps and the evolution from traditional to digital. Website Essentials, Basics of domains, hosting and website usability for a high performing digital presence. Installation, themes, plugins, widgets, and pre/post – launch optimization steps. SEO optimization, Algorithms, on-page /off-page SEO, and ranking improvement techniques. Social Media Mastery (SMO & SMM) – Building organic engagement and running paid campaigns across Facebook, Instagram. LinkedIn, and You Tube, Email & WhatsApp Marketing, Creating personalized communication strategies for audience engagement and retention. Content and Online PR, Impactful content, Storytelling, and managing SM relationships. Online Reputation Management (ORM), Monitoring brand perception and using tools to manage online. Digital Marketing Strategy & Tools, Crafting a strategy though audience insights, competitor research, creative planning, analytics, and AI tools, SEO Quake, MOZ, AHerfs. Wati.

COURSE FEE : Rs. 6,000/- (incl.GST) Fees to be paid throu' Online www.cftichennai.in Online Payment
Account No : 39868874350, IFSC Code : SBIN0000956, DIRECTOR, MSME TDC UPI ID : msmetdccfti@sbi

For Details Contact Mob : 95000 34831 / 96772 90237 / 98842 35327
Ph : 044 22501529 Ext : 27 E-Mail: msmetdc@cftichennai.in www.cftichennai.in

GOVT OF INDIA CERTIFICATE WILL BE ISSUED TO SUCCESSFUL CANDIDATES

INDIAN INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE

Bengaluru - 560012

MID YEAR ADMISSIONS 2026-27

"Applications are invited for Research Programmes [Ph.D.] and External Registration Programme [Ph.D.] at Indian Institute of Science".

For eligibility, areas of research, selection procedure, other details, and applying online, please visit our website: **www.iisc.ac.in/admissions.**

IMPORTANT DATES

Website opens for online submission of applications	06.10.2026
Last date of online submission of applications (website closes at 23:59 hours on 26.10.2026)	26.10.2026

Sd/-, REGISTRAR

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

Call our toll-free number 1800 102 1878
Or write to us at customercare@thehindu.co.in
Scan the QR code to register your feedback

THE HINDU thehindu businessline. FRONTLINE SPORTSTAR THE HINDU Young World THE HINDU

MSME TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT CENTRE CHENNAI

Government of India Autonomous Body
CFTI, 65/1, G.S.T. Road, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032
2 Weekend Online Training Program on
Certified Professional Course on
Income Tax Practitioner Training

Date : 10th, 11th, 17th & 18th October 2026 Time : 9.30 a.m. to 1.30. p.m.

Contents : Income Tax efiling Registration, Income Tax Login to efiling, efiling of ITR, income Tax Return Field, E-Verification efiling, Filing Tax Audit, Reports, Computation of Income Tax Filing, Return Filing of IncomeDigital Signature Certificate, efiling & forms,Rectification of ITR, Evalult and efiling Account, Report and Refund Reissue, HUF, Firms, Companies etc.., TCS and TDS Calculation, Recent Amendments in Budget, Capital Gain(LTCG, STCG) PGBP, Advance Tax, Response to various noticed issued by CPC, The New Income Tax Act 2025, Many More.

Trainer: Mr. V. ARANGANATHAN, Chartered Accountants

COURSE FEE : Rs. 5,900/- (incl.GST) Fees to be paid throu' Online www.cftichennai.in Online Payment
Account No : 39868874350, IFSC Code : SBIN0000956, DIRECTOR, MSME TDC UPI ID : msmetdccfti@sbi

For Details Contact Mob : 82201 03222 / 73051 03222 / 72005 26886
Ph : 044 22501529 Ext : 27 E-Mail: msmetdc@cftichennai.in www.cftichennai.in

GOVT OF INDIA CERTIFICATE WILL BE ISSUED TO SUCCESSFUL CANDIDATES

SIVANANDA SARASWATHI SEVASHRAM

HELP US FOR DEEPAVALI

SIVANANDA GURUKULAM
Home for Deserted Children & Senior Citizens • Since 1945

Help our children and senior citizens celebrate Deepavali. Share whatever you can: new clothes, sweets, bath oil, rice, wheat, food grains and eco-friendly crackers. **We thank you.**

Contribute Online
OUR UPI ID
BuildHope@HDFCbank

BY CHEQUE / DEMAND DRAFT
In favour of: **SIVANANDA SARASWATHI SEVASHRAM**
Send to:
Sivananda Gurukulam (Admin Office)
New No. 4, Old No. 20, Kambar Street,
East Tambaram, Chennai 600 059.

Credit / Debit Card • Netbanking • NEFT / RTGS / IMPS
www.BuildHope.org/donate • info@BuildHope.org
Your donations are exempt from Income Tax as per IT Act norms

SBI State Bank Of India

RBO3, No-27/8, Kaushikan Complex, Kamarajar Street, West Tambaram, Chennai-45.
Ph: 98845 08797, 96000 70941

PREMISES REQUIRED ON LEASE

State Bank of India invites tenders for commercial premises in the prescribed format for following branches in two bid system of ready built or under construction or proposed construction on lease rental basis preferably on the Ground floor with adequate parking facility. For further details, please visit Bank's website **https://sbi.bank.in** under **"SBI in the News: Procurement news".** The last date and time for submission of tender is **3.00p.m on 26.10.2026.** Corrigendum if any would be posted on the website only.

S.N	Name/Location of Branch	Approximate Carpet Area
1	Perungalathur Branch, Chennai	2750 sq.ft. (255 sq.m)
2	Zamin Pallavaram Branch, Chennai	2300 sq.ft.(214 sq.m)

Date: 04.10.2026 Regional Manager

DR. B.R. AMBEDKAR DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION

(A Govt. of Karnataka undertaking)
9th Floor, Vishveshwaraiah Mini Tower, Dr. Ambedkar Veedhi, Bengaluru - 560 001. Ph: 080-22868870, 22867097, 22865192
Fax : 080-22860396, e-mail : mdadcl2011@gmail.com

No:ADCL/FOODCART/TENDER/2026-27 Date:03.10.2026

TENDER NOTICATION
(Through KPP portal only) (Call-2)

The Managing Director, Dr. B. R. Ambedkar Development Corporation Limited, Bengaluru invites tender from interested Manufacturers(OEMs) for **Supply of EV Food Carts (Electrical Fast Food Truck Trailers / Mobile Kitchen, Food Kiosk) for the Beneficiaries under Self-employment - Entrepreneurship Scheme across Metro / Urban Cities in Karnataka for the year 2026-27** through e-procurement portal of Government of Karnataka **(https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in).**

Amount put to tender : **Rs. 63.05 Crores** and EMD Amount : **Rs. 63.00 Lakhs.**

Last date and time for submission of pre-bid queries: **08.10.2026 upto 17:00 Hrs.** Pre Bid Meeting Date and Time: **09.10.2026 at 11:30 Hrs.** Last date & Time for submission of Tender: **19.10.2026 upto 17:30 Hrs.** Date & Time of opening of Technical bid: **22.10.2026 at 11:30 Hrs.** Demonstration of offered Vehicles by Bidders and evaluation by the Technical Committee: **26.10.2026 at 11:30 Hrs.** Tentative Date & Time of opening of Commercial bid: **29.10.2026 at 11:30 Hrs.** Venue of pre-bid meeting, opening of tenders & address for communication: **Above Office Address.**

Prospective bidders willing to participate in this tender can download the bid documents after visiting the website: **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**

DIPR/CP/JA/3062/2026-27 **Sd/- General Manager(P&A)**

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform general public that Ashok Leyland Ltd has been accorded environmental clearance by State Environmental Impact Assessment Authority (SEIAA), Tamil Nadu vide EC Identification No. EC26C3806 TN5937011N Dated: 29/09/2026. for its Proposed Expansion of additional construction of an Industrial Building consisting of a Battery Pack Assembly Unit along with Existing Vehicle Testing Plant at Plot No. A-1/A, SIPCOT Industrial Park in Pillaipakkam Village, Sriperumbudur Taluk, Kanchipuram District Tamil Nadu under Category "B2" of Item 8(a) "Building & Construction Projects" of the Schedule to the EIA Notification, 2006. The copy of the environment clearance is available in the office of Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board (TNPCB) and can also be accessed on the website of SEIAA, TN. https://parivesh.nic.in/#/ec

M/s. Ashok Leyland Limited,
No. 1, Sardar Patel Road,
Guindy, Chennai District - 600 032

READ
FRONTLINE
LEADING THE DEBATE SINCE 1984
EVERY FORTNIGHT.
TO SUBSCRIBE, VISIT
www.thehindugroup.in/subscribe

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 15/-

Office of the Excise Commissioner
STATE EXCISE DEPARTMENT

2nd Floor, T.T.M.C. Building, 'A' Block, BMTC, Shantinagar, Bangalore-560 027.

No.: EXE/EAL/TENDER/01/2025-26(Part-1) Date: 03.10.2026

Short Term e-Tender Notification
(Two Cover System)

On behalf of the Govt. of Karnataka, Joint Commissioner of Excise (D&B), Office of the Excise Commissioner, Bengaluru invites e-Tender under KTPP Act 1999 and Rules made thereunder in Two Bid system from the eligible Manufacturers as stipulated in the tender document to Produce and Supply Paper-based Excise Adhesive Labels (EALs) as per the specifications and schedule of requirements mentioned in the tender document, by installing all the required infrastructure in the premises designated by the Excise Commissioner, State Excise Department, Govt. of Karnataka, Bengaluru. Tender fees & EMD is as per E-Procurement portal. The detailed tender document may be downloaded from website **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** for information. The bids shall be submitted through KPP Portal only. The details are given below.

1) Date of downloading of tender document: **05.10.2026, 10.00 a.m onwards. 2)** Pre-bid Meeting: **09.10.2026 at 11.30 a.m. 3)** Last date for online submission of tender: **19.10.2026 upto 5.30 p.m. 4)** Opening of technical bids: **22.10.2026 at 11.00 a.m.** The above office may be contacted for any clarification or further information.

Sd/-
Joint Commissioner of Excise (D&B) and Tender Inviting Authority

DIPR/CP/JA/3050/206-27

DIRECTORATE OF ENERGY, GOVERNMENT OF HIMACHAL PRADESH

MC PARKING BUILDING, 2ND FLOOR,
NEAR TUTIKANDI CROSSING SHIMLA-05
Telephone No. 0177-2673552 Email: ceenergy09@gmail.com

Notice Inviting Tender (NIT)

e-NIT No.: DOE/HPEMC/IT Tender/2026/6549 Dated:-01/10/2026

e-Procurement Notice Inviting Tender For Selection of Consulting Services For Design, Implementation And Commissioning Of Comprehensive Energy Portfolio Management Solution For Directorate of Energy (HPEMC), Shimla"

The Directorate of Energy (HPEMC), Government of Himachal Pradesh, invites online bids on National Competitive Bidding Basis through the Himachal Pradesh e-Procurement Portal from eligible and qualified consulting service providers for **Design, Implementation and Commissioning of a Comprehensive Energy Portfolio Management Solution** for the Directorate of Energy (HPEMC), Shimla. The selected Consultant shall be responsible for design, implementation, integration, commissioning and operationalization of the solution, including data management, analytics, reporting, training and technical support, as specified in the Bid Document.

The Bid Document shall be available on **https://hptenders.gov.in** from **05/10/2026 at 1700 Hours onwards** and may also be downloaded from the Directorate of Energy website. Bidders must possess a valid DSC and registration on the e-Procurement Portal. Tender Fee, EMD and other requirements shall be as specified in the Bid Document. The following schedule will be applicable for tender process as under:-

Sr. No.	Description	Date	Time
1.	Start Date of sale of RFP Document	05/10/2026	1700 Hours onwards
2.	Pre-Bid Meeting	23/10/2026	1100 Hours onwards
3.	Bid Submission Start Date	03/11/2026	1100 Hours onwards
4.	Last date for sale of RFP Document	20/11/2026	upto 1159 Hours
5.	Bid Submission End Date	20/11/2026	upto 1600 Hours
6.	Technical Bid Opening	21/11/2026	at 1500 Hours onwards

The Financial Bid Opening and e-Reverse Auction date shall be intimated separately. For any clarification, the Additional Director/Dy. Chief Engineer,Directorate of Energy, Government of Himachal Pradesh, may be contacted at Telephone No. 0177-2673552 or through email at dir.doehp@nic.in/ceenergy09@gmail.com.

HP / 1038/2026-2027 **Additional Director DoE GoHP, Shimla-05.**

idco ODISHA

Your power to grow NEW OPPORTUNITIES
ISO 9001 & 14001 Corporation

File No. HO/Civil/T&E-E-5297/01/2025 28116, Dt.23/09/2026

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (CIVIL)-III, IDCO, IDCO TOWER, BHUBANESWAR

Bid Identification No.Civil/EST/31/26-27

NOTICE INVITING TENDER UNDER NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement

1. Name of the Work : Construction of Swimming Pool in the district of Nabarangpur, Odisha.
2. Value of the Work : Rs.2022.00 Lakhs (Approx.)
3. Period of completion : 12 (Twelve) Calendar Months
4. Availability of tender online for Bidding :
   i. Start Date : 18:00 Hours of dt. 06.10.2026
   ii. End Date : 17:00 Hours of dt. 27.10.2026
   iii. Opening date : 11.30 Hours of dt. 28.10.2026.

Tender details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: **www.tendersorissa.gov.in.** Corrigendum or Addendum if any will not be published in newspapers and can be seen in **e-procurement portal** as well as in **IDCO website.**

Chief General Manager (Civil), IDCO, Bhubaneswar

4001/345/2627 OIPR-4001/4075/1/26-27/0125

MSME TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT CENTRE CHENNAI

Government of India Autonomous Body
CFTI, 65/1, G.S.T. Road, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032
Certified Professional Course on
LEAN SIX SIGMA CERTIFICATION
AI POWERED WORKSHOPS

COURSE	FEES (incl GST)	CLASSROOM TRAINING DATES
YELLOW BELT	₹ 5,900	10 & 11 October 2026 (WEEK END)
GREEN BELT	₹ 17,700	10, 11, 17 & 18 October 2026 (WEEK END)
BLACK BELT	₹ 29,500	10, 11, 17, 18, 24, & 25 October 2026 (WEEK END)

COURSE	FEES (incl GST)	ONLINE TRAINING DATES
ROOT CAUSE ANALYST	₹ 2,950	12, 13, 14, 15 & 16 October 2026 (WEEK DAY)
LEAN CHAMPION	₹ 7,375	14,15,16,21,22 & 23 October 2026 (WEEK DAY)
5S AUDITOR	₹ 7,375	18, 19, 20, 25, 26 & 28 November 2026 (WEEK DAY)
YELLOW BELT	₹ 2,950	31 October | 1, 14 & 15 November 2026 (WEEK END)
GREEN BELT	₹ 14,750	31 Oct | 1, 14,15, 21 & 22 Nov | 5 & 6 Dec 2026 (WEEK END)
BLACK BELT	₹ 22,125	31 October | 1, 14,15, 21 & 22 November | 5, 6, 12, 13, 19 & 20 December 2026 (WEEK END)

Timings : Classroom : 10.00 AM - 5.30 PM, Online : 07 PM - 10 PM Weekday Online : 8.00 PM - 10 PM
Classroom Venue: CFTI Block, 65/1, G.S.T Road, Guindy, Chennai – 32

LEAD TRAINER: **Prof. Dr.Gopal Sivakumar,**
M.E.,Ph.D.,CSSMBB, 20+ Years Exp. Founder & CEO , Vision Excellence

Call us for In-House Training Requirements:
APQP, PPAP, FMEA, SPC, MSA, 7 QC TOOLS, KAIZEN, 5S, POKA YOKE, MINITAB, QFD, DoE
Fees to be Paid through online www.cftichennai.in | Account No: 39868874350, IFSC Code: SBIN0000956, Director, MSME TDC
›› Group Registration Offer Available for Corporates ‹‹

For More Details Contact 90878 88225 | 88381 65936
044 22501529 EXT 27 msmetdc@cftichennai.in

AYUDHA POOJA & DIWALI Orders Accepted

Ps4 Perambur Sri Srinivasa Sweets & Snacks
TRADITION SINCE 1981

Now Open @
GST ROAD
TAMBARAM SANATORIUM

Sweets & Snacks Pan India Delivery
Chennai | Thiruninravur | Tiruvallur | Tirupati
Festival Orders Booking Contact
78248 87732 / 92824 44888 / 89398 78733 / 89398 78735
perambur_sri_srinivasa perambur sri srinivasa Mail : info@perambursrinivasa.com www.perambursrinivasa.com

A CH-CHE

From Page One

Veeramani booked in yet another POCSO case

The petition also questions how Mr. Regupathy came to comment publicly on the quality of the video evidence in the case.

On August 29, the Immoral Trafficking Prevention Unit of the CCB arrested Veeramani on charges of sexual assaults on a minor girl, while his associates – Shanthi, 60, and Mahendra Simhan, 63 – were arrested for abetting the industrialist in the offences.

Following the order of the special court for POCSO cases, the investigation picked up pace from August. Subsequently, a fourth accused – Ganesan, who worked for 23 years at Gem Granites, was arrested on September 22 for having an obscene video of Veeramani with a minor girl on his mobile phone and failing to report it to the police. The first case was registered in October 2025 over the alleged sexual assault of a minor in 2019, followed by another POCSO case concerning an alleged sexual assault in 2024. The third case relates to the alleged sexual abuse of a Class 11 student before her suicide in 2004. The fourth case was registered on September 30 involving a minor girl.

(Assistance for overcoming suicidal thoughts is available on the State's health helpline 104 and Sneha's suicide prevention helpline 044-2464 0050)

INBRIEF

Vijay lauds India men's cricket team for Asian Games gold

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Saturday congratulated the India men's cricket team for winning the gold medal at the ongoing 20th Asian Games in Japan. In a post on X, Mr. Vijay congratulated Tamil Nadu cricketer Washington Sundar, who is part of the team. In recognition of Mr. Sundar's achievement, the Tamil Nadu government will provide him with an incentive of ₹75 lakh. His success will inspire and instil confidence among the younger generation, he added.

CM, Ministers condemn Stalin over his comments against TVK's Dharapuram candidate

TVK lodges a complaint against the DMK president with the Election Commission, says the remarks that were made while campaigning for the byelection amounted to body-shaming

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI/COIMBATORE

C. Joseph Vijay

K.G. Arunraj

Rajmohan

Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) president and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Saturday condemned DMK president M.K. Stalin for his alleged body-shaming remarks about TVK candidate for the Dharapuram byelection, P. Sathyabama.

During an election campaign on Friday, Mr. Stalin criticised Ms. Sathyabama for switching from the AIADMK to the TVK, asking, "How did she manage to do a somersault with her body?" The remark drew widespread criticism from TVK leaders.

In a post on X, Mr. Vijay accused Mr. Stalin of body-shaming Ms. Sathyabama and "taking pleasure" from it. He said Mr. Stalin had "admitted and taken pride" that he was the one who created the DMK's "*aabasa nadhi* [river of obscenity], *vanma nadhi* [river of hatred], and *vakkira nadhi* [river of perversion]."

'DMK anti-democratic'

"The DMK is anti-democratic. The people of Tamil Nadu have long been aware that obscenity, violence, and perversity are embedded in the DNA of the DMK. People of Tamil Nadu will certainly give an appropriate response to this 'evil force' that is adept at making obscene remarks about women," he said. Several Ministers in the TVK-led government have also condemned Mr. Stalin for his remarks.

Health Minister K.G. Arunraj said Mr. Stalin insulted women, especially from Scheduled Castes, with his body-shaming remarks. He said Mr. Stalin's comments were against political decorum and demanded a public apology.

Minister for Energy Resources and Law C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar claimed that DMK leaders had made it a practice to repeatedly make derogatory remarks about women. He said Mr. Stalin's alleged body-shaming remarks were the height of frustration and were strongly condemnable. "This is the true face of the DMK, which delivers long speeches on feminism and the revolutionary ideas of its ideological leaders. The people have clearly understood this, and the DMK will no longer receive public support," Mr. Kumar said while speaking to reporters in Coimbatore. He added: "We are criticising the DMK as an 'evil force' because it is a party that is harmful to society. The DMK cannot ask people to vote for Mr. Stalin or Mr. Udhayanidhi, and it cannot cite any good work it has done."

"Is making derogatory remarks about women what the DMK's politics is all about?" asked Minister for School Education Rajmohan. "Insulting remarks about women do not affect only individuals; they demean the self-respect and dignity of women as a whole. If you think that insulting women on the political stage will earn applause, that is not a victory in politics but a decline in political culture," he said.

Minister for Industries S. Keerthana said it was truly disheartening to hear such remarks from someone who had held the highest office in the State.

"When the guardian of the party himself makes such statements, what can we expect from the rest of the DMK leadership? Repeatedly making derogatory remarks about women in public forums and attempting to demean their dignity is absolutely condemnable," she said.

Ministers T.K. Prabhu, Vanni Arasu, M. Vijay Balaji, R. Vinoth, and D. Logesh Tamilselvan also condemned Mr. Stalin for alleged body-shaming of Ms. Sathyabama. BJP leader Vanathi Srinivasan also condemned Mr. Stalin, saying the DMK has not learnt any lessons from its recent defeats.

Star campaigner status

Meanwhile, the TVK also lodged a complaint against Mr. Stalin with the Election Commission. In his complaint to Chief Electoral Officer Archana Patnaik, TVK's general secretary (election campaign management) and Minister for Public Works Aadhav Arjuna said Mr. Stalin's remarks amounted to violation of Model Code of Conduct.

He demanded that the star campaigner status given to Mr. Stalin be cancelled immediately and urged the Election Commission to direct the District Returning Officer to lodge a First Information Report against him under the provisions of Tamil Nadu Prohibition of Harassment of Women Act, 1998.

Later, while speaking to the media at Secretariat, Mr. Arjuna said the DMK was unable to digest the victory of the TVK and had been indulging in personal attacks, particularly targeting women.

Strengthening ties: Leaders of the INDIA bloc at the meeting held at Sathyamurthy Bhavan in Chennai on Saturday. PTI

TVK formally joins INDIA bloc; set to join demonstrations against BJP and EC

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The various Tamil Nadu leaders of the Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) met at the Tamil Nadu Congress Committee's (TNCC) headquarters in Chennai on Saturday and formally welcomed the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) into the alliance, led by the Congress nationally. The meeting was chaired by TNCC president B. Manickam Tagore.

At the meeting, it was also decided that 'Save Democracy' protests would be organised at the district headquarters across Tamil Nadu on October 13 and 14 to highlight the issues surrounding the breakdown of democracy in India. Additionally, a protest will be held on October 15, in which INDIA bloc leaders will participate in Chennai.

Mr. Tagore said the TVK's general secretary (Election Management) and PWD Minister Aadhav Arjuna; MDMK chief Vaiko; VCK chief Thol. Thirumavalavan; CPI(M)'s State secretary P. Shanmugam; IUML's K.A.M. Muhammed Abubacker; and CPI(ML) leader Chandra Mohan participated in the meeting. Other leaders, such as State Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson; Congress leaders K.V. Thangkabalu and K.S. Alagiri; State Higher Education Minister P. Viswanathan; VCK treasurer S.S. Balaji; Congress MP Praveen Chakravarty; Tiruvallur MP Sasikanth Senthil; and Congress MLA Tharahai Cuthbert were also present.

Asked if the DMK was invited to be a part of the meeting, Mr. Tagore said, "Everyone fighting the RSS-BJP's rule can be a part of the INDIA bloc. We need to have a political understanding that Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Amit Shah are destroying the democracy in India. Our leaders have reached out to parties who should have come today, but I cannot talk about those who did not attend."

"You have been asking why the TVK was not participating in INDIA bloc meetings. Now, it has joined the alliance. Its leaders have said that they are ready to protest and burn the effigy of Gyanesh Kumar," he said.

"INDIA bloc is strong in Tamil Nadu. We are going to oppose the RSS, BJP, and Gyanesh Kumar," he added.

Dharapuram farmers unhappy over govt.'s approach on crop loan waiver

T. Ramakrishnan
DHARAPURAM

The State government's approach towards the implementation of the waiver scheme of crop loans extended by primary agricultural cooperative societies has left many farmers in Dharapuram of Tiruppur district unhappy.

K.M. Ramasamy, a senior functionary of an association of farmers which, according to him, does not owe allegiance to any political party, complains that the couple of changes made by the government in the waiver scheme have only created more confusion among the agriculturists, and unnecessarily created false expectations among the farming community, even though he appreciates that the government has its own constraints.

One of the poll promises of the TVK was that a 100% crop loan waiver would be given to small and marginal farmers.

In contrast to the electoral promise of the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) that a 100% waiver would be given to small and marginal farmers (with up to five acres of land), who took loans from primary agricultural cooperative societies, and 50% waiver to others, the TVK regime had, initially, announced a full waiver up to ₹50,000.

Subsequently, it revised the waiver for loans up to ₹75,000 availed of by farmers, irrespective of the size of their landholdings.

One more change was made by providing a maximum waiver of ₹75,000 for those who had obtained loans in the range of ₹75,000-₹1,00,000 and a maximum waiver of ₹35,000 for those who took loans exceeding ₹1 lakh.

Referring to the coverage of the loans given between May 2025 and February 2026, Mr. Ramasamy wonders about the exclusion of March 2026 as it is, invariably, during the month that a large number of crop loans get sanctioned.

Besides, those who repaid loans up to June 19 have not been given any relief. All pensioners of the Central and State governments have been excluded from the coverage and this norm should be changed by introducing an income limit.

'Include dairy farmers'

N. Natarajan, another farmer of the constituency, points out that in the western districts, farmers take loans for the purchase of milch cows. The loan waiver scheme should include such farmers also, as animal husbandry and dairy sectors come under the overall agricultural sector.

Senior officials looking after policy formulation have not replied to the messages sent by *The Hindu* on the issues raised by the farmers.

A corporate mafia government has been ruling the State, alleges Stalin

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president and former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin on Saturday alleged that a "corporate mafia government", controlled by an unidentified individual, was ruling Tamil Nadu.

"Really, it is a mysterious government. There is no transparency and everything is being decided behind the scenes," he said while campaigning for DMK candidate I. Paranthaman in the Madurantakam Assembly constituency.

Mr. Stalin said the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), which had promised to provide a clean government, had inducted former AIADMK Ministers facing corruption cases into the party after "washing" them in "washing machines". "Can a government that cancelled the Parandur Airport Project be called a clean government? They sought to hand over Chennai airport to private operators and covered up the letter written to the Prime Minister. Is this a clean government?" he asked. He alleged that a "mafia" had taken control of the government with the intention of diverting investments to Andhra Pradesh.

M.K. Stalin

Mr. Stalin also criticised Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay for not taking a position on the demand by several political parties, barring the BJP and its allies, for the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and their protests over the issue. "Over 13 crore people have been denied their voting rights, and in many States, the outcome of the election has been stolen. Can a person who does not express his opinion on these issues be called a political leader?" he said.

Mr. Stalin said the "real face" of the TVK would soon be exposed and people would come to know who was in a "secret alliance" with the BJP at the Centre. Those who had joined the TVK too would eventually be "left in the lurch", he said. He asserted that the DMK's "only mistake" was that it had failed to take the TVK seriously. "We fought our ideological enemies and remained indifferent to the crowd of clowns," he said.

He also attributed the DMK's defeat in the Assembly election to the loss of votes caused by the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Mr. Stalin rejected the claim that there had been a wave in favour of the TVK. "If there had been a wave, it could have won at least 150 seats. It could not secure even 118 seats and formed the government with the support of political parties that were part of the DMK alliance," he said.

Palaniswami slams TVK regime for claiming to be 'corruption-free'

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Saturday questioned the claim of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK)-led government about providing a corruption-free regime.

Addressing electors at Achirapakkam in Madurantakam constituency, where the bypoll is scheduled to be held on October 6, Mr. Palaniswami alleged that ₹70 was being collected for a bag of paddy at direct purchase centres. Referring to searches conducted by the Directorate of Vigilance and Anti-Corruption (DVAC) at many government offices in the last five months, he contended that the DVAC itself had gone on record that unaccounted for money to the tune of ₹1.7 crore had been seized. Given this backdrop, he asked whether the current dispensation was a "clean regime".

While gross collections of GST rose in September at the national level, Tamil Nadu had recorded a decline in collections. "How is the government going to correct the situation? Already, the loans outstanding have reached ₹ 10 lakh crore," he added.

TVK has 'forced' byelections on the people: Udhayanidhi

Scathing attack: Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin campaigning in the Dharapuram Assembly constituency on Saturday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The Hindu Bureau
DHARAPURAM

In a no-holds-barred attack, DMK youth wing secretary and Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin, during his byelection campaign in Dharapuram on Saturday, framed the sobriquet 'Cheating Minister' for Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, a day after his father and former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin used the term 'Cheap Minister'.

Reiterating that the byelection had been "forced" on the people within months of the Assembly polls by the Chief Minister by "buying out a pliable group of AIADMK MLAs", Mr. Udhayanidhi said a "sobbing drama" was enacted by TVK candidate P. Sathyabama in the Chief Minister's presence in Dharapuram recently. It was the voters who actually had to cry for having elected a "traitor", he charged.

Mr. Udhayanidhi said the TVK, after accusing the DMK and AIADMK of bribing voters, appeared to be buying out MLAs as a "better option". He said the Chief Minister, after claiming to have left cinema at the peak of his career, was now providing "tiffin carriers containing money to the voters".

He said the steep increase in the costs of rice, sugar, tamarind, cooking oil, chilli, and garlic over the last four months had hit the people hard. The people were suffering due to daily power cuts that lasted for eight hours, he added.

Classifieds

thehinduads.com

LIFE MADE SIMPLE

THE HINDU

SITUATIONS VACANT

INDEX OF SITUATIONS VACANT

ACCOUNTS & FINANCE
BPO
COURIER
COMPUTER/ INFO. TECH.
DETECTIVE/ SECURITY SERVICES
ENGG./PRODN./ TECHNICAL
GARMENTS
HOTEL
HOUSE KEEPING
HRD & ADMN.
INSURANCE
LOGISTICS
MARKETING & SALES
MEDICAL
MEDICAL TRANSCRIPTION
OVERSEAS
PLACEMENT CONSULTANTS
PRINTING/ E-PUBLISHING
PUBLIC APPOINTMENTS
R & D/ LAB
SECRETARIAL
SHIPPING & CARGO
SKILLED LABOUR
STORES/ PURCHASE
TRAINING & PLACEMENT ASSISTANCE
WALK-IN
GENERAL

FINANCE

WANTED MIDDLE aged office manager for CA firm. Apply to sviswaca@gmail.com

Wanted: Experienced Candidate for GST, Income Tax Return Filling & Accounts Finalization for Audit Office. Phone: 9840242529.

WANTED ACCOUNTANT – Male / Female, Qual: CA, CA Inter. Age below 50yrs. Good Salary @ Kolathur Senthil Nagar. in & Around 15km. 9629333000

WANTED TALLY well Experience Person for Package industry Nr. Thiruvallur Ct: 9884168377/ 9443215053/ 9884499916/ chennaiindustries@gmail.com

GENERAL

REQ 1.TENDER Quotation Executive (MBA Gem Tender Exp), 2.Accounts Assistant 3. Stores Assistant. Interested candidates (Married Women only) Send Resume WhatsApp: 9361674840

REQUIRED A Male Assistant Manager, below 50 years, to manage a Men's Luxury PG in OMR, Chennai. Accommodation and Food provided. Good Salary. Contact: 98842 90097 Email – devsecurestaychennai@gmail.com

GENERAL

FEMALE RECEPTIONIST Wanted for Convention Center @ KK Nagar 8248510213

KNOWN CO Chrompet Want Rtd Sr. citzn M/F Ex.Sermen Age26–75. 7358621949

STENO GRAPHER Typewriting Req Highcourt Chambers 9841017177, 9941005790

REQ 50+ M/F 15+Yrs Exp Deg Must for Reputed Banking Sector. 8015314663

WANTED M/F Part / Full Time Sal+ PF & ESI + Attractive Inc 84282 46969

WANTED SALES executive/ Merchandiser with knowledge of textiles with minimum of 5 yrs exp Chetpet chennai– 600031 Ct: Theerth Raj gdjdchennai@gmail.com

WANTED TRAINER / Admn. Manager / App. Developer for a new SSC / Bank Exam coaching institute, Chennai. Ct: 9940907780

VRS /RETD /House Wives RPD Channel – Immediate Requirement Salary + INCENTIVE + Promotion Ct: 86673 82657

WANTED TELE Caller Work from home Tamil & Malayalam Computer knowledge Must, Sunday Working Ct:6381241334

WANTED

PROJECT MANAGER - CONSTRUCTION
Graduate in **Civil/Structural Engineering with 10+ years experience** in residential building construction. Experience in coordinating with **Design Consultants, Contractors Procurement & Project Teams** and handling **project execution.** Should have experience in **leading project teams.**

SITE ENGINEER
Minimum **5 years experience** in handling **site works**

ADMIN MANAGER
Graduate with **5-10 years' relevant experience.** Knowledge of **ESI, PF, statutory compliances & mandatory licences.** Experience in **office administration, maintenance of attendance & staff coordination.** Strong **communication, interpersonal and team management skills essential.**

SENIOR MANAGER - ACCOUNTS
Graduate/Post Graduate in Commerce with **10+ years relevant experience,** preferably in **property development**. Expertise in **GST, TDS, receivables & payables.** Should have experience in **leading and managing an Accounts team.**

ACCOUNTS ASSISTANT
Graduate/B.Com with **5+ years' experience.** Good knowledge of **Tally, bookkeeping, petty cash, office accounts and Bank reconciliation.** Knowledge of **banking operations** essential.

hr@deccan.co.in

DECCAN ESTATES PVT. LTD.

HOTELS

WANTD–STAFF FOR Restaurant Purasaivakkam Chn. Admin/BILLING/SUPERVISOR/Store/Coffe Master/Housekeeping CT. 7418036677

HRD ADMN

GLOBE DETECTIVE AGENCY (P) LTD., 152, Mount Road, Chennai – 600 002 Ph: No. 044 – 42919500 Wanted – Accounts / Executive – B.Com, Computer Knowledge & Tally. Typist cum Clerk – any Degree with Computer knowledge / Typing – Freshers / Retired Personnel also welcome. WALK – IN.

SITUATION VACANT: HRD Female Admin. Wanted Office Executive. Any degree. Contact: sureshkumar@instrulab.in

MARKETING

STAFF WANTED– APPAREL Industry– Chennail. Need Smart Salesman + Excel Master + Ready to Travel. Location: Shenoy Nagar, Chennai. Package: Rs.5 Lakhs per annum. Ct: 9600193328

We are Looking for 1. Civil Engineering Supervisor. 2. Looking for Marketing Persons. Contact: 9840942784

We are looking for smart and energetic Marketing Executives
to handle marketing activities across South India.
Requirements:
Fluency in Hindi preferred.
Knowledge of regional South Indian languages
Willingness to travel across South India
Contact: 8925818582
mail.id: labinterio1972@gmail.com

MARKETING

WANTED FRESHERS/ Any Degree to Sell Plots.Salary 25000+ Inc 7708498266

SANITARYWARE EXPD Sales Rep Chennai (Part/Full Time) 2Whlr License, TN,AP,KL,KA (Hindi). 9840172223.

MEDICAL

SONOLOGIST WANTED 10.30 to12.30 Monday to Saturday – Selvi Scans Mylapore Ct–9940212129

PRINTING / E–PUBLISHING

SITUATIONS VACANTACCOUNTS MANAGERA reputed manufacturing firm in VADAPALANI and PADAPPAI requires a qualified and experienced Accounts Manager. Eligibility:5+ years of core accounting experience. Skills Needed: Proficiency in Tally Prime, E–Invoice, TDS compliance and finalisation of balance sheets. Excellent leadership and analytical skills are essential. Salary: Commensurate with experience and qualifications (best in the industry).Interested candidates may email their updated resume to sicartonsenthil@gmail.com

TECHNICAL

A Leading Residential Promoter in Chennai is looking for a Qualified & well experienced
Civil Engineer for the post of
SENIOR SITE ENGINEER
Age: 50+ years.
Retired persons may also apply
Mail: admin2@bcplindia.in

SITUATIONS REQUIRED

69–YEARS–YOUNG CA & Company Secretary seeks professional opportunity or administrative work. WHATSAPP 6383456224

LOOKING FOR Sr. Consultant roles in BPO or Financial Services Org., 27 Yrs experience. Contact 7010877144

EXP'D PERSON available for International Sourcing, Procurement, SCM of Multiple Products. Assistance also for Marketing & Sales. 9500798299

TECHNICAL

ARCHITECT, BIM Architect/ Modeler & Draughtsman. Architect office in Tambaram. Mail: rogers@groupmail.com

Site Engineer BE or Diploma, 2 to 5yrs Exp. Orient Builders.9444061754

Civil Engineer, Purchase Executive, Accommodation will be provided, Chennai, Cont: 9100099953 Email Id : care@arimabuilders.com

REQUIRES IMMEDIATE: Civil Engineers with 5+yrs Experienced @ Chennai Salary:Based on Experience &Skills RMT Constructions. Send CV to: rmtconstructions4545@gmail.com Contact: 9962271755/ 9841124620

WANTED ITI, Dip in EEE/BE Exp 2-3 yrs, Control Panel, wiring/Testing, VFD, salary 25000-30000 PH NO-99400 53778

SENIER CADD Designer Ex:3–5 yrs BE/Mech.@ Thirumudivakkam. PH. 99527 53330.Mail ID : accounts@innovteck.in

SIVASAKTHI INFRA Req Quantity Surveyor, Civil Site Engineer 9500313555

REAL ESTATE

INDEX OF REAL ESTATE

ARCHITECTS
BUILDER'S REQUISITES
BRICKS/CONCRETE BLOCKS
BUILDING CONTRACTORS
BUILDING MATERIALS
CEMENT
CONCRETE MIX
HARDWARE
MARBLE
PAINTING CONTRACTORS
CONSULTANTS
HOME DECOR
PUBLIC NOTICE
HOME FINANCE
JOINT DEVELOPMENT
BUYING
SELLING
Classification common for Buying and Selling
COMMERCIAL
COMMERCIAL BUILDING
COMMERCIAL LAND
FACTORIES & SITES
FARM HOUSE/ LAND/ RESORTS
RESIDENTIAL
RESIDENTIAL FLAT-NEW
RESIDENTIAL FLAT-RESALE
RESIDENTIAL HOUSE
RESIDENTIAL LAND
TIME SHARE
GENERAL

BUYING

COMMERCIAL LAND

REQ 1TO5GR Com develop Land Guindy –Porur Arcot Rd Iyyappanthangal – Padi – Avadi GST upto Guduvancheri Velachery –Tambaram Omr upto Kelambakkam Radial Rd On Rd Only 9840055888

GENERAL

REQ LAND up to 5 Acres,Clear Title– Kelambakkam,Thiruporur, Kalavakkam. Main/40ft RD. Direct owners preferred. Immediate Buy.Call 9841095556

RESIDENTIAL HOUSE

REQ 1200SFT G+2 Res House 10–15yrs Old. Area Pin Code: Ch–3, 7, 112, 14, 35. Owners Only: 99417 99720

GENERAL

KATTUPAKAM 2401SF CMDA Land Avail for Exchange. Looking for 4000sf above With House Nr Main Rd. 9445480884

SELLING

COMMERCIAL

IRUNGATTUKOTTAI SRIPERUMBUDUR, Hundai backside 15000 sft 124x121size DTCP land Company & ware house use 1500 per sft Nago. Ct: 9566230325

KALYANA MANDAPAM for Sale @ Velachery– 12 Grounds, Open 55 car &100 bike parking Ct: Kumar PH 98410 24677

EGMORE ALSA Mall 2400 sqft UDS 965 sqft fully renovated attached toilet ready to occupy 2 car park 2nd floor Ideal for any offices. Buyers only +91 9789522759

COMMERCIAL BUILDING

PRIME PROPERTY on Rajaji salai Parrys. Standalone Building Approx 10, 000sqft Basement+5 Floors Built on 2044sqft of Land East Facing Genuine Buyers Call: 9869164779/ 7338779689

THIRUVANMIYUR PRIME Rd–facing, 925sft office/retail space in ready for occupancy/ investment. 9940028790

CHAMIERS ROAD
Brand New Commercial Space 2500 Sqft
Suits Boutique Clinics / Offices
90907 55000
COSMIC PROPERTIES

PORUR ON Trunk Road 1282sft with G+1 Commercial Building Around 2000sft Opposite ECI Church & Anjappar Hotel Suitable for Showroom, Shops Etc. Interested Buyers Contact Tanikaivel :9884071865 / 9841071865

COMMERCIAL LAND

PATTA LANDS 210 Acres, Near Sattur, Suitable for Solar. Ct: 9003658626

AYAPPAKAM MN Rd Ambattur Land 3078 sqft TNHB, Rs.15000/sft. 9677289119

ECR SEA–SIDE Muttukadu 15Grd & 22 Grd Mn Rd. Buyer Only Ct: 9840787799

GUMMIDIPOONDI 33 Acre land for sale. Suitable for Industrial, Data Centre & Commercial use. 9840283023.

OMR THORAIPAKAM Opp ASV Tower 4G 3.5C 9841971947/ 6374401577/ 42337779

VELACHERY OPP SBI, TNHB 2128sqft land 40 ft Road on bus route 20000/ sft Nego. Banks/ Corp. Ct: 9962577758

CMDA APPROVED Industrial Plots within city limit (Manali) 9600009999

COMMERCIAL LAND

ADAMBAKAM 1.5 Grd 50ft Rd Nr NGO Clny. Premshanthi Realtors 9003287101

GST ON Road Thindivanam 9.5 & 4.5Acres Good Frontage Azzets 9994194859

FACTORIES & SITES

AVADI INDUS Land 4.12 Acre 10K Sq Bldng Corner 50KV Rs.29Cr. 9884088660

THIRUMAZHISAI SIDCO 23 grounds Land with 30Ksft Shed, 250 KVA HT Power, just 400 mtr from Bangalore Highway. Ct: 9840048141/ 9445375742

✔ **WASHERMENPET 10000SFT** 11Cr. Rent Income 4.5Ls/Mth Raj NoBrk 9840326659

FARMHOUSE / LAND /RESORTS

REDHILLS SELVA Vinayagar Ngr 7200sft Farmhouse Sale 3.5 Cr. 9884037772

ECR MUGAIYUR Radiance Marina DTCP RERA 14400 Sft 33ft Road.9841400310

ECR PATTIPULAM GET TEE Resort Villa No.1E , Swim Pool Sale 9444075777

1.4 ACRES Well developed DTCP approved farm opp Mudaliarkupppam boat house, Paramankeni Fully Compounded. For Site Inspection: Ct: Mr. Ranjit– 6369517838, Mr. Ezhumalai: 8056673379 For Property Owner: 9600009999

50 CENT Punchai, 30ft DTCP Plot Road, Near Madurantakam Ct:9444724955

GENERAL

ADYAR, 1 Ground, Commercial or Residential. No brokers. Bysani Property Advisors: 9789000737

RESIDENTIAL

2BHK 950 sqft, UDS 570 sqft, Kilpauk, Car parking – 9884403049

RESIDENTIAL FLAT – NEW

T.NAGAR, POSH, 3&4BHK, Swandra Constructions, 9790915016. We Invite JV & Outright Purchase Of Properties.

3BHK ARCOT Road 1720sf 503 Uds 2Bly 4T Gated Comm 1.95C 95000 63091

ALWARTHIRUNAGAR PREMIUM 3BHK Vaasthu CCP Flat for sale Ct:9962099997

✔ **BESANT NGR** 50ft Beach Rd 821sf 2BHK Luxury Flt with CCP Ct: 9884055522

KK NGR 2/3BHK CCP, Lift,Gym,Terrace Garden, CCTV 1.62Cr. Ph:7094222211

OMR KARAPAKKAM 3BHK Lift Carpark Metro stn walkable,1.15Cr. 7305647056

RAMAPURAM
RAYALA NAGAR - 2nd Main Road
Deluxe 3-BHK Flat - 1,155 Sq.ft
Only 1 Flat available
Hurry up !!
Ready to Occupy
SAKTHI FOUNDATION
94442 43892, 98848 43892

PUZUTHIVAKKAM NEW Customizable 1, 2 BHK 43–L onwards. Ct: 78100 25909

RAMAPURAM NEW Customizable 2, 3,4 BHK flats 77–L onwards. 78100 25909

ALWARTHIRUNAGAR NEW 2, 3 BHK Flats for sale 87–L onwards. 78100 25909

KILPAUK HALLS Rd, Brand New Apt @Salma Panache 1877sf Owner 7305333830

VIRUGAMBAKKAM 3BHK Flat, Nearing Completion: 98404 72738 / 62625 75761

ROYAPETTAH BALAJI Ngr One Apartment Per Floor/ 4BHK @ 2100sft Under Construction:62625 75761/ 98404 72738

KOLATHUR PADMAVATHI Ngr Extn 4th St 2BHK CMDA Approved CCP. 9840951199

ALWARTHIRUNAGAR BOOK Now for Offer Price 2BHK 1050Sqft,Lift ,CCP, Near Metro.SRK CONSTRUCTIONS: 9080397355 / 9840957621

CHITLAPAKKAM NEW 2 BHK 820–1001sft Rera Appd Ready Occupy. 9884049612

MANGADU ALTIS Ashraya 2BHK CCP 972sq.ft 79L Next Velammal 85508 77779

KUNDRATHUR READY to Move Premium Semi Furn 2, 3BHK 940–1588sft 8 Units,RO Water. 9787401117 / 9003521117

MANAPAKKAM: MODERN Premium 4 BHK Homes at IPS Colony. Ready to Occupy. Excellent connectivity to Trade Centre, MIOT, Metro & Airport. Rs. 1.85 Cr onwards. Ct: 044–49494485

PERUNGUDI: PREMIUM 2 & 3 BHK Apartments at OMR. Ready to Occupy. 10 mins from Adyar & behind World Trade Centre. Special Price Rs. 1.19 Cr onwards. Ct: 044–49494506

YOUR NEW HOME AWAITS – PALLAVARAM! Premium 2 & 3 BHK Apartments, Ready to Move. Starting Rs. 58L. 962–1431 Sq.Ft. Get Possession in Just 10 Days! Ct:044–49494517

PADUR, OMR Spacious 1700 Sq.Ft. 3 BHK Apartments on OMR Main Road, Opp. Chettinad Healthcare. Rs. 1.10 Cr Onwards. Handover in 10 Days! Call: 044–49494537

10MINS FROM Porur Premium 2 & 3 BHK Apartments from Just Rs. 68L Onwards at kovur Call: 044–49494454

POTHERI – 5 mins from GST Road. Right Behind SRM University Premium 2&3 BHK apartments from Rs. 50L Onwards. Gated Community call: 044–46184425

THORAIPAKKAM SPECIAL ! 52% UDS Spacious 2 BHK Apartments, 1033–1198 Sq.Ft I Ready to Occupy I Rs. 86L Onwards I Handover in 15 Days Call: 044–46184410

RESIDENTIAL FLAT – NEW

MAMBALAM(W) NEAR Rly stn 1100sft 2BHK & 1160sft 2.5bhk CP. 9994405547

KORATTUR, EAST Avenue Road – 10 mins from Anna Nagar. Premium 2&3 BHK apartments from Rs. 1.28Cr. Limited units available. Call: 044–46184446.

VADAPALANI / NANGANALUR 2/3BR 1.5C BrNew PVkM 2/3BR TNr 3BR 9962192721

✔ **ADYAR 1920SFT** & 960sft Flat, Ultra Premium finish, November 26 Malar Foundations. 9444070108 / 9363701080

Adyar KB Nagar 4BHK 2650Sft 1080 UDS,4Baths, Pooja, Lift Till Terrace, 2 free CCP, Under Cons.Ct:9551142288

NANGANALLUR THILLAI Ganga Nagar Main Road 1450 Sft 3 BHK Flat, 450 Sft Commercial. Ct: 9841612223

RESIDENTIAL FLAT – RESALE

NR AVADI Rly Stn/ Market, 2BHK 1050sft, UDS – 650sft, 1st floor, 4 Balconies. Ct: 8825545083/ 7338712440

T.NAGAR, 3BHK Near Burkit rd 2000 sqft Grd floor flat UDS 1200 sqft Semi furnished 2 covered car park Lift, 1 store room 23 yrs old. Serious Buyers only. 9789522759

THIRUVANMIYUR KALAKSHETRA Rd, 1343sqft UDS–777, 2BHK 3rdFlr Lift OCP 30yrs old 1.5Cr. NoBrokr. 9840224752

ECR, MUTTUKADU Luxurious 3BHK, 1850 sqft, UDS 1000 sqft, Fully Furnished, North & East Facing, approved seaside gated community, lift, car park, solar, full power backup, 90% loan, 5 yrs old. Buyers only 97895 22759

K.K.NGR APARTMENT Land Area 3783sf Bdup Area –8829sf F.Furn 7305654751

OMR PERUNGUDI 1704 3BHK Isha 2550 3BHK & 2200. Sale & Rent 9840884253

ANNANAGAR BEHIND C–Blk 3BHK 2000sft 1st flr Vasthu. 9840062190 No Brkr

RA PURAM Near Harishree Vidyashram School 4BHK Apt / Single floor/ 3000Sqft BUP / UDS 1850Sqft 2CCP-Cosmic Properties 95000 72727

VELACHERRY SIS on 100Ft Rd 1090SF 2BHK4/F Lft OCP 1.10C neg 9841991540

POES GARDEN 3BHK Apt / 2500 sqft BUA /1600 UDS with 2CCP Cosmic Properties 95000 72727

KOVILAMBAKKAM 3BHK, 1100 Sqft, UDS 635 G.flr, CCP, 75 Lakhs 7010941588

MYLAPORE KARANEESWAR Koil St Near AIR 450sft, UDS 227sft Un Approved 2nd Floor No Lift 2WP Ct: 9840941952

KODAMBAKKAM
3BHK Apartment at
***MF Ram with a Total Built up area of 1459 sqft at a Prime location in Kodambakkam (NearFathima School).**
Semi furnished with 3 Toilets & 3 Balconies - Covered car parking - Lift - Vaasthu- WTP Good quality water - Ready for Occupation.
Ct No. 86105 07554

KOVILANCHERI NEXT to Perungalathur, 3 plots,each 1900sqft, @ Rs.6500/sqft Email: srinivasthemis@gmail.com

RESIDENTIAL HOUSE

MANNIVAKAM LAND 1880sq Bldng 2000sq Nr Kilambakam Bus Stand 9500166660

KOTTIVAKAM VILLA 1200 buildup 3200sft 3BHK S.Pool 4cr + GST 9025525599

ARUMBAKKAM NR PH Rd IND House G+1, 2404sft, Rs.6.50Cr.Nego: 9008307593

NEELANKARAI ECR Sea opp Row Villa Ind.Pool 900 Bdup 4500 4C 9941099964

ECR 3800SQ 5BHK Villa Vettuvankeni @ 3.5C Lift 9841971947/ 6374401577

THIRUVANMIYUR NEW Beach Rd 3300sf Villa Land 1860sf 5.76Cr. 7904138469

KOVUR THANDALAM Nr Bypass Rd Duplex 4BHK 2050sft East face CCP semi furn Ready to move. Ct: 7358516575

AMBATTUR SURAPET New house 1250sft 2BHK appd. 9840951199/ 7418666272

TVS EMERALD Green Acres 2268Sft Land Builtup 1967Sft Ind Villa (5years) Fully Furnished near OMR IT Corridor, Kolapakkam Vandalur Kelambakkam Road. Ct: 9790701507/ 9940449097

ECR NEELANKARAI 3350sft 4BHK Villa 8yr Old Fully Furn 4Crs 98840 19454

LUXURY BEACH Villa 2.5Cr with Private Beach access Muttukadu ECR Anugragha Builder 7845480478 / 9869845454

KODAIKANAL: 2.27ACRES Posh, Secluded Land with Vintage British Bungalow for Sale. Ideal HNI Holiday Home / Corporate Guest House. Clear Title. High Appreciation. No Intermediaries. Contact : 9499965666

ANNANAGAR LAND 2Grds, 48ft Rd 5BHK 5100sqft East Face, 3CCP 9789006000

VALASARAVAKAM S,E Corner Ind. house 50X40, 1850sft 2.8 Cr. 9381111223

CHETPET LAND 3000sq S/F 40ft Rd 37.5X80 Rs.10cr Full Cheque 9884088660

RESIDENTIAL LAND

PLOT SALE @ Suresh Nagar Navalur. 33x60 , Approved & Online Patta Aval Call :9940203433 Rate @6250/– per sqft

AVADI, APPROVED Plot (2400 Sft) for Sale at Avadi Vivekananda Nagar Near Sri Vishnu Mahal. Ct: 7305998130

ECR UTHANDI 2600sq.ft. (40 X 65) Per sqft Rs.11,500/–Owner: 9940181752

MARAIMALAINAGAR 1KM from GST Rd, SRM university to 2Km, Mahendra city DTCP Appr. Corner plot :9941609508

RESIDENTIAL LAND

WEST MAMBALAM– 3900sqft land Kavarai St.For Sale.8189900788/ 8610387445

KORATTUR MADHANAKUPPAM senapathy Ngr 11300 sft patta land. 8807721954

TAMIRABARANI BANKS, Apprd plots 5000sft on main road @ Melacheval. Rs.250/sft. 3t Properties. 91500 25532

OMR SIRUDAVOOR, 21780 Sqft, DTCP Approved Land, Rs.1500 Per Sqft. Genuine buyers email at naga41prema@gmail.com can negotiate.

ECR KANATHUR 1055 Sqft, DTCP Approved Plot. Call: 9087200088

MADAMBAKKAM SRI Vignesh Nagar 1Gr Approved Plot for Sale.Ct. 9962100745

IMMEDIATE SALE ECR Vilampur 45 Cents with Coconut, Mango &Jackfruit Trees. Just 3mins from Main Rd, surrounded by houses. 2.10Cr. 8754400006

WALAJABAD JS Ngr DTCP Appd. SF, 1800Sft, Broker Excuse. Ph: 8072318463

ARUMBAKKAM CHOOLAIMEDU Saligramam 700sf, 1200, 2400sft land. 9362346721

ECR: SEA side 2400 Sq ft, DTCP & CRZ approved plots @ Rs.33.3 LAKHS, Nr.Koovathur, secured gated community & Bank Loan Avl. Ct:7540054006

PADAPPAI SARAPANANCHERY 5400Sqft Vacant land Approved Plot. 9940662650

OMR NAVALLUR Nr 30mtr Hari's Garden DTCP & RERA 9962772672/ 9444282372

ANNANAGAR 5.7 Gr 85 Ft Front, Koyembebdu main Rd 4.5Gr Com. 9380835942

CHENGALPATTU 11000SFT Rate per sqft 900/– only. Just 2 kilometres from Railway Station. Ct: 95515 03397

KORATTUR 4,800 Sq.ft Resi. Plot/ Land for sale. Contact: 9840283023.

TAMBARAM/ MUDICHUR 2829 sq.ft Resi. plot for sale. Suitable for residence/investment. Direct buyers only. Hanu Reddy: 9790733818.

ECR PALAVAKAM Premium Villa Plots CMDA&RERA Appd Gated Community GEM Terra Realty: 9884439439, 9841067863

NR GUDUVANCHERY Railway Stn 1375& Adhanur 4565sft, 3800/Sft 8668038632

ECR OPP KALDAN SAMUDRA 2750 sqft land Rs.1700/sft 60% Loan. 9176737676

ADYAR 1.5GRDS Residential Land For Sale Ct: 9940697989 / 9444728899

SUNGAVASATHIRAM MOLACHUR DTCP approved Plots 1478 sqft to 2400 sqft Rs.1600/per sqft. Loan 70% Available. CT: Gauruda 9841175500

ECR MAHABALIPURAM Near DTCP Approved 1Gr, 2Gr, 4Gr Ct: 9884078597

W TAMBARAM 3km CMDA 1453sft–51L, 1350sft–61L, 800sft–37L.Ct 9840823663

SAVEETHA MEDICAL University (Behind),DTCP approved. On Kuthambakkam Main Rd, south facing 3900 sft, 40 feet Rd, Rs.1.1 crores, for immediate regn only. 80560 53838

LUZ AVENUE 3 Grounds with 5000Sqft House Vastu Compliance Brokers Excuse Cosmic Properties 70666 77777

KELAMPAKAM BALU Mudali st.4053 s.ft Appd Rs4.5K.9444189711/ 04423770711

CHENNAI AIRPORT Nr. 15Grd. Residential Land for Sale. Ph: 82209 33564

KODAIKANAL VILPATTI Kodai Green Valley Phase–I 4900sft DTCP appd patta land. Ct: 962611112/ 9444015069

ECR–KOTTIVAKAM AGS Colony Beachside Land 5000Sft Rs.5.50cr. 9840803138

MAHINDRA CITY DTCP Freehold Plots 705–3071sft Next to Club, Aqualily, School 96262–92424/98840–30000

MADURAI MEENAKSHIPURAM, behind Kilambakam Bus 1,800sft Appd 9940029415

PLOT. PLAN. BUILD. Kuthambakkam Gated Community Villa Plots I 891–2027 Sq.Ft. I Rs. 45L Onwards I Behind Bus Terminus. Call: 044–46184449

PERUNGALATHUR: PREMIUM plots! 967–1583 sq.ft. Rs. 60L+. Prime location. Hurry! Call: 044–46184450

PORUR GARDENS Corner Plot 2,880sq. ft 40–ft road, 16,000/Sq.ft. 3 km SRMC Hospital, 6 km DLF Cybercity, near upcoming Metro. Direct Owner. Genuine Buyers only 7305569186

ECR 3GR. Sea Side House Land, 5 Gr. Also Sale 1.5Cr Per Gr. 9840083303

ECR RENGANATHAN Avenue 8Grs Appd N/F No Broker Owner Call. 9677219352

ECR UTHANDI on Main Rd 2Grs Appd Corner No Broker Owner. 9677219352

MAHABALIPURAM GATED Cmnty EB Water Line 4.3Gr NF Rs.2200/Sf 9677080055

GUDUVANCHERRY VEDACHALAM Ngr Ashok-Leyland Aadhanur 2144sft. 8124212302

ARUNGAL(URAPAKKAM) & Sattamangalam (Potheri) Land for sale.9962884841

MEDAVAKKAM ADJ Veerabadra Nagar 38x50 Res Plot Sale. Brokers Excuse. Ishwarya Homes 9841037806

MADAMBAKKAM 14100SFT on 40ft Road 200ft Front Outright sale 8778341765

GUDUVANCHERY NEAR, DTCP Approved Plots for Sale. Contact: 91766 67499

NUNGAMBAKKAM NR Main Rd Ind Bungalow 2.456Grd 55ft Frontage 9884539008

KOYAMBEDU CHENNAI 1200sft North Face approved Rs.1.65Cr Ct: 9381141774

SRIPERUMBUDUR 1800SF 30x60 Metro Global City, Kundrathur 2000sf corner plot Metro Grand City 9940118498

ADAMBAKKAM OFFICER colony 3100 Sft Vacant Land For Sales Ct:9841612223

BUSINESS OFFERS

INDEX OF BUSINESS OFFERS

AGENTS WANTED
BUSINESS
BUSINESS FOR SALE
CONSULTANTS
FINANCE
IMMIGRATION
IMPORT & EXPORT
INDUSTRIAL
PARTNERSHIPS
SHARES & INVESTMENTS
GENERAL

BUSINESS

WANTED RUNNING clinic Dental/ Aesthetic for sale/rental. 78258 07919

COLDWELL BANKER
You've built the relationships.
But can your business scale beyond you?
120 YEARS OF GLOBAL LEGACY OF TRUST. OF HOME.
FOR FRANCHISE ENQUIRIES :
81470 29068
gopal.desai@coldwellbanker.in
cbsouthindia.com

BUSINESS

ENTREPRENEUR WANTED – PROFIT SHARING
Established Company at **Nelson Manickam Road, Chennai**
invites Entrepreneurs with scalable business ideas.
Our Investment - Your Business Idea.
We provide Funds, Furnished Office Space, Infrastructure & Support. Profit-Sharing Model.
Email detailed proposal to:
Business@indfashions.com

BUSINESS FOR SALE

SHEDS AVAILABLE on rental for factory, Godown, Labourshed chennai 9566247507

PARTNERSHIPS

LOOKING FOR Investors JV For Real estate company Chennai 9566247507

SHARES / INVESTMENTS

✔ **WANTED COLLATERAL Doc 10–15 Cr/ req Fin 5 CR Based on Profile & Projects like JV in Building, Cafe, Hotel, Interior Works /Partnerships/ Investors / Flexible Ratio/ Transparent Deals/ Interested Parties, Genuine Agent Good Commission. Ct: tigereyedevelopers@gmail.com / 9597739036**

INVESTMENT OPPORTUNITY Pre–Leased Warehouse, Cat A Tenant.55Cr/6% yield. sundarraj@growbridgeadvisory.com

PERSONAL

OLD AGE HOME

VINAYAKA OLD Age Home Bed Patient, Hygienic,Pure Veg Food,24HrsNursing Care,KK Nagar 9551663106/ 9380578731

LIONS CLUB Run Senior Citizens Paradise. Excellent Food & Service Independent Room attach bath 7299910004

M/F COUPLE, Bed Ridden (Senior Citizen) Paid. 9176200203 / 9003601899

INDUSTRIAL NEEDS

RUNNING SURGICAL & GYNECOLOGY GLOVES UNIT FOR SALE
A well-established Running Manufacturing Unit is available for sale.
*** Complete Surgical Gloves Production Line**
*** Gynecology Gloves Production Line**
*** Manufacturing Capability: Up to 18-inch Gloves.**
*** Ideal for manufacturers, exporters, and investors**
GENUINE BUYERS ONLY
Location: ALAPPUZHA, KERALA, INDIA
Contact: 8156839639

To advertise in
Classifieds Special
Contact:
T Muni Babu
@ 98407 95023
Toll Free
@ 1800 102 4161

CLASSIFIEDS SPECIAL

THE HINDU Classifieds SITUATIONS VACANT

Advertisement Rates
The Hindu Chennai Edition
Line Type Advt.: Rs.2,080 (2 Lines) Every additional line: Rs.810.
Classifieds Display:
Rs.1,435 per sqcm (Single Column)
Rs.1,530 per sqcm (Double Column)

Special Value Offers!
Classifieds Sunday & Wednesday Combo Offer:
At just 25% extra a Situations Vacant Advertisement in the Sunday Classifieds can be repeated under the same heading the following Wednesday in the Classifiedsmart columns.
Classifieds Sunday, Wednesday & Friday Combo Offer:
At just 35% extra a Situations Vacant Advertisement in the Sunday Classifieds can be repeated under the same heading the following Wednesday and Friday in the Classifiedsmart columns.

The above offers are available for The Hindu Chennai, Tamil Nadu, Southern and All Editions.
The advertisement copy will have to remain unchanged.
The advertisements booked under combo offers cannot be cancelled subsequently.
Terms & conditions apply.

For more details, please contact
Classifieds Customer Care
Phone: 044-28576342 Toll Free: 1800 102 4161
or Contact your nearest Authorised Space Sellers

More on next Page

Matrimonial

BRINGING PEOPLE TOGETHER — THE HINDU

BRIDEGROOMS WANTED

INDEX OF MATRIMONIAL

BRIDEGROOMS WANTED
BRIDES WANTED
BRIDES & GROOMS WANTED
Classification Common for Brides, Bridegrooms, Brides & Grooms
ASSAMESE
AWADHI
BENGALI
BHOJPURI
BIHARI
CHHATTISGARHI
ENGLISH
GUJARATI
HARYANI
HINDI
KANNADA
KASHMIRI
KONKANI
MALAYALAM
MANIPURI
MARATHI
MARWARI
NEPALI
ORIYA
PARSI
PUNJABI
SAURASHTRA
SINDHI
TAMIL
TELUGU
TULU
URDU
ADVOCATE
BUSINESS
DEFENCE
DOCTOR
ENGINEER
FINANCE/ BANKING
GOVERNMENT/ QUASI-GOVERNMENT
IAS/ ALLIED SERVICES
INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY
MBA/ CA/ ICWA
NRI
COSMOPOLITAN
DIVORCEE
PHYSICALLY CHALLENGED
MARRIAGE BUREAUS
WEDDING ARRANGEMENTS

COSMOPOLITAN

CSI CHRISTIAN 40yrs, Software Engineer (UK), seeks any Caste Groom willing to settle in UK 9791322874, 8870560816.

HINDU NADAR, 38, 155 cms MD (Anaes) & FNB (Critical Care) from a good family employed in BLR looking for a suitable Doctor / SW Engineer. CNB 80734 37540 / 98450 36548.

ATTRACTIVE, WARM 30, 168cm, well–read UK–based architect. Open to relocating. Cultured, affluent family. Seeks smart, compatible groom. Lang./caste no bar. Call/WA 93456 34365

DIVORCEE

BEAUTIFUL, KIND 39, 163cm, responsible, well–educated professional. Seeks smart, warm, compatible groom. Caste no bar. Call/WA 9345 634 365

DOCTOR

WANTED DOCTOR GROOM
ROMAN CATHOLIC, MD, DNB, (Anesthesiology), 27 Yrs, 5′ 7″, SLIM, FAIR, REPUTED SCHOOL, COLLEGE, WELL - SETTLED, CHENNAI.
CONTACT No. WhatsApp Profile
75500 65082

NAIDU PG Doctor Girl (Gavara), Pursuing M.S., Final Year, 26/160, Kettai / Viruchigam, Upper Middle Class, Native Coimbatore, Seeking PG Doctor Groom (Sub Sects No Bar) . Contact: 98653 01920, 98426 50751

HINDU THEVAR Male MBBS Doctor wanted for Girl MBBS Doctor. Ct: 98400 31579, 9443184149, 9444034165

REMARRIAGE :- Syrian Christian doctor 37 years, 163 cms, slim fair, professor AIIMS North India. Retired parents with liberal religious attitude invite proposals from **Doctors, Engineers, Officers of Central Government Institutes, IITs** and other transferable professionals.
Contact :- 9995465029, 9447558971

ENGINEER

GROOM WANTED Canada, Toronto–PR, Bengali Girl, Hindu, Kayastha, Aug'1990, 5'5" B.Tech. Non–Veg, Nev –Mar, Wkg MNC as Manager, High pkg. well – Qualified Canada bases Working Boy, Excuses Divorce. Contact: 9477507531

GOVT / QUASI GOVT

Hindu Adi Dravidar 28 Yrs/152 cm/ 52 BE AO, 14 LPA, PSE, Tamil Nadu Contact - Phone: 9600983800

IAS / ALLIED SERVICES

Hindu, Tamil, gounder, 45 years, IPS, seeks groom. Contact phone: 9578822036.

KANNADA

HINDU VOKKALIGA Gowda 31, BE from Coimbatore seeks Suitable Groom. Contact: 97917 68175.

MALAYALAM

CATHOLIC NADAR Girl, Thiruvananthapuram, 1994, 158 cm, mutually divorced, Assistant Professor Radiology, St. John's Medical College, Bangalore. Seeking Doctors or Highly qualified professionals from any Christian denomination. WhatsApp: 9447242173.

MUSLIM GIRL 25/160cm data analyst seeks moderate religious groom pref brought up outside state 6238189455

NAIR DOCTOR Girl DM 32 Yrs 161 Cm seeks Doctor - Professional. Mob: 9249 920550, 8089 584220

MALAYALI 29YRS Hindu/ Nair (1997) Ayilayam Working at Paris Seeks Hindu Malayali Boys holding Schengen Visa working in EU or UK preferred Ct: 9901929074

SUITABLE ALLIANCE invited for an upper class Ezhava Lady Doctor (37, Avittam, MS Gen Surgery), working as Senior Resident . Ph: 9895909248.

NAIR GIRL, MBBS
Avittam, 29 years, working as Director, Rich, 150 cm, fair.
Family with excellent financial stability and running business since 40 years all over UAE. Proposals invited from educated young men with a similar background including business.
Ph : +918891 916916 +919847 797729

NRI

NRI GROOM WANTED. Nair girl, unmarried,Aug1974, well employed US citizen, caste nobar .Malayalam/Tamil US residents only Cont: 9895 824803.

TAMIL

CSI Christian Bride 36 BE Working in MNC seeks Christian Groom 37 to 40 Yrs BE/ME Working in MNC. CT:9043019165

BORN AGAIN Christian, looking for a groom from any sub-caste in any country from 30-37, 8137001247

CSI, LOOKING for a groom from 25-30 ,Pilot,Business,UK profiles from CSI and Christian Nadar, 8137001366

RC CHRISTIAN – 38 Yrs, 175cm, Fair, B.E, M.Tech , Divorcee, No Child, Working in Belgium With Good Salary. Seeks Groom 35+ Years , Well Educated, Tall, Well Employed, Willing to Move to Belgium (Caste No Bar) Contact: 9884086383/82

RC, B.Arch, looking for a groom from 26-30 from any subcaste in Tamilnadu, 8138 900575

CATHOLIC, BE, Looking for a groom from 26-31 from Catholic,RC pillai and Nadar from anywhere, 8138900487

ROMAN CATHOLIC Bride, Aug 1995, 156 cm, B.E.(India) PG (NZ) / New Zealand (PR), Seeks professionally qualified Nadar Bridegroom based in New Zealand / Australia. Contact: 9489262223 / Mail: anthonysamy3007@gmail.com

NATHAMAR UDAYAR Catholic,1993 Borned, HR professional– MNC, with null and void order looking for Christian boy below 35yrs, Working professional with legal, church orders with clean habits, WhatsApp 99400 99429

CATHOLIC VELLALAR 33/171, MBBS, MPH Researcher in student visa, USA Seeks groom from USA. 9150153743

CSI, RICH /Affluent, MSC, looking for a groom from 25-29 from chennai and NRI profiles from CSI and Christian Nadar,8138 900487

CHRISTIAN Nadar, Rich, M.tech, looking for a groom from24-28 from equal status in Kongu circle 8138900575

PILLAI 26Yrs/157cm Pooja Fair BE Hospital Mgt Canada seeks grooms any Country.9894107825, 9500595339

HINDU NADAR Divorce Unconsummated Marriage–35 BE,MBA Accenture UK–London CyberSecurity Associate Manager Seeks Blw 39yr CNB CL/WA 9442126376

AGE 35 BE MBA MS(UK) Divorced unconsummated marriage seeks preferably NRI groom. Caste No bar. 9444298707

BALIJANAIDU 32/BE/167CM Punarpoosam Nakshatra, Mithuna Rasi, Chennai Settled Seeks Well Settled Family with Clean Habits.Whatsapp 9445215488

SOZHIYAVELLALAR PILLAI Age 31 BE (CSE) Working in Pvt Sector Chennai, Seeks Groom Preferable from Pillai/Mudaliar Age 31–34, BE Working In IT Field Employed in Chennai / India / Abroad. Ct: Gowdhaman 9342276143

GROOM WANTED CNB,41yrs, BE, MBA, Elite business family in Chennai. Ph: 6385293227

GROOM WANTED Naidu,29yrs,ME, Elite business family in Chennai.Ph: 9384772710

REDDIAR, RAKU/KETU, BDS, looking for a Reddy groom from 28-34 from any location,8137003550

ADIDRAVIDAR, 26, MBA, looking for any caste groom from Mumbai based(IIM,CAT - MBA), 8138900487

SC, UK, MBA, looking for a UK,European grooms from 29-35, 8137003516

UDAYAR, CANADA, M.tech,looking for a canada groom from 27-33 from.well educated and settled,8138900312

MUDALIYAR, MBA, MNC, Looking for a well settled groom from 30-35 from Mudaliyar and pillai caste, Contact : 8138 900553

NAICKER, ME, looking for a groom from 26-31 from Naidu and Naicker from Well educated and settled family, 8138009144.

SEEKING UNMARRIED GRADUATE/IT/NON–IT PROFESSIONAL for 44yrs unmarried Tamil SC Hindu Adi Dravida Female IT professional residing in Singapore. Contact +91 7200942776/ +65 91051142.

AGAMUDAYA MUDALIAR 34 Dentist Chennai. Seeks well educated, good family background Groom. Ct: 9486531194

GROOM WANTED Hindu Nadar 35 yrs, divorce,MBBS,MD, Elite Business Family.Ph: 9380791999, 9841329471

MUDALIAR 32 5.6 Anusham MA(H.R) working well settled family in Chennai seeks qualified groom Age 32– 37 Ct:9444363220

HINDU SC AD 38 Sr. Software Engineer TCS Chennai Rs 1.40 LPM seeks suitable groom working in Chennai. Ct: 99521 47216 / 88380 34943

INTERCASTE, 25, Masters, Business, looking for a groom from 26-31 from Mudaliar and Naidu from Kongu and chennai circle, 8137001387.

REDDY, Divorced, Masters, looking for a 2nd marriage profile from 29-35 from any caste in India and UAE, 8138900312.

VISWAKARMA, MSC, Upper middle class, seeking for a groom from 24-28 from same caste in tamilnadu, 8138900523.

RC, UDAYAR, optometry, looking for a groom from 27-32 from singapore and any christian subcaste, 8137003550

SC PALLAR, DIVORCEE, 38, Caste No Bar, B.E, M.S Seeking a Suitable Groom.Call/whatsapp 7539985037.

VANNIYAR, BDS, 33, Star – Revathi, Employed, Middle Class Family, Groom from Same Community Needed. Contact: 98409 61251

26YEARS, HINDU, Maruthuvar Community, BDS, MDS, Dentist Girl looking Groom, Doctor/Engineer/ Business/ Govt job. Good family. Ct: 9841747184

MUDALIYAR, 26YRS, MBA,Elite Business Family in Chennai, Seeks Affluent Business Groom.Ph:8925239889

GROOM WANTED Naidu,29yrs, Divorce,B.Tech, Affluent Family in Chennai. Ph: 6385293227

GROOM WANTED CNB,33yrs,BE, Civil service,Well Educated Family.Ph: 6385293227

FASHION DESIGNER Saiva MudaliarAnusham 33 Very Fair Propertied NeedVeg IT/ Govt Employed Groom 9566268349

HINDU SC AD 30/155 cm MTech Bio Well settled Seeking Groom from age 31to 34 India & Abroad Ct 9176667499

VELLALAR, AGE–38, MBBS,MD, Own Hospital Star:Magam, Never married Well settled, Sub Caste ok. 7305460763

Thuluva Vellala 28/152 BE MBA MSc seeks teetotaller good family BG employed PG groom SNB ct:6382794549, malaranihsr@gmail.com

NAIDU /PILLAI 31/160cm MBBS MS MRCS doing MCh Bangalore seeks PG Dr Naidu / CNB Geetham 9884858014

MUDALIAR 29/163CM MBBS MD Chennai Seeks Mudaliar Pillai PG Dr Geetham 9884858014

GROOM WANTED CNB,31yrs, BE,MS,Rich & Affluent Business Family in Chennai.Ph:7200187009

GROOM WANTED Hindu Nadar 30yrs, MBBS,MS,own Hospital,rich and Affluent Family.: 9380791999, 9841329471

GROOM WANTED Mudaliyar, 26yrs, MBBS, MD,Own Hospital in Chennai, Elite family.Ph:8925239889

MUDALIAR 26/165, Fair, BE, MS, HWE, INTEL USA,100000.USD.PA, Affluent Family, CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

MUDALIAR 24, BE, MBA,160cm Good Looking Well Settled Family Seeks Groom CNB Ct. 8778514465/ 7200866346

REDDIAR, RAKU/KETU, BDS, looking for a Reddy groom from 28-34 from any location,8137003550

VANIYA CHETTIYAR, Rich, BE, Private, looking for a groom from 30-36 from any equal caste and good looking ,8138 900412

VANNIYAR, RICH, Divorced, MD, Doctor, looking for a groom from any caste 2nd marriage profile from 35-45 in Banglore circle,8137001387

✔ **ALLIANCE INVITED for 26–year–old, 169 cm, Fair, SC, Tamil daughter, working as a Securities & Capital Markets Associate with a top–tier corporate law firm in Mumbai/ Bangalore/Chennai, advising companies and banks on IPOs and major financial transactions; CTC Rs.26 LPA. BBA, LL.B. (Hons.), LL.M. qualified. Family–oriented, with strong values. From an educated, well–settled Chennai family; father retired Executive Director of a leading PSU. Seeking a highly qualified, professionally accomplished groom from a respectable family, working in Government/PSU/ Private sector. Ph: 9444415358.**

MUKULATHOR, UPPER middle class, MSW, looking for a groom from 27-31 in equal caste only in coimbatore, 8137 001247.

SM4 TAMIL Brahmin Iyer Girl, 37/ 5'6", CA, MBA, issueless div (short marr.), affluent family. Seeks well–edu/emp Boy, never marr/ issueless div, 37–42 yrs from cultured, affluent family. Cont: 9043949107 / asalliancemail@gmail.com

Tamil, 26Years, B.Sc, Good Family, UMC, Fair Girl seeks suitable Groom, CNB. Cont: 9441677205

Tamil, Good family, 29Years, B.Tech, MBA (BIM), 26 LPA, seeks suitable Groom, CNB. Contact: 9441677205.

GROOM WANTED SC(Ad),30yrs, MBBS, MD, Elite business family in Chennai.Ph: 6385293227

Matching highly qualified Chennai based Groom from Mudaliar / Pillai community with Good value- clean habits from Reputable Family WANTED:- For Fair - slim- beautiful- ht 5.4 / born June 97 Chennai based ENTREPRENEURS- Mudaliar GIRL - BE - M.S from USA - Daughter of Chennai based industrialist.
Contact
SREERAM
98402 20273

TAMIL

NADAR, RICH/affluent, MD, looking for a MD groom only in Nadar caste from 25-29 ,8138 900312

YADAVA, MBBS, looking for a groom from 24-28 from same caste MD,MS, MDS in Tamilnadu, 8138900498

WANTED GROOM
Alliance Invited:
For an educated, well-brought-up Muslim girl from a respectable family. Seeking a well-educated groom aged 25 to 29, above 5.5ht from a reputed, financially well-established business family, with good character and family values. Suitable alliances from business families, Tamil speaking Muslims settled in Chennai are preferred.
Please contact:
95007 67726

TELUGU

Naidu Girl 30/165 cm Aswini pursuing PhD Doctoral studies in Satellite Communications Quantum Neuromorphic Computing European Space Agency Europe- completing by Dec 2026 seeking suitable groom PhD / MS in USA / Europe. Ct: 9840103686

Seeking groom from affluent family for 33/170cm reddy hindu girl employed as technical lead in MNC Bangalore. Only daughter well to do family CNB. 9944949052

REDDY SPECIALIST Dr.MBBS, MS&EGMP from IIM 165cm 1990 Born. Seeks nevermarried Elite groom CNB. 8925640111

NAIDU:34/FAIR, MBBS, MD, Govt. Asst. Surgeon, TN, Seeks Groom any Telugu Doctor– 9443001170/ 8925019776

NAIDU 26/162, Fair, BTech, MS,SWE, Google USA,100000.USD.PA, Affluent Family, CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

URDU

MUSLIM GIRL 29/155 Fair, MBA, working in Dubai seeks handsome well educated groom pref Chennai, working in Dubai. 9840445119 (No Khan)

COSMOPOLITAN

SAIVA VELLALAR 38, 170 cm, fair and handsome, BE (Telecom), Sr Officer Indian Army Tech Branch, 30 lacs PA, never married, son of retd army officer looking for affable and well educated girl. Equal and sub caste no bar. 9448307862.

MUSLIM BRIDES 35 to 45 Age divorcee widow single alone satisfaction life broad– Minded caste no bar.abroad UK.Ct: +918667645841

DIVORCEE

OPEN–MINDED, SUCCESSFUL 43, humble, intelligent (PhD), responsible AI scientist. Seeks progressive, compatible bride. Call/WA 9345 634 365

49, REDDY widower, Software, well–to–do. fit & health conscious. caste no bar. 9885970033

IYER, 2ND Marriage, 45, B.E, Mirugaseerdam, MNC Chennai, Suitable Vegetarian bride wanted. 72000 26588

DOCTOR

NADAR, 28 Years MBBS, MD. Seeks Bride – Any Christian, Any District. Doctor Only. Ct : 73977 76595.

HINDU THEVAR Lady Doctor Wanted for Boy MBBS Doctor . Ct : 95666 11668

HINDI

GAUR BRAHMIN Boy, 93, 5'6", BE chemical BITS Pilani, Working IT Company at Bangalore, 70 LPA, Father Doctor, Mother Gazetted officer family in Bhopal Seeking Suitable Girl, 9425301716, 9826023716

KANNADA

HINDU, NEVER Married. Age 45, height 5 ft 7 inch. IIT, Ph.D. University Professor in US, Green Card. Non–smoker, Non– drinker, vegetarian. Seeking Veg bride below 37 yrs. No caste bar. Contact: 8329691330

BRIDES WANTED

COSMOPOLITAN

✔ **ROMAN CATHOLIC/ Oct 94/ 180 cms/ B.E., M.S/ Product Mgr/ Sweden (PR), seeks professionally qualified working bride based in EU/ willing to relocate to Sweden. Contact sjm.val7@gmail.com or 9923884686.**

SMART, SUCCESSFUL 29, 179cm, well–educated (IIT BTech/MTech) professional. Affluent S Indian business family. Seeks compatible bride. Language/caste no bar. Call/WA 9345634365

INTER CASTE – family looking for Bride (Hindu) qualified and Employed girl– (Caste language no bar) for boy settled in Hyderabad B.Tech, MBA 33 years working as senior project Manager . Contact – 9000819435/ 9848029435.

MALAYALAM

NAIR BOY 41yrs 174 height , AVITTAM , UnMarried, B–TECH IT , Working in Cognizant,Chennai. Ph : 9884366062

Railway Engineer Thiyya 34 Bangalore seeks bride. Contact Phone 8113832105.

TAMIL

CHRISTIAN BRIDE Wanted, No Dowry, Affluent Christian family Seeking a God fearing, Good looking, Well educated and employed Christian girl for their son (Elite family, Teetotaler, 28yrs / 182 cm / 12L PA) M.E . Design Engineer in MNC (JV) Chennai, Origin Tirunelveli. Contact: V.Christober@91 94868 15635 (call / whatsApp)

CHRISTIAN NADAR, Looking for a bride from 31-37 from CSI and christian nadar doctor profile from any where Tamil mother tongue, 8137001247

CHRISTIAN NADAR, Doctor, MBBS, PGDCC-P(NI), Cardio - Physician, Divorcee, no kids. 38yrs/178cm, lives in Nagercoil. seeks qualified / divorced Bride. Ct: 90039 83230

HINDU–BE/SWE/35YRS/172CMS/34LPA/AYILLAM–KADAGAM. WELL educated and financially stable,settled in Bangalore. Seeking Bride from educated family .Con No:9845401461.

VANNIAR GROOM 44 Years B.E,M.B.A (Lon), Divorced, No issue. IT Chennai, 16.5L/PA. Seeks Bride . CT: 9944928521/ 9487935521 Vellore

AUDITOR/ 47 Chennai/ Seeks Any Vegetarian Hindu Girl. Contact : 9884398109

BRIDE WANTED Naidu,38yrs, divorce, Own Hospital in Chennai.Ph: 6385293227

BRIDE WANTED Hindu Nadar 29 yrs, BE, SWE,5 lp/m, Elite Business Family.Ph: 9841329471, 9380791999

MUDALIYAR,28YRS,MS, OWN schools & colleges in Chennai,Seeks Affluent Bride.Ph:7200187009

BRIDE WANTED Graduate, divorcee without Child or First Marriage, below 37 yrs for Navigation Officer 39yrs at Chennai. Contact: 6369004108

BRIDE WANTED Naidu, 32yrs, MBA, Own Construction, Elite business family in Chennai Ct: 7338877275

NADAR (CNB) :30/ 180cm, MBBS, MEM, Pursuing MRCEM, working in Pvt. Hosp, Chennai, Elite Doctor Family, seeks Bride Doctor /Non Doctor Ct:– 9841374710, 8925019776

ADVOCATE 31/168 Unmarried Vegetarian, Teetotaler, Parents Professional, Pillai+Agamudayar Simple Self–Respect Marriage seeks Professional Working Bride 26–29yrs from Chennai settled family. WhatsApp: 9445640752

HINDU NADAR 32/180cm BE MS Fair working USA younger brother 27/ 175cm BE MS V fair VIP family Ct: 9884188849, 7550113468

SOZHIA VELLALA / MUDALIYAR 32/ 182cm, BE / MS., Software Engineer in UK. Seeking Well- educated, Employed / Employable girl, Preferably IT / Doctor background, Willing to relocate to UK. CNB Contact: 7502806125 / 9443192352.

GAVARA NAIDU Boy (29) with H1B VISA in USA seeks Naidu girl knows Tamil with H1B or Student visa in USA. Contact: 9443724981.

DIVORCEE HINDU. 35yrs No issues, M.Tech, well settled Software Engineer, seeking bride with no issues. Caste no bar. 9841862535, 9941962421

BRIDE WANTED Naidu,34yrs, BE, MBA, Elite Business Family.Ph: 6385293227

BRIDE WANTED Mudaliyar, 29yrs, MBA (UK), Rich & Affluent Business Family. Ph:7200187009

THONDAI MANDALA Saiva mudaliar 31 BE, MBA Canada working in Toronto seeking suitable vegetarian Bride including Brahmins Ph.9789037876.

BRIDE WANTED CNB, 35yrs,MS (US), Own complex & Multi Business in Bangalore.Ph: 8925239889

TAMIL

HINDU NADAR, 31yrs, 180cm, MS (AI) , Boston, USA. Seeking a fair, Smart, Well–educated & family–oriented bride from Nadar community, who is currently settled/working in the USA. Brokers ExcuseMob: 9385223715

BOYAR, PURSUING MS, looking from a same caste bride from 20-24 in doctor profession in Tamilnadu, 8138009235

SHADAMARSHNA GOTHIRAM Vadamal Avaittam 25 / 176 / Rs.100000 PM, Yajur veda ganapadigal, Veda Parayanam. Own house. Seeks suitable bride from same caste. Ct 8870074323

GROOM 12 th December 1994,Revathy star,Vegetarian Family,doing MCH Urology At Saveetha University. Rich,Teetotalar,Handsome.,Looking Vegetarian Family PG Doctor, Bride. Call: 9841039515

MUDALIAR 32 BE, MBA 178cm Smart 40Lacs PA, well Settled Family Seeks Bride, CNB Ct.8778514465/ 7200866346

NAIDU 29/165 M.E,Design Engr L&T, own business & rental income,affluent family,Star:Thiruvonam,Rasi:Magaram.Seeks Suitable bride.Similar level caste also acceptable. 9841097110

VELLORE AGAMUDAYA Mudaliyar I Marriage Rishabam 40/165,BE,MNC/Chicago/USA,1L USD/A. Seeks SWE. 9487624807

BE MECHANICAL MBA, 30 Years CBSE School Teacher Chennai, Capable of Speaking and Writing in English, Hindi, Tamil, French, Sanskrit, Studying Data Science, Rich Family, Only Son, 6.25 Height, Expecting Good Girl from Respected Family, Any Caste within Hindu Community. Ct : 9080483961 / 9789891685

BRIDE WANTED Naidu, 29yrs, MBA (IIM),well Educated Family in Chennai.Ph: 7200187009

BRIDE WANTED Hindu Nadar 29yrs, BE, PWD,70K p/m, Business Family. Ph: 9380791999,9841329471

WELL–SETTLED SEEKS Beautiful, Caring, Family–Oriented Life Partner For Genuine Alliance. Ph: 82208 19962

MUDALIAR 43yrs 170cm MCA divorcee well settled in USA. Looking for a Bride employed in USA or India willing to relocate in USA, Cast No bar P-9842079504, 9443263629

HINDU, GROOM, 43 years, IT Chennai, divorced. Seeks a suitable Divorcee or widow woman with children. Caste no bar. Inter–caste and Inter–Religion welcome. Brokers Excuse. Contact: 9962046002

32/176 SELF–EMPLOYED Freelancer, Soft–Spoken from a Rich, affluent & cultured family, seeks Suitable Bride. Caste No Bar. Imperfection, Divorcee without issue also considered. Ct: 9994216431

HINDU MARUTHUVAR 36 B.Tech, MBA, IT, Chennai 18 LPA Seeks Suitable Girl. 8754012186.

GAVARA NAIDU, 42,180, Uthiradam, Maharam, B.E.,M.S.(Engg), Chief Egr. MNC Chennai, 15L PA, First Marriage, seeks Naidu Bride.Ct: 9487272897

NAIDU SHORT lived Remarriage 38/ 168cm MBBS MEM pvt Hospital chennai seeks PG Dr CNB Geetham 9884858014

BRIDE WANTED Naidu,29yrs, MBBS, MD, Elite Business Family in Chennai.Ph: 6385293227

BRIDE WANTED CNB, Divorced,31 yrs, BCom working in Banking Sector, Upper Middle class.Ph: 9176718886

MUDALIAR 28/183, Handsome BE, MS, SWE, Oracle USA,150000.USD.PA, Elite Family CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

HINDU, MUDALIYAR, 37yrs, Own House, Working in Malaysia, Salary 5 Lak PM Looking for a Well–Educated and Good–Family Bride (No Other Expectations). Ct:9820183684 / 8098973888

BRIDE WANTED Naidu, 29yrs, MBA, Well Educated Rich & Affluent Family 7338877275

WEDDING ARRANGEMENTS

MARRIAGE HALLS

SRI GAJALAKSHMI KALYANA MANDAPAM A/C, Velappan Chavadi, Chennai. Vacant Days February 5th, 18th, 26th 2027. Ct: 9382170924, 9840061297

RAJALAKSHMI KALYANA MANDAPAM, 205/ 1, Velachery Main Rd, Dhandeeswaram, Velachery, A/C, Full Facility, Ample Carpark. Ph:22435353/ 9840545585

SRI PADMAVATHY Venkateshwara Hall Ac Mini Hall Ac 100yr trust with free offer Oct Nov Dec few dts available T.Nagar. 7845089089

SHREE HALL A/C T.Nagar Marriage& Other Functions:9444467090/ 9884885282

MARRIAGE BUREAU

US UK Australia All Caste Religion 1st Marriage Remarriage. 8248757840

TAMIL

SC Pr Upper Middle Class Groom, PG studied and Employed at Italy aged 30 Seeks educated preferably Engineering graduate girl from India or abroad who willing to move Italy. Caste No Bar. Ct : 9865960836

SC, BE, Business, Rich, looking for a bride from 26-31 from chennai circle in same caste, 8137003550

BRAHMIN IYER Boy, Magam, 32/170cm B.Tech, TCS Chennai 1L/Month. Seeks Brahmin, Graduate girl. Simple marriage. Ct: 9940352807

BACHELOR OWN Business 61, Iyer pious seeks unmarried Iyer bride. Divorcees & Widows excuse. 9447496006.

Seeking BRIDE for Bridegroom
Hindu, Kulalar/Udayaar, 44 yrs, 170 cms, M.Tech, IT professional, Caste open for discussion. First Marriage Only
CT: 93842 76066

Mudaliyar 1971/170 unmarried B.Com Manager Pvt 50K, seeks Life Partner, CNB, Broker Excuse.Ct: 9360297552

NAIDU GAVARA 34/172cm.BE MBA SBI Dy.Manager 1LPM seeks suitable Bride.Ct.94434 83784.

Tamil, Good family, 32Years, ME(PS-GCT), MBA (SIOM), 30 LPA, seeks suitable Bride, CNB Cell:9441677205.

TELUGU

NAIDU 37, BE, ECE, Quality Engr in Pvt Company Well Settled Family in Chennai. 8939090211

TELUGU VANNAR, 1984, MBA, Kanni, Astham, Mumbai AGM in MNC, 33 Lac.PA, Any Telugu CNB. Ct: 98947 77505

NAIDU, AGE–34, Sadhayam, B.E., Salary:1L. Well settled family. Sub caste ok. Ct: 8754756329 / 8883158177

NAIDU 29/186, BTech, PhD, Re–Scientist, IBM USA,170000.USD.PA, Elite Family, CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

URDU

CHENNAI BOY NRI–Sunni Urdu Engg H–5.8 Youngest Software Company CEO, Working in USA No Demand 9311730142

THE HINDU
DISCLAIMER: Readers are requested to verify and make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/ company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

RENTAL

INDEX OF RENTAL

ACCOMMODATION WANTED
ACCOMMODATION WANTED-COMMERCIAL
ACCOMMODATION WANTED-RESIDENTIAL
COMMERCIAL
FACTORIES & SITES
FARM HOUSE/LAND/ RESORTS
GUEST HOUSE
HOSTEL
PAYING GUEST ACCOMMODATION
RESIDENTIAL
TIMESHARE
GENERAL

RENTAL – COMMERCIAL

VYSARPADI, MKB Nagar Manali Rd 3000sqft for Commercial Land Available BTS (build to suit) Ct: 89253 06684

RENTAL – COMMERCIAL

@ CHETPET Suitable for Clinic L/M Class Locality Contact : 98416 59786

THIRUNINRAVUR NEXT Jaya Engineering College 1 acre land 3 sides compound wall for lease/ rent. 9840080686

ANNANAGAR–W LILY Pond Play School space for activity class. 9840080686

ANNANAGAR 5TH Avenue Prime Commercial Office Space 2nd Floor 1200sqft Lift Ct: 9094035311

VADAPALANI DURAISAMY Rd,1st Flr, 2200sft,Suit For Office,Etc 9840096144

VADAPALANI PERIYAR Pathai 3300sf, All Flr A/C,GF,1st Each Flr 1650sf,offce,Bank,S.market S.Room. 9940138904

CEEBROS 3BHK FullyFurnished Flat Thoraipakam Corporte Rentl. 9443389106

COMMERCIAL SPACE Royapettah Nr Ponnusamy Hotel 300 sft. Ct 9840420774

PERUNGUDI (OMR)
Nehru Nagar 7690sqft, Independent Building, G+2, Fully Furnished, 100 Work Stations, 7 Cabins, 2 Conference Hall, Centrally Air Conditioned, Power Backup, Server Room, Fire Exit, Car / 2 wheeler Parking.
Ct: 9840028833

RENTAL – COMMERCIAL

AMINJAKARAI NEXT to PH Road, Near Perumal Koil Ground Floor 1000sq. ft for Rent. 80563 18562 / 98401 80804

ARCOT RD Kodambakkam New 1200sft II flr Office/Shwrm/Lift 9444600232

VANAGRAM - NOOMBAL
17000 sft
READY TO OCCUPY
MODERN WAREHOUSE
NO INT COLUMNS
DECK HEIGHT 4 FEET 3 BAYS
98402 57114

SUNNYSIDE
Premium Space 31,000 Sq. Ft. lease Warm Shell 2nd-floor 14,500 sq. ft. + 16,500 sq. ft, (above Deutsche Bank) Ample basement parking, 100% power backup, 24/7 ground security. Ideal For Banks, MNCs etc
Add: 8/17, Shafee Mohd. Rd-Greams Rd, Nr Thousand Lights Metro, Chennai - 6. (Next to Apollo Child Hospital)
98404-33377

RENTAL – COMMERCIAL

VIRUGAMBAKKAM 2BHK Lift +Car /Bike Parking Rs.31,000/–. Ct:8248274117

KODAMBAKKAM GF 600sft,2ndFlr 1000sft,CCP,Lift closeto Metro:7299044330

ANNA NAGAR 3rd Avenue opp Govt Peripheral Hospital (Gandhi Nagar Hospital) GF 15000, FF 10000 for Showroom /Healthcare /Office Ct: 9841044411

ARUMBAKKAM SIDCO near metro station for office / factory/ warehouse First and Second 2500 sq.ft each floor. Lift parking Single Tenant preferred Ct: 94440 75410

DEV CO – Working Furnished Premium Office Spaces available in 4th Main Road, Anna Nagar, Chennai. Ct – 98842 900 97 / 98, Email – devcoworkingchennai@gmail.com

HOTEL 17 Rooms For Rent & Bank – 1500 Sqft For Rent @ Kattur Near OMR Thiruporur. Ct: 7305654751

OMR PADUR on Main Road Prime Standalone Building 2nd & 3rd Floor Carpet Area 4000sft with Ample Parking. Suitable for Salon, Beauty Parlour, Clinics, Scan Center, Hospitals, Gym and Wellness Etc. Ct:9940279868

PORUR GK Industrial Estate 2100Sft GF 15HP, 900Sft FF & 1800Sft GF 2500Sft FF 35HP & 12HP Commercial/ Godown/ Factory 9444143413/ 9791137839

NANGANALLUR NEAR Kumaran Theatre 2700sft Shed for Rent.Ct: 98403 77347

RENTAL – COMMERCIAL

NELSON MANICKAM Rd Comm. space for rent. All floors avail 1350sft each floor. Direct tenants only. Hanu Reddy: 9790733818.

PUDUCHERRY PRIME 8000sft space available for rent. Suitable for Clinics, Banks & Corporate offices. Not for food joints. 9840283023.

MYLAPORE OFFICE space 4800. sf. Lift /Car/ Bike park/. Cafeteria for Corporates. For site visit call 7299017249 / 9941277086

CLOUD KITCHEN SIRUSERI,OMR: with All Amenities Ready to Use 9884040221

KILPAUK SHOWROOM Nr Taylors Rd 4500Sqft G+Cp Ct: 9840033693/ 9840085898

THIRUVALLUR TO Uthukottai (Neiveli, Poondi Village) Main Road Commercial Building For Rent. Bank,Shops Purpose Ct:9080581249 / 9047895373

KK NAGAR 2000 Sqft Prime Commercial Property Avl for Rent. Suitable for Corporate Office / Clinic / Training Centre. Ct: 8807742845

GUINDY FULLY Furnished 20w/s Office Space 1200sft N/F Ct: 9940045008

ALWARPET REDY to Ocpy 700sf 12workspace 2Cabin Meeting Room 9444066548

NUNGAMBAKKAM MAHALINGAPURAM Main Road Ground Floor 1500sqft for Rent. Ct: 93810 49227 / 98402 29176

RETAIL SPACE for rent Uthandi, Ground Floor 1390 Sqft. Ct: 97890 11116

FACTORIES & SITES

SRIPERUMBUDUR NEARBY VALARPURAM Industrial/Warehouse 1.62Acres Land, Shed Builtup 44000sft Ct: 9940095075

RENTAL – RESIDENTIAL

ADAMBAKKAM

4 BHK & 2 BHK Flat for Rent 25K & 40K Mohanapuri Adambakkam CCTV Covered Car Park Ct: 7358538461

ADYAR

GOOD LOCATION Gated Community Flat 1875sqt 3BHK 4thFloor Power backup 2CCP Rent 95+ maint.nego.9500007697

ALWARPET

ALWARPET NR Venus cly 3BHK Semi furn Apartment 1,2 Lac MRC 174 & Nugmbkm 2&3BHK.TAR 9840707745/ 9566563721

ASTA ARISE 2400, 3300sft 3,4BHK North 2CCP Gym Spool Backup 8148648618

CIT COLONY 1200sft 2BR flat Lift CCP 45K working prfd Agent 9677290088

ANNA NAGAR

NEAR POST Office fully furnished 3BHK 1st flr Lift Gen CCP. 9444061611

POSH 3BHK, 1

INBRIEF

Tusker uses cleared passage to move to national park

In a positive sign towards mitigating human-wildlife conflict in Chinnakkanal under the Devikulam forest range in Idukki district of Keralam, a wild tusker named Chakkakompan has moved into the Mathikettan Shola National Park through a newly cleared natural elephant passage. Chief Conservator of Forests D.K. Vinod Kumar said the Forest department dismantled illegal fences obstructing elephant passages, after a directive issued by the Idukki Collector.

Rapunzel syndrome: 1-kg hair mass found in girl's stomach

A one-kg mass of hair was removed from the stomach and small intestine of a nine-year-old girl in a rare surgery at a private hospital in Thiruvananthapuram, Keralam. The girl was admitted to the hospital with persistent abdominal pain and vomiting. Scans revealed severe intestinal obstruction, and an endoscopy confirmed the mass of hair. The girl, who was diagnosed with Rapunzel syndrome, has now recovered and is eating normally, a doctor said.

Fashion photographer held in Keralam with drugs and cash

An Excise squad has arrested a fashion photographer with 38.13 gram of suspected MDMA and over ₹15 lakh in cash from Ernakulam district of Keralam. The arrested was identified as Arun K. Nair, 34. The team intercepted the car he was travelling in and seized the drug and cash. Deputy Excise Commissioner P.K. Satheesh told the media that the department suspected that the accused had been supplying narcotics to students and those in the film industry.

Councillor's threat to resign puts BJP in a fix in Keralam

BJP-led alliance is in power in Thiruvananthapuram Corporation with slender majority; Sreelekha has reportedly sent her resignation letter; Mayor says she only raised some 'personal inconveniences'

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

If R. Sreelekha resigns, the BJP-led NDA will be left with 49 councillors in the 101-member corporation. FILE PHOTO

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), which rules the Thiruvananthapuram Municipal Corporation in Keralam with a slender majority, plunged into a crisis on Saturday as party State vice-president R. Sreelekha reportedly expressed her desire to quit as the Sasthamangalam ward councillor.

The BJP-led National Democratic Alliance has 50 seats in the 101-member council and is ruling with the support of Independents. If Ms. Sreelekha resigns, the party will be left with 49 councillors.

Mayor V.V. Rajesh tried to downplay the development, saying Ms. Sreelekha had only handed over a letter expressing personal inconveniences. He did not confirm if the letter communicated her resignation, saying a councillor has to submit the letter of resignation to the Corporation Secretary. Ms. Sreelekha had earlier protested at not being considered for the post of Mayor.

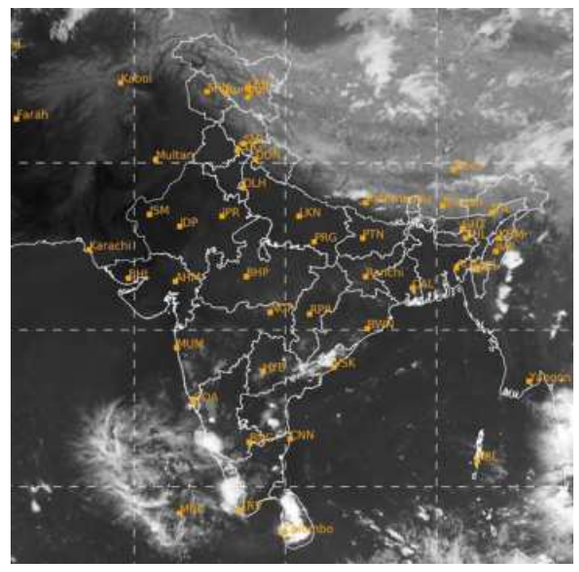
Corporation Secretary J. Muhammed Shafi, too, denied receiving an official communication from Ms. Sreelekha. Mr. Shafi clarified that according to Section 40 of the Kerala Municipality Act, a resignation letter has to be submitted to the Corporation Secretary.

Ms. Sreelekha reportedly mentioned in her ward's WhatsApp group that she had informed the Mayor through a letter on September 30 about resigning as a councillor for personal reasons. A copy of the letter would be submitted to the District Collector on Monday, she had said.

Mr. Rajesh said the party was trying to find ways to address the inconveniences pointed out by Ms. Sreelekha. "On the basis of the letter I got and the information shared with me, I'm trying to take things forward smoothly and address them in the best way possible," he said. Ms. Sreelekha could not be contacted for comments.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Sunday: Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Keralam and Mahe. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds very likely at isolated places over Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura and Andhra Pradesh. Hot and humid weather likely at isolated places over Konkan & Goa

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	—	34.4	26.4	Kurnool	—	37.4	25.8
Ahmedabad	—	37.0	22.5	Lucknow	—	34.0	24.2
Aizawl	—	31.8	20.4	Madurai	—	35.5	25.6
Bengaluru	—	30.1	21.2	Mangaluru	—	33.3	24.5
Bhopal	—	33.5	18.0	Mumbai	—	37.4	24.6
Bhubaneswar	—	35.2	26.0	Mysuru	—	32.2	19.2
Chandigarh	—	35.1	22.7	New Delhi	—	37.1	23.2
Chennai	—	36.2	27.4	Patna	—	33.6	26.5
Coimbatore	—	35.0	24.0	Port Blair	—	31.6	25.8
Dehradun	—	33.0	21.1	Prayagraj	—	34.6	23.6
Gangtok	4.2	22.9	17.4	Puducherry	—	34.3	25.8
Goa	—	34.5	24.6	Pune	—	35.4	21.9
Guwahati	—	34.0	23.5	Raipur	—	34.2	24.6
Hubballi	—	32.0	22.0	Ranchi	—	30.6	19.0
Hyderabad	—	33.4	22.8	Shillong	0.1	23.6	15.4
Imphal	7.8	28.7	21.1	Shimla	—	26.5	16.8
Jaipur	—	37.4	23.6	Srinagar	—	30.8	10.5
Kochi	—	31.2	26.6	Thiruvananthapuram	10.8	31.5	24.4
Kohima	—	21.6	16.6	Tiruchirappalli	—	35.7	25.4
Kolkata	—	33.6	27.0	Vijayawada	0.8	33.5	26.2
Kozhikode	—	33.6	28.0	Visakhapatnam	—	33.4	26.8

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO_2	NO_2	CO	PM2.5	PM10	CODE
Ahmedabad	.93	102	14	139	186	
Bengaluru	.27	.22	20	69	124	
Chennai	.7	.10	13	105	104	
Delhi	.27	.53	65	186	225	
Hyderabad	.8	.18	11	101	137	
Kolkata	.10	.46	34	190	133	
Lucknow	.23	.32	14	118	133	
Mumbai	.9	.64	43	78	115	
Pune	.18	.70	57	87	122	
Visakhapatnam	.14	.64	.—	—	150	

Yesterday

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Yamuna Nagar, Haryana recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 228 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Udupi, Karnataka recorded a healthy AQI score of 31

Air Quality Code: Poor | Moderate | Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO_2: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO_2: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM2.5 & PM10: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Telangana Cantonment firearms theft investigation indicates role of insiders

Naveen Kumar
HYDERABAD

Weeks before stealing firearms from the Army premises at Bolarum in Secunderabad Cantonment, former Havildar Upputholla Mallesh allegedly shared bank robbery videos with his cousin and an associate, asking them to study them. Investigators now say he had built a network comprising serving Army personnel and alleged arms dealers before the theft on August 30, 2026.

The details emerged during Mallesh's police custody from September 22 to October 1. Malkajgiri Police Commissioner B. Sumathi said financial difficulties after retirement, a grudge against superiors and a penchant for quick money led him to consider armed robberies.

The police said that before joining the force, Mallesh was involved in two theft cases and was known as a property offender under the alias 'Raju'.

When his funds ran out after retirement, Mallesh approached his cousin Upputholla Mallikarjun and discussed robberies using firearms. Mallesh initially tried to procure two pistols through arms dealers Birbal Shaw and Avi Dey, his contacts from West Bengal. Dey told him it would take around two months to arrange the pistols. Investigators said Mallesh then decided to steal arms from the Army unit. Three personnel at the Bolarum unit knew of Mallesh's plan. One of them gave him details of guard positions, the police said.

Dey had expressed interest in buying weapons, while Shaw allegedly acted as a broker for arms deals.

A.P. files plea in SC against court order on BC quota

V. Raghavendra
VIJAYAWADA

The Andhra Pradesh government filed a Special Leave Petition in the Supreme Court on Saturday, challenging the High Court order dated October 1 on reservation for the Backward Classes (BCs) in the local body elections.

The government argued that the judgment proceeded on the premise that the reservation exercise undertaken in 2026 suffered from the same infirmity as the earlier reservation exercise considered by the High Court in the Birru Prathap Reddy case.

Why slap FIRs for filing Form-7, BJP Karnataka unit asks police

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A BJP delegation led by former Karnataka Chief Minister B.S. Yediyurappa, State unit president B.Y. Vijayendra, Leader of Opposition in the Assembly R. Ashok, and Leader of Opposition in the Council Chalavadi Narayanaswamy met the Director-General and Inspector General of Police on Saturday, urging him to ensure that FIRs registered in connection with Form-7 applications during the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls be dealt with strictly according to the law.

In a memorandum, the delegation alleged that criminal cases were being registered against BJP workers and political activists for submitting Form-7 objections, and that the police machinery was being subjected to political pressure.

The BJP said that Form-7 is a statutory mechanism provided by the Election Commission for electors to object to inclusion of names or seek deletion of existing entries from electoral rolls.

It argued that the mere filing of multiple or bulk Form-7 applications cannot, by itself, constitute a criminal offence.

Did not stage dharna: CM

Meanwhile, Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar told reporters in Periyapatna that he and others, including Ministers, did not stage a dharna at the office of the Chief Electoral Officer, but had gone there to safeguard voters whose names were proposed for deletion under the SIR.

"I cannot place demands before Constitutional bodies, I can only make requests. Therefore, I went there to make an appeal in connection with Form-7 and the deletion of voters under SIR. Let a case be filed against me if I have done anything wrong, as claimed by the BJP leaders," he said.

Responding to the BJP leaders' allegations over his move at the CEC office, Mr. Shivakumar said he and his Cabinet colleagues had waited for the officials to arrive and did not stage any dharna as being alleged.

3D-printed houses set to be built in A.P. under Centre's PMAY-G scheme

V. Kamalakara Rao
VISAKHAPATNAM

October 4 will mark a defining milestone in India's infrastructure journey as Andhra Pradesh breaks new ground with a national-level pilot project to construct rural homes using 3D Concrete Printing (3DCP) under the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana-Gramin (PMAY-G) scheme.

The initiative will start with 100 housing units proposed in Burripalem of Guntur district and 77 units in Pothuru. The project has an outlay of ₹13.93 crore (excluding taxes), with the Union Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD) contributing ₹9.44 crore and the State government ₹4.49 crore.

Speaking to *The Hindu* on the integration of this cutting-edge approach, P. Veerabhadra Rao, Professor of Practice in the Department of Civil Engineering at GVP College of Engineering, Visakhapatnam, highlighted how shifting toward automation could redefine national habitat development.

Going hi-tech: 3D concrete printing replaces traditional masonry and sequential manual labour with a computer-controlled system.

Prof. Rao and his research team have conducted extensive research on these 3DCP models.

How does it work?

Construction-scale additive manufacturing – commonly called 3D Concrete Printing – replaces traditional masonry and manual labour with a computer-controlled system. A robotic printer directly translates a digital Building Information Modelling design into a physical structure by extruding specially formulated cementitious materials through a nozzle in successive horizontal layers.

The process relies heavily on materials science and automation to ensure the wet mix maintains precise extrudability and buildability, and sets rapidly without collapsing under its own weight.

"Landmarks such as Dubai's multi-storey printing feats, ICON's advanced Vulcan printers in Texas, and Japan's seismically compliant structures in Miyagi Prefecture have steadily pushed the technology... into heavily regulated commercial environments," Prof. Rao said.

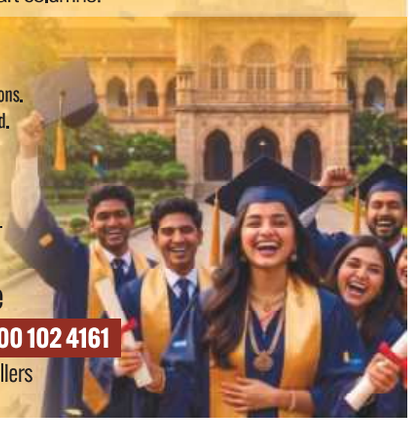
Classifieds

LIFE MADE SIMPLE — THE HINDU

THE HINDU Classifieds — EDUCATIONAL

Advertisement Rates The Hindu Chennai Edition	Special Value Offers!
Line Type Advt.: Rs.2,310 (2 Lines) Every additional line: Rs.915.	**Classifieds Sunday & Wednesday Combo Offer:** At just **25% extra** an Educational Advertisement in the Sunday Classifieds can be repeated under the same heading the following Wednesday in the Classifiedsmart columns.
Classifieds Display: Rs.1,300 per sqcm (Single Column) Rs.1,525 per sqcm (Double Column)	**Classifieds Sunday, Wednesday & Friday Combo Offer:** At just **35% extra** an Educational Advertisement in the Sunday Classifieds can be repeated under the same heading the following Wednesday and Friday in the Classifiedsmart columns.

The above offers are available for The Hindu Chennai, Tamil Nadu, Southern and All Editions. The advertisement copy will have to remain unchanged. The advertisements booked under combo offers cannot be cancelled subsequently. Terms & conditions apply.



For more details, please contact
Classifieds Customer Care
Phone: 044-28576342 Toll Free: 1800 102 4161
or Contact your nearest Authorised Space Sellers

EDUCATIONAL

VACANCIES

PET(FEMALE), TGT CSc, CHE, SOC & all other sub CBSE school Ambattur, CV: hr@pnet.school, WA:9840866819

WANTED
Applications are invited for the post of
PRINCIPAL
in CBSE experience
Apply on or before 6th October 2026
– CORRESPONDENT –
RAMACHANDRAA PUBLIC SCHOOL (CBSE)
Kottivakkam, Chennai-41.
Contact: 98406 20267
Email: correspondentrps chennai@gmail.com

PLAY SCHOOL, Annanagar–W reqs Montessori teacher 1–2yr exp. 9840080686

SVMHSS 104B,1ST Main Rd,Alwarthirunagar Annex Ch–87. Ph:23770088 /23771745/ 9884085559. Wanted 1.PGT –Comp Sci 2.SGT–All Subjects 3.Female office Assistants/Accounts Assistants

TEACHERS WANTED for a Preschool at Ayappakkam. Contact: 89396 45839

EDUCATION FOCUS

HOMETUITION ACCOUNTS Tax School College CA CS CMA All 7days 8610994743

GENERAL

FINANCE

SPOT CASH for 2Wheeler & 4Wheeler Mortgage / Immediate Cash 9787466599

HEALTH

HAPPY FOOT Reflexology. @ Shenoy Ngr. 60min– 999/– 9042 18 28 28

BODY MASSAGES Avl at Alwarpet @ PIVOT SPA. Ct: 97909 67299

HOME SERVICES

MARIAS (REGD) Provides Housemaids, Cooks, Patient Attenders. Little Mount, Ch–15. 22350602/ 984030997

MACHINERY FOR SALE

L&T ZUPERARC 300MIG HD welding 5no, KWP250amps MIG 3no 1.5L 9840716176

PEST CONTROL

NETLON SAINTGOBAIN SS Doortype SV Trading Authorised Dealer:9940386715

MEDICAL

MRI RS.2900 CT Rs.900 Ultrasound Rs.500 MHC + Echo Rs.2500 SVDC, Inside DG Vaishnav College Arumbakkam 7824048299/399 7am–7pm Sun Hol

OTHERS

AUTOMOTIVE

INDEX OF AUTOMOTIVE
FINANCE
RENTAL/HIRE SERVICES
SPARE PARTS/ GARAGE
BUYING
SELLING

FOUR WHEELERS

BUYING

GENERAL

GT REDDY Cars T.Ngr Buy/Sell Used Cars For Best Price Call:9841055555

SELLING

B M W

BMW-X1 Diesel- Automatic, 34K-kms, 2019,II-owner exInt cond. 9380744632

MAHINDRA

SCORPIO SLE silver Dec 2010 Dealer maintn Newtyres 237000km 9600044450

TATA

TATA HEXA XM 2017 TN02 Reg 2nd Owner 118000 km Company Maintained. Brokers Excuse: 9566473777

RENTAL / HIRE SERVICES

AT ANNAGR Ch–EV Load Vehicle 3& 4Wheeler On Monthly Contract:9841616782

TWO WHEELERS

BUYING

WANTED USED Any Vehicle /Model/ Make/Condn/State, Spot Cash. 9841002826

From Page One

Protests persist as Rahul calls for joint 'resistance'

The National Students' Union of India, the student wing of the Congress, staged a protest at the India Gate over alleged irregularities in the SIR process and demanded the arrest of the CEC.

Mr. Gandhi said the platform would allow people to share their stories and see who else was fighting similar battles. He also promised to take up their concerns "in Parliament, on the streets, through letters, wherever I am needed".

In the accompanying video, Mr. Gandhi said protests relating to land, women's rights, Dalit and OBC rights, education, and examinations were taking place across the country. "We want to help organise these protests, put them together on one map, and work together with you to see if we can help you resolve what you're fighting for," he said.

"As the Leader of the Opposition, it is important for me to help people resist where truth is being crushed," Mr. Gandhi said. "The truth is important. It is important at the highest levels, but it is important that we fight for it in every corner of the country."

Later in the evening, he said the 'Satyagraha' platform had received over 10,000 responses in nine hours after it went live. "That's how many struggles Indians are already fighting – quietly, convinced no one was listening. We are listening. Every submission will be read," he said.

Mr. Ramesh alleged that the government had been formed through "stolen votes" and said the detention of citizens, students and Congress workers would not deter the protests. "The protests continue today as well, and people will keep raising their voices," he said.

He said Mr. Gandhi's initiative sought "to unite all those voices, no matter who is resisting or where", adding that "our unity is our greatest strength".

Mr. Kharge, speaking in Kalaburagi, Karnataka, said the Opposition would continue its agitation against the SIR and alleged that the exercise was adversely affecting poor people, workers, the uneducated and minorities. He demanded that fresh elections be held through ballot papers.

"Today, the entire country is being run on illegal elections. Modi is an illegal Prime Minister, Shah is an illegal Minister, and all the Chief Ministers who have been elected anywhere are illegal," Mr. Kharge said, demanding that the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies be dissolved.

He also attacked the 2023 law granting immunity to the CEC and Election Commissioners for acts done in the discharge of their official duties. Referring to reports of objections raised by Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi over aspects of the SIR, Mr. Kharge said their concerns had not altered the process.

Boiler blast at Sri City pharma unit kills five

Upon receiving information of the explosion on Saturday morning, District Collector S. Venkateswar and Superintendent of Police L. Subbarayudu, along with other officials, reached the site to oversee the relief efforts.

Health Minister Satya Kumar Yadav spoke to District Medical and Health Officer (DMHO) Balakrishna Naik over phone and directed him to ensure that the injured received quality medical treatment.

The DMHO told the Minister that emergency response teams, medical personnel, and other officials had reached the site and initiated relief measures.

He told the Minister that the bodies of Gourab and Mohan were shifted to the Sullurpeta Government Hospital, while those of Chinna Mastan and Ramesh were moved to the Satyavedu Government Hospital for a post-mortem examination.

The DMHO also informed that a woman, Krishnaveni (38), who sustained a leg injury, was treated at the accident site and her condition was stable. Two other workers, Ramu and Lakshmamma, who were present at the accident site, did not sustain injuries.

The District Collector announced an ex gratia of ₹50 lakh to the next of kin of each of the deceased.

The Sri City SEZ management said it would bear the educational expenses of the children of the deceased. Eligible family members of the deceased would also be provided employment within the Sri City, the Collector said.

In addition to registering a preliminary case against those responsible, a special team, comprising senior officials from the Boiler, Factories, Industries, and Police departments, has been constituted to inquire into the incident. Strict action would be taken against those responsible based on the inquiry report, the Collector said.

Orders were also issued to suspend the Tirupati Boiler Inspector for negligence in discharging his duties, he said, while noting that this was the first such accident in Sri City since its inception. He further said that instructions were also issued to immediately conduct a third-party safety audit across all the industries in Sri City to prevent the recurrence of such incidents.

Pharma unit assures assistance

Meanwhile, addressing the media, Tablets India Limited Director Ajay Kumar said, "We are committed to fully cooperating with the government authorities and all concerned agencies in conducting a thorough investigation into the cause of the accident." "At this difficult time, our immediate priority is to support the affected employees and their families...," Mr. Ajay Kumar added.

9 lakh names dropped from electoral roll in Uttarakhand

Final roll contains 71.59 lakh names, including 1,29,872 newly enrolled voters; State to begin drive to enrol missing voters, with BLOs visiting homes to help eligible people fill Form 6, says CEO

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

Detailed exercise: The final electoral roll comprises 34,21,036 women, 37,37,701 men and 212 third-gender voters. FILE PHOTO

Around nine lakh names have been removed from Uttarakhand's electoral roll through the special intensive revision (SIR). The final electoral roll was published on Saturday, carrying the names of 71.59 lakh electors in the State.

Speaking to the media, Uttarakhand Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) B.V.R.C. Purushottam said the final roll includes 1,29,872 newly enrolled voters.

When the SIR exercise began in June, the State had 79,60,762 registered voters. The first draft roll, published on July 14, contained 71,33,785 names.

The State accepted claims and objections until August 13, while hearings and disposal of cases continued until September 28, ahead of the publication of the final roll on Saturday.

"Compared with the draft roll published in July, the number of electors has risen by about 25,000, as 1,04,708 names were deleted following claims and objections, while more than 1.29 lakh names were added," Mr. Purushottam said.

Sharing the gender-wise details, the official said the final roll comprises 34,21,036 women, 37,37,701 men and 212 third-gender voters. It includes 72,656 voters aged 18-19 years and 1,22,892 voters above the age of 80. The State has 12,543 polling stations.

Special enrolment drive

Addressing concerns over those who could not make it to the final poll list, Mr. Purushottam said people who were left out, as well as those who have become newly eligible to vote, can apply by filling Form 6 either online through the ECINet app or offline through their booth-level officer (BLO).

The State will now begin a special drive to enrol missing and eligible voters, following the nearly 10% decline in the electoral roll, with a large number of voters placed in the "uncollectable absent, shifted, dead, or duplicate (ASDD)" category. Dehradun recorded the highest number of such voters at 1,86,008, followed by Udham Singh Nagar with 1,77,673 and Haridwar with 1,30,203.

"A special campaign to enrol new voters will now begin. Under the plan, BLOs will compare the current roll with the pre-SIR list, identify voters who were earlier listed but are now missing, and visit them at home to help eligible people fill Form 6. They will also ensure forms are filled for first-time and young voters and share the list with booth-level agents of recognised political parties," the official said. He added that Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) would subsequently share booth-wise lists with party representatives.

Vote theft, claims Cong.

Meanwhile, senior vice-president of the Uttarakhand Pradesh Congress Committee, Suryakant Dhasmana, expressed dissatisfaction with the final electoral roll and demanded that the Election Commission (EC) make public the complete Assembly constituency-wise details of voters whose names were deleted during the pre-SIR and SIR exercises.

"They have deleted over 8.5 lakh names in the final list while 4.5 lakh names were deleted pre-SIR. This totals to the deletion of 13 lakh names in such a small State," claimed Mr. Dhasmana.

He alleged that most of the deletions were carried out under what he described as a "vote theft" formula and claimed that irregularities in Forms 6 and 7 had come to light, following which the EC took a U-turn, raising questions over the exercise.

NHRC seeks report over minors at CJP protest in Mumbai

Chinmay Gaikwad
MUMBAI

Gathering took place on a road, disrupted traffic, and created a law-and-order situation, say police

The Mumbai Police registered a first information report (FIR) on Saturday against the organisers of a protest on Friday by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and 400-500 unidentified persons. The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC), meanwhile, sought action-taken reports over a complaint which alleged that children below 18 years were involved in the gathering.

An FIR was registered at the Shivaji Park police station under provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and the Maharashtra Police Act, based on a complaint, made by Shivaji Park resident Siddhi Deolekar, which named CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke among others. According to the FIR, 400-500 protesters gathered near Gate No. 6 of the Shivaji Park grounds around 2 p.m. and remained there until 7 p.m. The police said the gathering took place on a road, disrupted traffic, and created a law-and-order situation.

Mr. Dipke organised the "Jail Bharo" protest demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over irregularities in the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Based on another complaint over participation of children in the gathering, the NHRC took cognizance of the matter under Section 12 of the Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993. The complainant, Satish Vaid, head of intervention, Sewa Nyaya Utthan Foundation, said photographs and videos of children in the protest were circulated on platforms. The rights body sought action-taken reports from the authorities within a week.

The complaint said a child was held above a crowd with the National Flag and a placard while slogans were raised and people recorded it all on phones. It said the discussions raised the premise that police may not detain children.

The Commission said the issue was not only the presence of children. It said if the allegations were proved, it would raise a concern about planning, mobilisation, or use of children with knowledge of their age and vulnerability. *(With inputs from PTI)*

On the draw

Police removing badges before detaining protesters, says CPI MP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

CPI MP P. Sandosh Kumar on Saturday alleged that Delhi Police personnel have been removing or concealing their identity badges before detaining or using force against protesters and urged Union Home Minister Amit Shah to order a time-bound inquiry into the practice.

In a letter to the Minister, Mr. Kumar sought his intervention into repeated use of violence, arbitrary detentions and other unlawful practices by the Delhi Police while dealing with democratic protests.

The National Secretariat Member of the CPI was himself detained on Friday along with CPI workers and cadres of the AISF and AIYF during a protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

He expressed serious concern that the Delhi Police, which is directly answerable to the Union Home Ministry, has repeatedly responded to peaceful political mobilisation with "violence, mass detentions, internet shutdowns and manhandling" instead of protecting citizens exercising their democratic rights at a protest site designated by the Supreme Court and the National Green Tribunal (NGT).

Citing the Supreme Court's directions in *D.K. Basu v. State of West Bengal* and Delhi Police Standing Order No. 51, the Rajya Sabha MP said that identification is essential for accountability when the police exercise coercive powers against citizens.

India, Pak. summon diplomats over two men killed by BSF

Suhasini Haidar
Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

India and Pakistan summoned each other's diplomats and traded charges on Saturday over the killing of two Pakistani men whom the Border Security Force said had attempted to infiltrate through the International Border along Punjab's Tarn Taran district.

Pakistan's Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) summoned the Indian Charge d'Affaires (CdA) in Islamabad on Saturday to protest the killings of men they said were "unarmed civilians". Late in the evenjng, India also summoned the Pakistan Charge d'Affaires to reject the Pakistani statement and protested "the continued facilitation of illegal cross-border infiltration from Pakistan".

After completing the post-mortem procedures, a senior BSF official told *The Hindu* that they handed over the bodies to Pakistani Rangers on Saturday. Officials did not confirm whether any weapons had been found on the men, who had been accused of trying to infiltrate through the border fencing on Friday morning.

While the BSF said that they had shot at the men, including one who ran away, when they attempted to cross over at the International Border along Tarn Taran district, Pakistan's Foreign Ministry accused the Indian security forces of using "unprovoked lethal force against unarmed civilians".

"Such use of force was wholly unjustified and grossly disproportionate, resulting in the tragic loss of two precious lives. Pakistan categorically rejects any attempt to mischaracterise the deceased as 'infiltrators'," the Pakistan MoFA said in a statement.

However, the Ministry of External Affairs said that the incident highlighted "a clear pattern of repeated cross-border movement by armed narcotics syndicates operating from Pakistan"

Citizen groups slam Rijiju's description of Manipur issue

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

A coalition of 14 civil society organisations in Manipur has criticised Union Minority Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju for describing the prolonged violence in the State solely as a communal conflict.

The coalition, which was at the forefront of a movement that made the Centre defer the Census exercise in Manipur, said the conflict was linked to armed groups. It questioned the Centre's approach to these groups despite failing to address the security dimensions of the crisis.

"The Union Minister's description of the Manipur conflict and his emphasis on dialogue reflected an 'inadequate understanding' of the security scenario," said Shanta Nahakpam, the coalition's convenor.

"The violence has involved armed extremist groups, and attacks on civilians and villages," he told journalists in Imphal on Saturday.

Insulting people's mandate old habit of Cong.: Chouhan

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Saturday said Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge calling Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah "illegal" amounted to an insult to constitutional institutions and the people's mandate.

"The country's democracy stands firmly on the foundation of the Constitution given by Babasaheb Ambedkar, and the people will continue to respond to such false and baseless statements democratically time and again," Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said in a statement.

"Mr. Kharge's statement, made at the direction of Leader of the Opposition [in the Lok Sabha] Rahul Gandhi, reflects the Congress' frustration and mindset following electoral defeats," Mr. Chouhan said.

Stating that the Congress chief's remarks were yet another example of the party's "longstanding practice of attacking constitutional institutions", he said, "Whenever the people of the country reject the Congress in elections, it begins conspiring to discredit democracy, the Election Commission, EVMs (Electronic Voting Machines), and the mandate of the people."

Shivraj Singh Chouhan

"Does democracy, in the Congress party's view, become legitimate only when the Gandhi family or the Congress party is in power?" he asked. Mr. Chouhan said the Congress had not questioned EVMs when it won elections in Karnataka, Telangana, or Himachal Pradesh.

Fighter jet deal likely by end of fiscal year: IAF chief

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

India expects to finalise the much-awaited Multi-Role Fighter Aircraft (MRFA) deal by the end of the current financial year, provided the ongoing process progresses as planned, Air Chief Marshal A.P. Singh said on Saturday.

The proposed acquisition of 114 fighter aircraft is at the price negotiation stage, with discussions also under way on other critical aspects of the programme.

In February, the government cleared the long-pending proposal to procure 114 Rafale fighter jets from France through a government-to-government framework.

Speaking at a press conference ahead of Air Force Day on October 8, Mr. Singh said the IAF could also look at acquiring another fighter platform if the Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA) programme encounters delays. "Russia has offered us Su-57 jets, but no decision has been made on it," he said.

Trinamool Congress loses chairpersonship of two key parliamentary committees

Leaders of some BJP allies, such as JD(U), Shiv Sena and the TDP, retained as heads of different parliamentary panels; DMK's Kanimozhi, Tiruchi Siva and Congress's Tharoor, Channi retained

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Trinamool Congress has lost the chairpersonship of two key parliamentary panels as Rajya Sabha Chairman C.P. Radhakrishnan and Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla on Saturday reconstituted various department-related parliamentary standing committees.

While the BJP's Sudhanshu Trivedi has been appointed the new chairperson of the parliamentary committee on commerce, replacing Trinamool's Dola Sen, Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, leader of Trinamool's rebel faction, has replaced her former party colleague Kirti Azad as the chairperson of the panel on chemicals and fertilizers.

DMK MPs Tiruchi Siva and K. Kanimozhi have been re-appointed chairpersons of the parliamentary committee on industry and the panel on food, consumer affairs and public distribution, respectively.

The leaders of some key BJP allies – JD(U), Shiv Sena, and the TDP – have also been retained as heads of different parliamentary committees.

In new roles: BJP's Sudhanshu Trivedi (left) replaces Trinamool's Dola Sen, while, rebel Trinamool leader Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar (right) replaces former colleague Kirti Azad. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA, PTI

Other heads and panels

Some Opposition leaders, including Shashi Tharoor and Charanjit Singh Channi of the Congress, have also been retained as chairpersons of the committees on external affairs and agriculture, respectively.

Congress's Mukul Wasnik has been retained as the head of the parliamentary panel on education, women, children and youth, while Samajwadi Party's Ram Gopal Verma has been retained as the chairperson of the panel on health and family welfare. The BJP's Radha Mohan Singh will head the panel on defence.

Sanjay Kumar Jha of the JD(U) has been reappointed as the chairperson of the parliamentary panel on transport, tourism, and culture, while Shiv Sena's Shrirang Barne has been retained as head of the panel on energy.

BJP's Sujeet Kumar has replaced his party MP Brij Lal as the chairperson of the parliamentary panel on personnel, public grievances, law, and justice.

Former Union Minister Anurag Thakur has been reappointed as the head of the panel on coal, mines, and steel, while the BJP's Rajiv Pratap Rudy has been retained as the chairperson of the panel on water resources. BJP's Bhartruhari Mahtab will continue to head the panel on finance, while his party colleague Radha Mohan Das Agarwal has been retained as the head of the panel on home affairs.

BJP's Nishikant Dubey has also been reappointed as the head of the panel on communications and information technology, while party MP from Maharashtra, Medha Vishram Kulkarni, has been retained as the chairperson of the committee on science and technology, environment, forests and climate change.

Sudheer Gupta of the BJP has replaced party colleague C.M. Ramesh as the chairperson of the panel on railways, while the Congress' Saptagiri Sankar Ulaka has been reappointed as head of the panel on rural development and Panchayati Raj.

Cases will be completed in 3 years under new criminal laws, says Home Minister

Mehul Malpani
BHOPAL

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Saturday said in Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh, that criminal cases in the country will be completed within three years, even if they go all the way to the Supreme Court, once the new criminal laws are fully implemented.

Mr. Shah, who is also the Minister for Cooperation, was speaking at a cattle rearers' conference, 'Gaupalak Sammelan'. Along with Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, he also inaugurated a State-level exhibition on the new criminal codes at Bhopal's BHEL Dussehra ground.

"Our justice system was once known for its '*tareekh pe tareekh* (date after date)' taunts. Once the laws are fully implemented in one to one-and-a-half years, whatever FIR you file, the culprit will be punished within three years, up to the Supreme Court," he said, adding that the old codes were made by the British to protect their rule.

Madhya Pradesh meet: Amit Shah, along with Mohan Yadav attend the 'Gopalak Sammelan' in Bhopal on Saturday. PTI

'Modern provisions'

"Now, the new laws have been made to protect the honour, property and body of the Indian public. Their *mool mantra* (fundamental principle) is justice. After their full implementation, our criminal justice system will become the most modern in the world. We have integrated various modern scientific technologies in it, like digital evidence, e-summons, online hearings, video conferencing and various provisions related to FSL (forensic science laboratories)," the Union Minister said.

"There are provisions for women's safety, [finding] missing children and protection from terrorism and lynching in them," Mr. Shah added.

The three new criminal codes – Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) and Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam (BSA) – came into force in the country on July 1, 2024. They replaced the Indian Penal Code (IPC), 1860; the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC), 1973; and the Indian Evidence Act, 1872; respectively.

Mr. Shah virtually laid the foundation for a ₹255-crore milk processing plant, with the capacity to process three lakh litres per day, in Ujjain. He also inaugurated a milk processing plant and a research laboratory in Bhopal and a mini dairy plant in Shivpuri.

He said that the infrastructure will help increase income for cattle rearers.

Mr. Shah said that India is the largest milk producer in the world and that the per capita milk availability in the country has increased from 307 grams per day in 2013-14 to 485 grams per day now.

AAP leader Priyanka Kakkar moves to Congress

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Former Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) chief spokesperson Priyanka Kakkar joined the Congress on Saturday, saying she could no longer "defend the indefensible" and praising Rahul Gandhi's "authentic" leadership. Ms. Kakkar joined the party along with former Uttar Pradesh MLA Shyam Sunder Sharma and former journalist Rajat Rakesh Tandon.

Explaining her decision to leave the AAP, Ms. Kakkar said the party had once attracted people of "great substance and intelligence", but had since changed. "There was a time when it was said our leaders would not accept a bungalow or a car. But later, choppers were being used for private travel; I could no longer defend the indefensible," she said.

She also questioned the elevation of people without organisational experience to senior positions, saying she had "drawn a line" over the party's recent decisions. "New people who have not even worked at the booth level are being brought in from Rajasthan and given senior positions in Punjab, along with bungalows and cars. How long can I defend the indefensible?" she asked.

Mamata faction writes to LS, RS heads on exclusion from chairing committees

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The All India Trinamool Congress faction that backs former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee on Saturday wrote to Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla and Rajya Sabha Chairman C.P. Radhakrishnan protesting its exclusion from the chairpersonship of any department-related parliamentary standing committees.

The party's Lok Sabha leader Abhishek Banerjee and Rajya Sabha leader Derek O'Brien have written separate letters to the presiding officers of their respective Houses.

In his letter to Mr. Birla, he objected to the appointment of Lok Sabha MP Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar (rebel Trinamool leader) as chairperson of the standing committee on chemicals and fertilizers, questioning under which party affiliation the chairmanship had been allotted. "The member appointed claims affiliation with Nationalist Citizens Party of India (NCPI) through a purported merger disputed in the pending disqualification proceedings," Mr. Banerjee said.

Abhishek Banerjee

The NCPI's reported association with the NDA cannot settle the question of affiliation under the Tenth Schedule, he argued. "That question requires a decision in the pending proceedings." Appointing a member to a panel chairmanship while leaving the member's disputed affiliation undecided is, according to the AITC, contrary to parliamentary propriety. "This appointment cannot be treated as a chairmanship allotted to AITC," he said.

In his letter, Mr. O'Brien wrote that when the Trinamool was the third-largest party in the House in 2019, it was denied a committee chair. He said that the situation was corrected a few years later. "Now it is back to square one... Parliament is being turned into a deep, dark chamber," he added.

Trace, bring back 2 Assam women sent to Bangladesh, Gogoi writes to Jaishankar

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Congress Member of Parliament Gaurav Gogoi has urged Union External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar to help trace and bring back two Assam women pushed into Bangladesh two months after the Gauhati High Court asked a Foreigners' Tribunal to review its 2019 decision that they were non-citizens.

The whereabouts of Jahanara Begum of Bagariguri village and Mumtaz Begum of Dhing Gaon – both in central Assam's Nagaon district – remain unknown since they were sent across the India-Bangladesh border on the intervening night of June 13 and 14, Mr. Gogoi said in a letter to Mr. Jaishankar on Friday.

Gaurav Gogoi

The Foreigners' Tribunal in Nagaon declared the two women as foreigners in 2019. They challenged the verdicts before the Gauhati High Court, which set aside the Foreigners' Tribunal's opinions in April, and asked it to revisit their cases afresh because material evidence had not been properly considered.

"This is a matter in which your Ministry has already been made a party by the Gauhati High Court. I, therefore, request your personal intervention to ensure that both women are traced and, if they are indeed in Bangladesh, brought back to India at the earliest," Mr. Gogoi urged Mr. Jaishankar.

Mr. Gogoi also requested the Ministry of External Affairs to direct the High Commission of India in Dhaka and the Assistant High Commission of India in Sylhet to actively pursue the matter with Bangladesh, and facilitate appropriate consular assistance and travel documentation for the return of the two women to India, subject to the necessary formalities.

Their families should be kept informed, through an appropriate point of contact, about the progress of the efforts to trace them, he said.

Punjab Cong. chief pitches 'team spirit' to faction-ridden unit

Sandeep Phukan
NEW DELHI

Amid deep factionalism in the Punjab Congress and ahead of the Assembly election, newly appointed Pradesh Congress Committee (PCC) chief Pargat Singh on Saturday drew on his experience as former captain of the Indian hockey team, and stressed the importance of team spirit and being a team player.

Replacing Amarinder Singh Raja Warring, who headed the party's Punjab unit for more than four years, Mr. Singh repeatedly used the language of sport to underline his approach to the job.

"I have been a team player," he told reporters here, adding that he had always played as a "full-back" – a position centred on supporting the team from behind.

"I feel there are very good players in our team. We will take all decisions unanimously," he said, in a clear attempt to reach out to the party's competing factions and senior leaders.

Pargat Singh

'Issue is Punjab, not us'

He recast the gaze from internal differences to the larger political context in Punjab. "The issue is Punjab and not differences amongst us," he said, while describing Mr. Warring as a "player of our team".

He also said that all the senior leaders would be ahead of him in the team.

"We are a team. This is Rahul Gandhi's team," Mr. Singh said, adding that the Congress would pursue "constructive politics" and seek to "revive democracy".

His emphasis on cohesion comes at a politically difficult moment for the Punjab Congress, which has been marked by factional differences as the party prepares for the Assembly election, due early next year.

Mr. Singh, who called on the All India Congress Committee general secretary in-charge of Punjab, Sachin Pilot, stressed on building a "very good team in Punjab" and gave a call to those who had left the party to return if they wanted to contribute to the State.

Mr. Pilot said Mr. Singh's experience as a national hockey team captain would help the Congress even though there isn't much time left for the Punjab polls.

Former Union Minister Ashwani Kumar, who had left the Congress a few years ago, said though Mr. Singh's appointment was "somewhat unexpected," the decision represented a generational shift in the State leadership.

Hasina's extradition possible via legal process, says envoy

Kallol Bhattacherjee
DHAKA

Extradition of Bangladesh's deposed Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina could take place via a "well-structured process" that involved "legality", said India's High Commissioner to Bangladesh Dinesh Trivedi on Saturday. A legal process was "in place", he added.

Speaking of Ms. Hasina's presence in India at the Bay of Bengal Conversation, an annual conclave organised by the Dhaka-based Centre for Governance Studies, Mr. Trivedi said Ms. Hasina had sought refuge in India based on a decision taken by those governing Bangladesh in July-August 2024, and that, "India had hardly any choice."

"Again and again, the Government of India through the Spokesperson in MEA (Ministry of External Affairs) has replied to this – that there is a process, and that the process involves legality, and it is well-structured. So, as far as that is concerned, the process is on," Mr. Trivedi said in response to a question from a student at the conclave on Ms. Hasina's extradition.

The incumbent government of Bangladesh, led by Prime Minister Tarique Rahman, has demanded several times that Ms. Hasina be extradited to face justice for the July-August 2024 crackdown that led to the death of at least 800 civilians, including many students. A panel under the Office of the UN High Commissioner for Human Rights placed the number of fatalities at about 1,400.

"The legal process is there in place, which you can be very sure [about] – India being as vibrant and democratic as Bangladesh is – and you will also respect the legal system, and the legal system is on," Mr. Trivedi said, adding, "Nobody can give you a time frame [for the extradition]."

The Bangladesh government has demanded several times that former PM Sheikh Hasina be extradited to face justice. REUTERS

India and Bangladesh signed an extradition treaty in 2013, with specified grounds under which it may be halted, including "offence of a political character". Mr. Trivedi spoke of the "tragic circumstances" in Bangladesh while referring to India's decision to provide refuge to Ms. Hasina.

"The situation arose because of tragic circumstances in Bangladesh, that must not be repeated anywhere else in the world. At that point in time, Ms. Hasina was still the PM of Bangladesh. We hardly had any choice on that and it was our duty to accept the reality of life," the High Commissioner said.

He also referred to the abrupt nature of developments in the final moments of the anti-Hasina uprising, adding, "because situations are such, where at times you are not prepared for it".

'Only option'

On August 5, 2024, Ms. Hasina was first airlifted from near her residence in Bangladesh by a military helicopter and then flown to India by the Bangladesh Air Force aircraft. Mr. Trivedi recalled the involvement of Bangladesh's then existing government machinery in facilitating Ms. Hasina's evacuation from Dhaka, and said, "Ms. Hasina was not brought to India by the Indian Air Force or Indian Army."

"What was our choice? If you would have said no to that, and that we were not going to accept, or if we did not give landing permission, then things would have been different," Mr. Trivedi said in a session titled 'Power and Prudence' on the first day of the three-day conclave being held at Hotel Sonargaon in Dhaka.

Mr. Trivedi maintains that a good neighbour would not interfere in the internal affairs of neighbouring States. "Bangladesh is an independent country. It will decide independently with which country it will build and maintain relations," the High Commissioner said.

(*The correspondent is in Bangladesh at the invitation of the Centre for Governance Studies, Dhaka to participate in the 2026 Bay of Bengal Conversation.*)

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM TECHNOPARK HARMONY@WORK
keralaIT
RFP No. ETPK/MKTG/GCC-LAUNCHPAD/RFP/2026/01
Request for Proposals are invited for **Appointment of Managed Office Operator in Technopark Phase 1 Campus for Keralam GCC Launchpad —Technopark, Thiruvananthapuram, Keralam.** The last date of submission of RFP is 31.10.2026.
For further details, please visit **https://www.technopark.in/tenders**
Date: 01-10-2026 **Chief Executive Officer**
Trivandrum **D3/578/2026/I&PRD** **Technopark**

INBRIEF

Head of U.S. Pacific Command visiting India to boost ties

Commander of the U.S. Pacific Command Admiral Samuel J. Paparo is visiting India till October 8 to advance the U.S.-India Major Defense Partnership and deepen military-to-military cooperation between the two countries. Admiral Paparo is scheduled to engage with his Indian counterparts on a range of shared security priorities, including digital transformation and emerging technologies, regional strategic stability, defence energy resilience and the challenges posed by an increasingly competitive technology landscape. The visit comes amid expanding defence and security cooperation between India and the U.S.

CBI names RCom, ex-Reliance executives in LIC fraud case

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has filed a charge sheet against Reliance Communications Limited (RCom), two former executives of the Reliance (Anil Ambani) Group, and others in the LIC investment fraud case that caused alleged loss of ₹3,750 crore. According to the agency, LIC subscribed to Non-Convertible Debentures (NCDs) worth ₹1,500 crore issued by RCom in 2012 on the basis of serious misrepresentations. The funds received through the NCD subscription were thereafter diverted to Group companies, thereby causing wrongful loss to LIC and corresponding wrongful gain to the accused persons and entities.

Five Indians rescued after tanker hit in Strait of Hormuz

Five Indian nationals were rescued after a Kuwait-flagged tanker was struck by a projectile in the Strait of Hormuz, the Indian mission in Oman said on Saturday. In a post on X, the Indian embassy said it coordinated the rescue of the five Indians on board the *MT Kazimah III*, with all of them safely shifted ashore. It thanked the Oman authorities for their assistance in the rescue operation. The mission did not give further details about the incident, which came in the backdrop of heightened tensions in the Gulf region. Several commercial vessels, with Indian seafarers aboard, have come under attack amid escalating tensions in West Asia. PTI

Narco-trafficking kingpin deported from Turkiye: Shah

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Saturday said that hardened narco-trafficking kingpin Navpreet Singh has been deported from Turkiye to India in connection with drug trafficking and other criminal cases. Mr. Shah said that the accused obtained Turkish citizenship under a fake identity and smuggle methamphetamine and heroin to India from Afghanistan. Mr. Shah said: "Our agencies tracked him down... and secured his deportation. Today he has been brought back to India and put behind bars in connection with cases involving drug trafficking and other crimes. Congratulations to all the agencies for this success."

SUDOKU

			6					
4		5			2	6		
		1	8	3	4			
7				2			1	6
1			3		9			5
6	8			7				9
			2	8	3	9		
		8	1			5		2
					5			

No. SS7021 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★☆☆☆☆

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

1	8	7	6	3	4	5	2	9
9	3	2	5	8	1	7	6	4
5	6	4	9	2	7	3	8	1
6	5	9	4	7	8	2	1	3
3	7	1	2	9	6	8	4	5
2	4	8	3	1	5	6	9	7
8	2	5	1	4	3	9	7	6
7	1	6	8	5	9	4	3	2
4	9	3	7	6	2	1	5	8

Rising child leprosy cases challenge India's 2027 goal

Country records 3,832 child leprosy cases in 2025-26, a figure that is 91.6% above the Centre's target of 2,000; 37 Grade-2 disability cases point to delayed detection and ongoing transmission

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

India recorded 3,832 new leprosy cases among children in 2025-26, including 37 who had Grade-2 disability (G2D) at diagnosis – an indicator of delayed detection. The child caseload was 91.6% higher than the National Leprosy Eradication Programme's (NLEP) target of 2,000 cases for the year.

The figures, from the latest NLEP annual report for 2025-26, come even as India pursues the National Strategic Plan for Leprosy 2023-27, which seeks to interrupt transmission at the district level by 2027.

Under the roadmap, a district is considered to have interrupted transmission after reporting zero new indigenous child cases for five consecutive years.

The NLEP's programme objectives include zero disability among new child cases and a national G2D rate of less than one case per million population. The roadmap projects 1,000 child cases and a G2D rate of 0.5 per million for 2026-27.

The Health Ministry has identified high-priority States and districts where the burden remains concentrated. FILE PHOTO

Epidemiologic question

The World Health Organisation (WHO) considers new cases among children below 15 years an indicator of recent transmission, while G2D among newly detected patients indicates delayed diagnosis.

The WHO also says disabilities among newly detected child cases signal both delayed detection and ongoing transmission.

India recorded 63 children with G2D in 2019-20, followed by 35 in 2020-21, 41 in 2021-22, 55 in 2022-23 and 45 in 2023-24. The continued detection of children with G2D contrasts with the NLEP's objective of zero disability among new child cases.

The latest numbers therefore raise a fundamental epidemiological question: if India is working to interrupt transmission by 2027, why are children still developing leprosy, and why are some reaching diagnosis only after visible disability has appeared?

India detected 91,783 new leprosy cases in 2025-26, according to the Union Health Ministry. The prevalence rate was 0.56 per 10,000 population, and 1,945 patients had Grade-2 disability at diagnosis, accounting for 2.12% of all newly detected cases. The national G2D rate was 1.34 per million, above the NLEP's target of less than one case per million.

Global hubs

According to the WHO's latest global update, India reported the world's largest number of newly detected leprosy cases in 2025, with 91,783 cases, followed by Brazil with 22,901 and Indonesia with 16,292. Together, the three countries accounted for 78.3% of all new cases reported globally. The WHO notes that, although the update is for 2025, India reported data for April 2025 to March 2026.

India also reported the world's largest number of new child leprosy cases in the WHO's 2025 global update, with 3,832 cases.

The WHO figures and the NLEP figures refer to the same reporting period for India – April 2025 to March 2026 – although the WHO presents India's data in its 2025 global table. The WHO table records 3,832 child cases and 37 child cases with G2D for India.

Hard-to-reach areas

The Health Ministry identifies high-endemic and hard-to-reach areas as priorities for intensified case detection. The NLEP emphasises active case detection, household contact surveys and focused campaigns, along with special plans for hard-to-reach areas. The programme also identifies stigma and discrimination as continuing concerns.

Leprosy, or Hansen's disease, is a chronic bacterial infection caused mainly by *Mycobacterium leprae*. It primarily affects the skin and peripheral nerves. Transmission occurs mainly through prolonged, close contact with an untreated person. The disease is curable with multidrug therapy.

The Health Ministry has identified high-priority States and districts where the burden remains concentrated. Twenty-three districts in Chhattisgarh, 21 in Jharkhand, 18 each in Maharashtra and Odisha, and 10 in Madhya Pradesh had a prevalence rate above one case per 10,000 population.

Govt. plans Centres of Excellence in five classical languages

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The centres will strengthen regional ecosystems for higher education in classical languages

The Union government has approved the establishment of five Centres of Excellence for studies in five classical languages – Assamese, Bengali, Marathi, Pali and Prakrit.

The initiative will provide dedicated institutional support for advanced academic research, preservation and digitisation of linguistic and literary heritage, and help in wider dissemination of knowledge relating to these classical languages, said an official statement by the Ministry of Education on Saturday.

The Centre of Excellence for Classical Assamese will be established at Tezpur University in Assam. Similarly, Visva-Bharati University in West Bengal has been selected to establish the Centre of Excellence for Classical Bengali. The Deccan College Post-Graduate and Research Institute (deemed to be university) in Pune, Maharashtra, will host the centre for Marathi. The Central University of Odisha will house the centre for classical Pali and the Central University of Gujarat will host the centre for Prakrit.

"The Ministry of Education's approval of a Centre of Excellence for Classical Pali at the Central University of Odisha will strengthen the study, preservation and promotion of Pali, a language deeply connected with India's intellectual, spiritual and cultural traditions," Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi said on X.

Heritage conservation

The Centres of Excellence will focus on strengthening academic research and scholarship, providing dedicated institutional platforms for advanced research, scholarly work and academic engagement in the respective classical languages.

The centres will support the documentation, preservation and digitisation of linguistic and literary resources.

They will also strengthen regional ecosystems for higher education, research and scholarship in classical languages.

"The initiative reinforces the government's efforts to preserve and promote India's rich linguistic and literary heritage while strengthening institutions of higher education as centres of research and scholarship," the statement said.

A total of 11 languages have been granted the status of classical languages.

Red tape leaves UGC scheme for the study of social inclusion in limbo, leads to salary crisis

Maitri Porecha
NEW DELHI

Seven months into the current financial year, 24 central universities still await the renewal of the University Grants Commission's (UGC's) flagship scheme for teaching and conducting research on marginalised communities.

The Centre for the Study of Social Inclusion in Universities (CSSIU) had originated in 2007-08 as part of the Five-Year Plan. This now runs as a UGC scheme renewed annually from April to March each year.

In a written reply to *The Hindu*, the Ministry of Education (MoE) said, "The proposal regarding the continuation of the CSSIU Scheme for the Financial Year 2026-27 is currently under process."

Prominent universities that conduct two-year Master's programmes and five-year PhD courses under the CSSIU include the Banaras Hindu University, Jamia Millia Islamia, the University of Hyderabad, the Tata Institute of Social Sciences and Panjab University, amongst others.

Administrative lags have crippled payroll systems in some universities that had been chosen for the scheme. ISTOCK

Apart from teaching, these centres also conduct specialised outreach activities focused on tribal and disadvantaged populations.

Bureaucratic delays

Because the scheme is renewed on an annual cycle from April to March, administrative lags have crippled payroll systems in universities. For the financial year 2026-27, while the continuation order for the scheme remains stuck in bureaucratic processing, teaching and non-teaching staff working in these centres either have had their salaries delayed or remain unpaid.

Speaking on condition of anonymity, a professor teaching in one of these centres said: "While our university paid salaries for August 2026 after a delay of about 20 days, our September salaries have currently been withheld entirely. We have been indicated that payouts will only be made after the extension nod arrives from the centre."

Staff members also recalled that non-payment of salaries was a recurring ordeal between 2019 and 2024. "Non-payment of salaries on time causes a great deal of hardship for faculty and non-teaching staff. Such uncertainties have led to a flight of faculty and students, thus undermining the academic objectives behind the centre," the professor said.

Ministry's response

In response to *The Hindu*'s queries, the Education Ministry said in a written reply that financial assistance to universities under the CSSIU scheme operates on a reimbursement basis, subject to document verification.

According to the Ministry, ₹26.05 crore was released on a reimbursement basis to 18 centres for the 2024-25 period. Additionally, a provisional grant calculated at 60% of the previous year's funding – up to ₹7.59 crore – was released in advance for 2025-26, taking the total disbursed amount for that period to ₹33.64 crore.

"The settlement of accounts for the financial year 2025-26 is currently under process, subject to the receipt and verification of the requisite documents from the respective centres," the Ministry stated.

It also stated that the proposal regarding the continuation of CSSI Scheme for 2026-27 is currently under process.

Despite the critical role played by the CSSIU scheme in researching and advocating for marginalised communities, the centres routinely operated on ad-hoc, annual extensions.

The uncertainty over annual renewal of the UGC scheme has also deprived long-serving staff, those with over 15 years of uninterrupted service – of fundamental employment protections, performance appraisals, and career promotions.

Enforcement gaps make Odisha haven for poachers: wildlife group

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

The Wildlife Society of Orissa (WSO), an environmental pressure group, on Saturday claimed that not a single tiger or elephant poacher has served a jail sentence for the crime in Odisha, pointing to poor enforcement and lack of commitment of the wildlife wing.

WSO Secretary Biswajit Mohanty said that a month after five baby orangutans, native to the rainforests of Indonesia and Malaysia, were found in Odisha, the people behind smuggling them into the State are yet to be caught.

"Most of those arrested are released on bail within a few weeks... Odisha has become a safe haven for wildlife traffickers and poachers because of weak enforcement. The wildlife wing has never treated wildlife crime as a serious issue that calls for intelligence gathering, enforcement and punishment of offenders," he said. "As many as 316 elephants have been killed in Odisha during a 15-year period from April 2010 to March 2025 by poaching," he said.

"There is no truth in the claim that no poacher accused of killing tigers or elephants has served a jail sentence for the crime in Odisha. The conviction rate in wildlife crime cases is low, but systems are now being put in place to improve it," said P. K. Jha, Principal Chief Wildlife Warden of Odisha.

Mr. Mohanty also said there may be instances where accused persons are convicted by lower courts but later exonerated by appellate courts.

IIT-B student death: police deny his father permission to protest

Chinmay Gaikwad
MUMBAI

The Mumbai police have denied permission to Ravindra Wakode, father of Sahil Wakode, the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT Bombay) student who died by suicide allegedly due to caste discrimination, to continue a protest at Azad Maidan. Following the denial of permission, Mr. Wakode planned to visit the Powai campus of the institute, sources said.

On Thursday, the Crime Branch questioned for 10 hours, and recorded the statement of Professor Suryanarayana Doolla, against whom a First Information Report has been lodged. Statements have also been recorded from 40 others, including Sahil Wakode's parents, and hostel staff. The police are examining devices.

Students at IIT Bombay started a protest on October 2, 2026 demanding accountability from the administration. Earlier, the Wakode couple started their protest, seeking justice for their son. They demand the arrest of Prof. Doolla, and Shireesh Kedare, Director, IIT Bombay.

Sahil Wakode, 22, a second year student of the B. Tech. programme at IIT Bombay was found dead in his hostel room on September 18, hours after he had been caught using a phone during an exam.

(People in distress can contact Tele MANAS - 14416)

Bitchat taken off Apple India App Store

Pallavi Keswani
NEW DELHI

Apple has officially removed the offline messaging application, Bitchat, from its India App Store after a demand from the IT Ministry, Jack Dorsey said in an X post on Saturday.

"Government of India officially removes Bitchat from the App Store," the app's developer and Twitter co-founder Jack Dorsey wrote in a post, alongside a screenshot of what appeared to be a notice from Apple's App Review team.

Bitchat, built by Mr. Dorsey, had come under government scrutiny in July this year, when the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre, had ordered GitHub to remove the Bluetooth-based messaging application.

Mr. Dorsey tagged Apple's notice in his post which says the app would be removed because "it includes content that is illegal in India".

How is AI reshaping Indian IT companies' 'benches'?

EXPLAINER

Balasubramanyam C.P.
CHENNAI

The story so far: Wipro recently changed how long some of its staff can stay without a billable project. Under a revised bench policy, effective October 1, staff in Band 2 and below can reportedly stay unallocated for up to 180 days while for band 3 and above, the standard period is 45 days and those with disabilities 75 days.

Band 2 and below staff who are unallocated for 180 days can be separated under employment contracts. Wipro did not respond *The Hindu* queries.

Recent industry estimates show shorter bench periods and lower bench strength. Average bench time at large IT-services firms was estimated at 35-45 days in 2025 compared with 45-60 days in FY20 and FY21. The proportion of bench staff was estimated at 2-5% (10-15% earlier). So, what is happening?

What is bench?
In IT services, the bench refers to staff not assigned to a billable client project.

Firms have to balance workforce strength with uneven project demand. A firm that wins a large project needs people ready to work on it but hiring, training and demand do not always happen at the same time. Carrying some spare capacity allows faster deployment when demand materialises but a firm continues to incur staff costs while not billable .

A higher proportion of non-billable staff can weigh on utilisation and margins. But bench could also mean may be training, working on internal projects or developing skills.

Evolution of bench
There is little evidence of a single point at which the Indian IT industry unveiled a formal bench model. In April 2001, Infosys told analysts the firm had "slightly more than 1,000 people on the bench" at the end of the quarter. Utilisation excluding training was 73%; the balance unbilled effort included staff on the bench as well as those on leave, management, research and development and internal information-systems projects.

Such disclosures show unallocated capacity was already an identifiable part of workforce management at a major Indian IT-services firm by early 2000s.

Why have a bench?
When companiefirms expected demand to rise, retaining trained staff allowed them to respond to new projects without having to recruit and train an entirely new workforce.

Wipro's FY12 annual report points to investment in a "strategic bench to fuel growth" which contributed to gross utilisation falling from 69.9% in FY11 to 68.3% in FY12.

Just-in-time hiring
The economics of carrying a bench changed when demand weakened. Spare capacity for deployment turned into cost when projects were delayed or failed to materialise.

Wipro's October 2009 earnings call illustrates the shift. The then CEO Suresh Vaswani said the firm's bench fell from about 11,000 to about 7,000 and Wipro made its "people supply chain" tighter and more "just-in-time" in hiring and recruitment. HCL Technologies took a similar approach during the 2008-09 downturn.

Bench productivity
Some firms tried to change what happened to staff between projects rather than simply cut numbers.

Persistent Systems announced in its FY2016-17 annual report the creation of TeXT or Transforming Employee Experiences. Staff, between projects, could work on timed projects involving AI, machine learning, natural language processing, IoT and analytics. Infosys launched Zero Bench programme in 2015, creating an internal marketplace for staff awaiting longer-term assignments.

What is AI changing?
AI is changing what makes staff deployable.TCS's FY26 annual report says its talent model is centred on skills, roles and talent and reports over 2.7 lakh staff with advanced AI and ML proficiency. Wipro's FY2025-26 filing describes a "Skill as a Currency" approach involving upskilling, reskilling and cross-skilling while Infosys's FY2025-26 ESG report says its AI strategy includes enabling staff to be deployed to relevant projects through upskilling.

Therefore, AI is not simply shrinking the bench but also changing definition of who is deployable.

Who bears the risk?
Maintaining a bench means carrying the cost of staff without billable assignments while maintaining too little means risking a shortage of trained talent when demand picks up.

For staff, a shorter bench window leaves less time to find another assignment and prolonged non-deployment can eventually put the employee's job at risk. Therefore, the bench becomes a balancing act for both sides, with companies managing capacity and employees managing deployment risk.

RBI chief lays down five key priorities for financial stability

Financial instability anywhere can become a threat to financial stability everywhere, says Reserve Bank of India Governor Sanjay Malhotra

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

New context Sanjay Malhotra with ex-ECB President Jean-Claude Trichet, others at the 5th Kautilya Economic Conclave. PTI

Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Governor Sanjay Malhotra emphasised on the importance of maintaining financial stability amid multiple shocks. Financial instability anywhere can become a threat to financial stability everywhere, he added.

The challenge before financial sector regulators is to build a financial system that can withstand the shocks they anticipate and those they cannot yet foresee, said Mr. Malhotra laying down five key priorities policymakers must factor in when safeguarding financial stability.

"This requires resilient institutions, better data, deeper markets, credible safety nets, effective resolution mechanisms and regulation and supervision that is proactive and forward-looking while being proportionate," he said at an event here.

First, financial stability was about strengthening systemic resilience to face and contain amplification.

"Shocks may be endogenous or exogenous. Our aim must be to foster a financial system that can provide financial services in all States of the world, even under severe shocks," he said. Second, as a new generation of systemic risks were taking shape, assessing them and complex interactions was vital.

"The next financial crisis may begin with a geopolitical event, a cyberattack, or a technological failure and affect the financial system through multiple channels," he said.

Dependencies network
To boost systemic resilience, those responsible must aim to better understand the network of dependencies and contagion channels and make scenario analysis a cornerstone of risk management.

Third, monitoring and assessment frameworks must improve. "For that, we need better and more granular data. The financial system is turning increasingly complex but data on NBFIs, interconnected exposures, technology dependencies and cross-border positions remain fragmented."

Fourth, he said, resilience must be system-wide. "A strong banking system is not sufficient. We need resilience across sectors and institutions: NBFIs, financial markets, payment systems, technology infrastructure, critical third parties and cross-border financial networks."

Fifth, he said, innovation must boost fragment, the foundations of trust.

"AI, tokenisation and new forms of financial intermediation can dramatically boost efficiency. But innovation will be sustainable only if financial system preserves the fundamental properties on which trust rests: sound institutions, settlement finality, singleness of money and financial integrity."

Mumbai airport, airlines clash over Navi Mumbai shift

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

From Oct 26, MIAL will allocate vacated T2 facilities to domestic operators from T1.

A dispute is brewing between Adani-run Mumbai International Airport Ltd. (MIAL) and airlines over a proposed operational reshuffle during phased redevelopment of Terminal 1 (T1). The plan involves moving domestic traffic from T1 to Terminal 2 (T2), while shifting some international services to the more distant Navi Mumbai International Airport.

In a letter to airlines, a copy of which was reviewed by *The Hindu*, MIAL warned as many airlines failed to attend September 16 meeting and have yet to submit transition plans sought by September 25, it will proceed with a previously announced 33% cut in international departure slots from 11.59 pm on October 25 amounting to 265 of T2's 770 weekly international slots. Airlines have until 4 pm October 6 to identify the slots they want temporarily discontinued; otherwise, MIAL will determine them "based on operational, capacity and implementation considerations."

From October 26, MIAL will allocate the vacated T2 facilities to domestic operators moving from T1.

The International Air Transport Association (IATA) opposed the move saying any transfer should be voluntary and backed by airline consultation. "IATA is fundamentally opposed to forced airline relocations," it said. IATA also warned Navi Mumbai's wider operating ecosystem may not be ready for international services.

Meanwhile, in a press statement Mumbai airport said the move to Navi Mumbai airport would be temporary. Navi Mumbai will also offer 100% waiver on landing charges for new international flights as well as vouchers to international passengers to offset the difference in the User Development Fee levied at Navi Mumbai and Mumbai Airports.

T1 redevelopment will begin from January, which will raise its capacity by 33% - up to 20 million passengers/year from 15 million currently.

Titan Company to focus on mechanical horology with Vetra

Mini Tejaswi
BENGALURU

Mechanical watchmaking is entering an important phase in India, driven by a growing consumer appreciation for craftsmanship, engineering and the experience of owning a watch with a mechanical heart, said Kuruvilla Markose, CEO, Watches at Titan Company Ltd.

Although quartz still dominates the overall watch sales volumes on account of affordability, consumer interest for deeply designed wares, fast-pace of growth and value are heavily tilting toward mechanical horology

"We have seen the category gain significant momentum, with Titan's mechanical watch business growing almost fivefold over the last three years,'' Mr. Markose told *The Hindu*.

Titan is expecting the segment to grow from around ₹270 crore last year to about ₹350 crore at end FY27.

To add momentum to this segment, Titan Company is making a strategic push into premium mechanical watchmaking by designing and branding its own in-house movement, Vetra. It embodies Titan's philosophy of elegant ingenuity in solving the most demanding challenges with clarity, precision and purpose, Mr. Markose said.

INBRIEF

Nayara Energy hikes prices of petrol by ₹5, diesel by ₹3

Nayara Energy, India's largest private fuel retailer, raised petrol prices by ₹5/ litre and diesel by ₹3, to narrow the gap between retail prices and rising global oil and refined-product costs, people familiar with the matter said. The latest move comes amid renewed pressure on fuel retailers from higher global energy prices and follows price adjustments by Nayara this year as refiners grapple with the impact of geopolitical disruptions on crude and product markets. PTI

'G20 reviews impact of excess manufacturing capacities'

G20 trade ministers discussed preventing large production capacities, created with government support in some geographies, from hurting manufacturing in countries that follow fair trade practices, including India, the U.S. and Europe, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal has said. Replying to questions from the Indian diaspora in Chicago, Mr. Goyal said the members also discussed the future of several elements of the World Trade Organisation (WTO). PTI

'Nestle 'low-fat dairy whitener' found 'unsafe at Hotel Lalit'

A sample of "low-fat dairy whitener" made by Nestle India, drawn from the premises of Hotel Lalit was found "unsafe and substandard", the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) said. In response, Nestlé India said it complied with all applicable regulatory requirements and its low-fat dairy whitener is safe to consume. In a post on social media, the food regulator said a sample was collected from the premises of Bharat Hotels Ltd. (The Lalit), Connaught Place, New Delhi. PTI

READ
SPORTSTAR
EVERY FORTNIGHT.
TO SUBSCRIBE,
VISIT
www.thehindugroup.in/subscribe

KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD.
(Department of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of Kerala)
THYCAUD P.O., THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - 695014
Tele:0471-2945646, 2945600
website: www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, e-mail: eptenders.kmscl@kerala.gov.in
CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616
No. KMSCL/EP/264/2026 Dated : 03.10.2026
e-TENDER NOTICE (Running Contract)
Online bids are invited for the supply and installation of the following equipment for various Government healthcare institutions across Kerala

Sl. No	Tender No.	Description	Online Pre-Bid Meeting	Last date of Online submission
1.	T606(R)/ 2026	Automated DNA Extraction Device	N.A.	12.10.2026 5.00 p.m.

Tender documents and all other information related to tender and bidding process can be downloaded from the website www.etenders.kerala.gov.in.
Sd/- Managing Director (Tender Inviting Authority)

GOVERNMENT OF TELANGANA
NIZAMABAD MUNICIPAL CORPORATION
Tender Notice No. EE/NMC/21/2026, Dt.01.10.2026
On behalf of the Nizamabad Municipal Corporation Expression of Interest (E.O.I) is invited from the Similar Experienced Firms for the Maintenance, Management and **Establishment of the Compressed Bio Gas Plant at Nagaram Dumping Yard in Nizamabad Municipal Corporation on Turnkey Basis** and Sale of RFP Dt.05.10.2026 and Last Date for Submission of RFP Dt.14.10.2026 @ 04.00 PM. For further details see on e-procurement platform i.e http://tender.telangana.gov.in. For Further Details, Contact: **6309506351**.
Sd/-Commissioner, NMC
DIPR R.O.No.612-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:03.10.2026

DR. BABU JAGJIVAN RAM LEATHER INDUSTRIES DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LTD. (LIDKAR)
(A Govt. of Karnataka Enterprise)
No. 32,Dr. Babu Jagjivan Ram LIDKAR Bhavan,
Millers Tank Bund Area, Vasanthnagar,Bangalore - 560052
Phone: 080-22238895, e-mail: lidkar2018@gmail.com
No: LIDKAR/COMML/2026-27 Date: 30.09.2026
RFQ NOTIFICATION
Request for Technical Proposal for Empanelment of manufactures for the Period 2026-27 & 2027-28. The Dr. Babu Jagjivan Ram Leather Industries Development Corporation Ltd (LIDKAR) invites pre-qualification bids from interested manufacturers for supply of Leather / Non-Leather, Leather Goods, Leather Garments, Footwear Accessories under 'LIDKAR' brand as and when required, as per the Design/Drawing/Specifications/Raw material/ Packaging specified by LIDKAR, through e-procurement portal of Government of Karnataka **(https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in)** with short notice. The manufactures / Producers willing to participate in this tender shall necessarily register themselves with above mentioned e-procurement portal.

1	Tender Reference No. and date	No: LIDKAR/Comm/CR-05/2026-27 Dated :30.09.2026
2	Pre Bid Meeting Date, Place and Time	Dt: 09/10/2026 @ 11.00 AM
3	Last date & Time for submission of Tender	Dt. 23/10/2026 @ 4.00 PM
4	Date & Time of opening of the Tender	Dt. 28/10/2026 @ 4.30 PM
5	EMD Amount	Rs.10,000/-
6	Venue of pre-bid meeting	Office Address As Above

Prospective bidders willing to participate in this tender can down load the bid documents with visiting the web site: **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.**
Sd/-
General Manager (Finance & Admn)
Tender Inviting Authority
DIPR/CP/SMCL/3066/26-27

इंटरनेशनल एडवांस्ड रिसर्च सेंटर फॉर पाउडर मेटलर्जी एंड न्यू मटेरियल्स (ए आर सी आई), हैदराबाद
(विज्ञान एवं प्रौद्योगिकी विभाग, भारत सरकार का स्वायत्त अनुसंधान एवं विकास केन्द्र)
आरसीआई, न्यू एअरपोर्ट रोड, बालापुर, हैदराबाद – 500 005, तेलंगाना
INTERNATIONAL ADVANCED RESEARCH CENTRE FOR POWDER METALLURGY AND NEW MATERIALS (ARCI)
(An Autonomous R&D Centre of Department of Science & Technology, Govt. of India)
RCI-New Airport Road, Balapur, Hyderabad-500 005, Telangana.
Ph. Nos. 040-24452515/425/356, Email : rectt@arci.res.in
Advt. No. ARCI/HRD/SCD/2/2026
अनुबंध के आधार पर नियोजन/Engagement on Contract Basis
विज्ञान संचारक और डिजाइनर/Science Communicator & Designer
एआरसीआई अनुबंध के आधार पर विज्ञान संचारक और डिजाइनर के एक पद हेतु उपयुक्त उम्मीदवार को नियोजित करने के लिए आवेदन आमंत्रित करता है। रचनात्मकता, नवपरिवर्तन और एआरसीआई के मिशन संबंधित विज्ञान-केंद्रित सामग्री को विकसित और प्रसारित करने में रूचि रखने वाले उम्मीदवार अपना विस्तृत आवेदन प्रस्तुत कर सकते हैं। पद का विवरण नीचे दिया गया है:
ARCI invites applications to engage a suitable candidate for ONE (1) post of Science Communicator & Designer purely on temporary/contact basis. Candidates with creativity, innovation, and passion for developing and disseminating science-focused content relevant to ARCI's mission may submit their detailed application. The details of the post are given below:
Name of the Post, Qualifications & Experience
SCIENCE COMMUNICATOR & DESIGNER
Age: Not exceeding 40 years
Remuneration: Minimum of Rs. 50,000/- to a Maximum of Rs. 70,000/- p.m. (fixed) (based on qualifications and experience)
Tenure: Initially for a period of 1 year which is extendable upto 3 years based on performance.
Essential Qualification:
i. Master's Degree in Communication, Journalism, Mass Communication, Media Studies, Science Communication, Public Relations, Advertising, Digital Media, or an equivalent discipline; OR
ii. Master's Degree in Physical, Chemical, Materials Sciences, or an equivalent science discipline; OR
iii. B.E./B.Tech./M.E./M.Tech. in Materials Science, Engineering/Technology, or an allied field from a recognized University/Institution.
Last Date for submission of detailed CV/Resume is 03rd November, 2026
पूरी जानकारी के लिए लॉग ऑन करें/For complete details, log on to: https://www.arci.res.in/careers/vacancies

After great apes, scientists find African elephants self-medicate too

Divya Gandhi

Wild animals have long been known for their intuitive pharmacological knowledge: orangutans balm their wounds with plants; chimpanzees consume bitter antibacterial leaves; Indo-Pacific bottlenose dolphins queue up to rub against selected corals; and birds smear their nests with insecticidal plants to fend off anaemia-causing mites.

Scientists term this behaviour zoopharmacognosy, where animals seek out plants to treat endoparasite infestations, respiratory and fungal infections, wounds, and gastrointestinal problems. While most of these medicinal resources are plant-based, for example, barks, leaves and resin, animals also treat themselves with charcoal, clay and insects.

Now, a paper published in *Scientific Reports* that focused on a group of African elephants in Kenya found that they consume specific plants when unwell. In fact, the scientists learned from local experts who had worked with these elephants for decades that mothers fed plant-based "medicine" to their offspring too. This knowledge is transferred intergenerationally.

Several of these plants are also used in indigenous human traditional medicine. Local experts pointed to 39 natural resources that elephants in Kenya's Mount Elgon region use. This included 35 plant species and four types of soil: mineral or clay.

Elephants were found to travel long distances to get to a particular tree without foraging on the way. Their single-minded mission was to consume the bark or leaves.

R. Sukumar, the National Science Chair, Centre for Ecological Sciences, Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru, told *The Hindu* that while in India there does not seem to be any systematic study of zoopharmacognosy in Asian elephants, he once made a personal observation: "I once observed a wild female Asian elephant feeding on the bark of *Terminalia crenulata*, a very rare occurrence. The elephant was secreting from its temporal gland and seemed to be in advanced stage of pregnancy."

When Prof. Sukumar asked the mahout about this behaviour, the latter confirmed female elephants do indeed feed on the bark of this tree when they are about to give birth.

"The exploitation of such knowledge by the modern pharmaceutical industry for developing drugs for human use should respect the intellectual property rights of our indigenous communities and perhaps even contribute to wildlife conservation goals," Prof. Sukumar said.

India's river interlinks may create invasive species 'highways'

Lower Ganga basin hosts 13-15 invasive alien species and could become a major source of invasives for the Mahanadi; river interlinking project could also help aquatic pathogens to spread and flatten the unique biota of individual river basins

Jhinook Mitra

The National River-Linking Project is the world's most ambitious project of its kind to date, proposing to link 37 major river basins across India, potentially redistributing around 174 billion cubic metres of water from 'surplus' to 'deficit' basins while generating some 34,000 MW of power.

The Project has also raised serious concerns about its environmental costs. Experts have said the idea of 'surplus' and 'deficit' basins can mask seasonal and year-on-year variations in river flows, and that transferring water between basins can alter downstream flows, sediment transport, floodplains, deltas, and the habitats that depend on them. Dams, reservoirs, and canals can also break ecosystems up into pieces and disturb fish migration and other ecological processes.

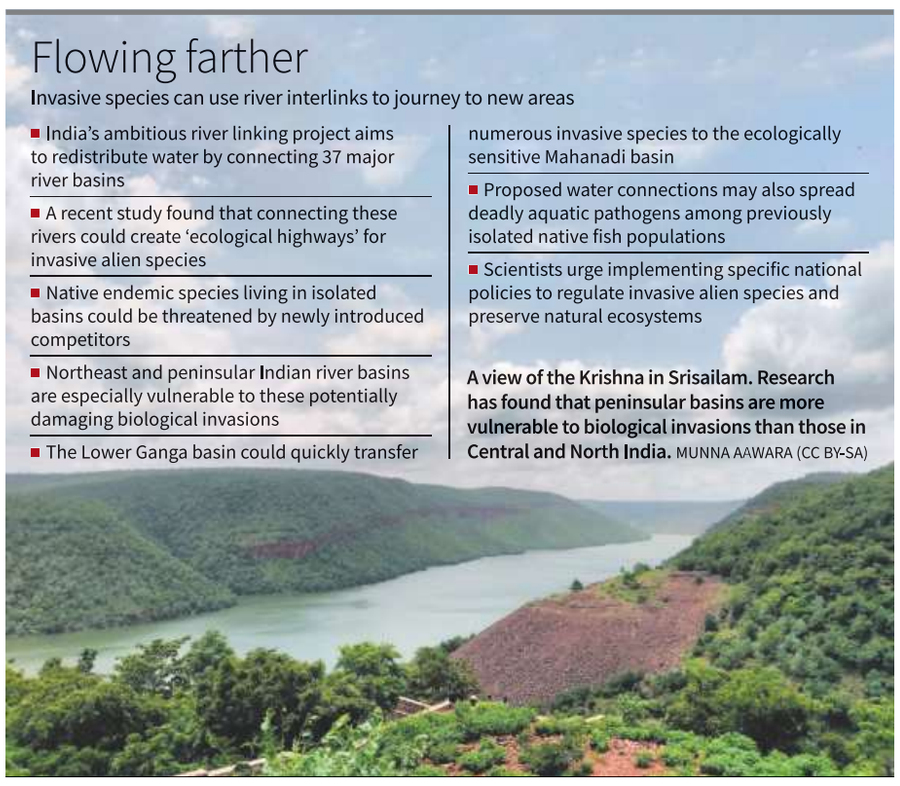
It seems river-linking also poses another, less obvious problem. Researchers from the Ashoka Trust for Research in Ecology and the Environment (ATREE), Bengaluru, assessed the project as possibly creating "ecological highways" that invasive species can travel on to new, ecologically sensitive areas. Their findings were recently published in Scientific Reports.

Given how India's river basins are isolated from each other, many species inhabit a small area and are not found elsewhere, and river links may then threaten them more than native species.

In the paper, the team showed that all Northeast and peninsular Indian basins are more vulnerable to biological invasions than those in Central and North India.

The southwestern Ghats, Kaveri, Krishna, Lower Ganga, and Brahmaputra basins support diverse habitats and complex ecological niches that host native species, threatened species, and invasive alien species.

"Right now, [the invasive alien species] are isolated, restricted to individual river basins," the study's lead author and ATREE senior fellow Aravind Neelavar Ananthram said. "By connecting rivers, we would not only introduce new species that are not naturally found but also increase the vulnerability of the native species that cannot compete with the invasive alien species."



A view of the Krishna in Srisailam. Research has found that peninsular basins are more vulnerable to biological invasions than those in Central and North India. MUNNA AAWARA (CC BY-SA)

This finding is consistent with research worldwide, which has suggested that biodiversity hotspots can accumulate more invasive alien species, thus compromising the long-term prospects of native species and themselves turning into 'invasion hotspots'. For example, the Lower Ganga basin hosts 13-15 invasive alien species, and could become a major source of invasives for the Mahanadi, which is home to 69 threatened species. In fact, this is one of the Project's most ecologically sensitive links, and it could increase the risk of extinction for the threatened species.

Water connections under the Project could also help aquatic pathogens to spread, disrupt the migratory routes of fish, and flatten the unique biota that individual river basins boast today.

"Fishes in one river basin may be well adapted or immune to the pathogens it harbours, while species in other basins may not be able to protect themselves against such pathogens," Dr. Ananthram said. "If one reduces the water flow by taking out water from one river and putting it into another, the downstream water flow will be reduced. As a consequence, the downstream biodiversity will be severely affected and there is a high chance that the endemic species in the lower reaches might go extinct."

"Rivers like the Ken have sand of great ecological value. But if the Ken-Betwa link is live, large quantities of water will be moved away from the river, lowering the flow volume and reducing sediment production rates in the river," Siddharth Agarwal, director-founder of the Veditum India Foundation, a nonprofit working on environmental governance, said. "That could ultimately reduce the biodiversity in the river and potentially even trigger a food chain collapse."

The Project's consequences may also extend to downstream nations.

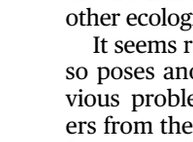
"Right now, we have only considered 15 freshwater invasive species for which data is available," Dr. Ananthram said. "If one looks at all species across India, including terrestrial and marine systems, it would be approximately 350 to 400 species in different stages of invasion. Developed economies like Australia and Europe have very strong policies for invasive alien species. It is an urgent need that India comes up with a policy targeted to regulate, manage, and control" such species.

Embedding evidence-based management of river basins into national infrastructure planning could provide ecological foresight.

"The health risks, biodiversity, wildlife, and economic costs of [the Project] to India, especially for the agro-economy, farmers' livelihoods, and fisheries, are matters of urgent attention," he added. "While the government's intention might be good to address water deficit, development plans and policy decisions should be holistic, addressing the ecological impact, the effect on biodiversity, and people's lives."

Jhinook Mitra is an independent researcher and ecologist, currently with the Nature Conservation Foundation, Bengaluru.

Ig Nobel Prizes awarded to serious work in amusing areas



SPEAKING OF SCIENCE
D. Balasubramanian

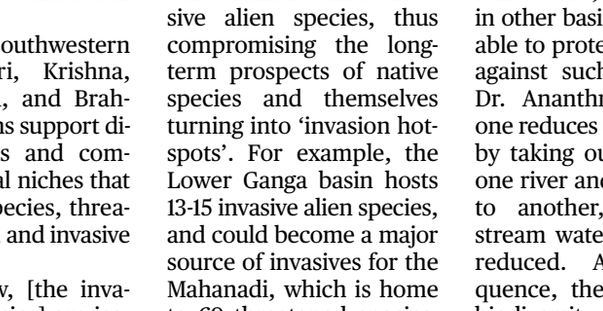
On September 3, a dozen people from various countries were declared to be the recipients of the Ig Nobel Prizes for 2026. Some readers may wonder what an Ig Nobel Prize is. The Ig Nobel Prizes are a lighthearted parody of the actual Nobel Prizes. They were instituted in 1991 by Marc Abraham, editor of *The Journal of Irreproducible Research*.

For example, last year, a group from Nigeria worked on how lizards like to eat pizza, and another group was feted for showing that when a lactating mother eats garlic, the baby drinks more milk.

Just as the Nobel Prizes are awarded in various fields of science and the arts, so are the Ig Nobel Prizes. (This column also wrote about the 2025 Ig Nobel Prizes on October 4, 2025.) But while the Nobel Prizes' categories are fixed, those of the Ig Nobel Prizes change year after year.

For example, this year, the Ig Nobel Prize in biomechanics was awarded to Matilda Brindle and colleagues of Florida State University, who showed how the practice of mouth-to-mouth transfer of food in birds, gorillas, and large apes evolved into lip-to-lip kissing in modern-day humans.

The prize for economics went to psychologist Paul Piff and his colleagues from the University of California, Irvine for their study of how upper-class people are likely to be arrogant, cutting off other vehicles and pedestrians in traffic jams. We see examples of such arrogant behaviour in upper-class people in India as well.


Finding that blowing the nose inappropriately could lead to a sinus infection won the 2026 Ig Nobel Prize for medicine. GETTY IMAGES

The prize for medicine was awarded posthumously to Tokuji Unno, a physiologist from Japan who studied the aerodynamics of blowing the nose: he showed that doing so inappropriately could lead to a sinus infection as well as that a big and long nose blow prevents upper and lower respiratory tract diseases. The prize was accepted on his behalf by his colleague Miki Takahara.

The prize in biology went to João Miguel Alves-Nunes and colleagues in São Paulo, Brazil, who studied factors such as body temperature, ambient temperature, time of day, and interaction with humans that cause snakes to bite people. They learnt that upon physical contact, smaller snakes bite humans more often and that newborn female snakes are particularly prone to biting when provoked.

The olfaction prize went to Ilona Croy and colleagues from the University of Jena in Germany. They studied 235 nursing mothers and found that babies smell wonderful to their parents but less so as they grow up.

The peace prize has been awarded to social psychologists from several universities in the U.S. who studied why people become friends.

After studying over a thousand people from the U.S. and India, they came to particular conclusions about how people prefer their friends and their attitudes towards their 'enemies'.

The Wan Der Heiden laboratory at the University of Zurich won the soil science prize for asking hundreds of volunteers to bury their used underpants to study soil health.

Finally, the chemistry prize went to Sanchari Banerjee, Nitish Satyanarayanan, and Jandhyam Srikanth from InStem Bengaluru, S. Ramaswamy of Purdue University, Leo Chavas of DECTRIS Japan, and Nathan Coussens of the Frederick National Laboratory for Cancer Research in the U.S. for finding that milk proteins from the *Diploptera punctata* cockroach have more energy content than cow milk. When the prize was announced, the three from the U.S. received their prize wearing cockroach hats!

dbala@lvpei.org

SNAPSHOTS

GOOGLE EARTH

Breaking up forests is just as bad for global warming

How broken up a forest is can affect local temperatures as much as the forested area, a new study has found. Using satellite data, researchers found that in tropical and temperate zones, dividing continuous forests into smaller, isolated patches significantly raised surface temperature. In high-altitude boreal forests, however, fragmentation had a cooling effect because it exposed more open ground to snow cover, which reflects sunlight. The findings mean climate action needs to track fragmentation, too.

Radio jets from colossal black holes light up gas clouds

Astronomers have wondered how large black holes affect the gas halos surrounding their host galaxies. An Indian team combined hundreds of observations to find a glow of ionised hydrogen only along the path of radio-frequency energy blasting from the galaxies' centres. Magnesium, a marker of cool gas, was however found scattered around the galaxies. This meant the jets don't create the halos; instead, as they shoot out, they crash into existing gas clouds and light them up.

Flying butterflies use wing patterns to confuse predators

The striking wing patterns of butterflies may be a visual defence. By studying high-speed videos of butterfly flights and using 3D computer models, scientists found the combination of flapping wings and contrasting patterns, such as stripes and bright edges, creates an optical illusion that tricks a predator's eyes and confuses its judgment of the insect's speed and direction. The team said this "potentially represents one of the most successful visual defence strategies in moving animals".

Question Corner

Stumbling around

Why do we make noises like 'oof' when we lift something or bump into furniture?

When you physically exert while doing a task, you may also briefly hold your breath, releasing it as the effort eases. Your body may also contract the muscles around the trunk, making the torso more rigid and giving your arms and legs a more stable base from which to work. When the trunk stiffens, the abdominal muscles brace while briefly holding or restricting the breath. When you release that pressure, air is forced through the partly closed vocal cords, producing a grunt that sounds like 'oof'. This said, the noise you make after bumping into furniture has a different origin. A sudden impact prompts the nervous system to respond quickly. You might gasp, tense your muscles, pull away, and vocalise before you have actually decided to do any of these things. A sound like 'ow' or 'ah' is thus part of the body's startle response.
The exact sound is not automatic. People learn to react a certain way from those around them, so those speaking different languages and from cultures exclaim somewhat differently.

Readers may send their questions / answers to science@thehindu.co.in

How did social media rumours in Punjab lead to protests?

What happened in Chitkara University and Lovely Professional University? What are the police probing?

Vikas Vasudeva

The story so far:

In the last week of September, there was a spurt of unrest in two private universities in Punjab – Chitkara University and Lovely Professional University (LPU). The unrests were triggered by rumours that surfaced and spread on social media. In both cases, the rumours spread online faster than the facts could be verified, resulting in violent protests on campus.

What were the rumours in Chitkara?

On the intervening night of September 25 and 26, students at the Rajpura-based Chitkara University in Patiala district held a protest, alleging that two female students had died by suicide on campus and their bodies had been disposed of. They allegedly damaged two police vehicles, apart from assaulting a police officer.

The students also alleged that mysterious voices were coming from the university's girls' hostel, though preliminary police findings suggested it was a prank.

The initial probe by the police found the allegations about students going missing and having died by suicide to be unfounded. The police have arrested two people – both former students of the university – for provoking students by spreading rumours.

What happened in LPU?

A day later, trouble also began at LPU at Phagwara in Kapurthala district. Agitated students went on a rampage on campus following a rumour that an outsider had raped a female student in the university's GH-3 hostel. Videos on social media showed protesters at LPU, some of them with their faces covered, vandalising property on campus. On September 27 morning, they blocked National Highway-44, demanding that the police register an FIR in the case.

> In both Chitkara University and LPU, the rumours about suicide and rape, respectively, spread online faster than the facts could be verified, resulting in violence.

The police registered an FIR against an unidentified person under Section 64 (rape) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023, and a Special Investigation Team is probing the matter. However, nearly a week later, the alleged victim remains unidentified. The students have so far been unable to establish whether they know the person in question, say the police.

Despite the police registering a case, the protesters continued blocking the National Highway, pressing for other student-related demands. A clash broke out between the police and students, when protesters allegedly threw bottles and stones at the police and set some police vehicles on fire. The police responded with lathi charge. By the next morning, the situation was brought under control and the National Highway was cleared for traffic.

The police registered an FIR against the protesters under Sections 326(g), 324(4), and 309(4) of the BNS – relating to arson, property damage, and robbery, respectively – and under Section 4 of the Punjab Prevention of Damage to Public and Private Property Act, 2014.

They also registered an FIR under Sections 109 (attempt to murder), 132 (assault or the use of criminal force to deter a public servant from discharging their official duty), 221 (voluntarily obstructing any public servant while they are performing their official public duties), 326(b) (penalising any wrongful act of mischief that damages or obstructs a public road, bridge, navigable river, or channel), 326(g) (using fire or an explosive substance to destroy a building ordinarily used as a place of worship, a human dwelling, or a place for the custody of property) and 324(5) (causing property loss or damage amounting to ₹1 lakh or upwards) of the BNS.

So far, the police have arrested nine people.

How did the two universities respond?

In its statement, Chitkara University dismissed the reports circulating on social media about the alleged suicide, terming them false.

LPU claimed that certain "anti-social elements" had spread false, baseless rumours. It released a video statement featuring three female students from room no. 504 of the GH-3 hostel, in which they claimed that no such incident had taken place.

How did this lead to a political slugfest?

Rajya Sabha MP Ashok Mittal is the founder and chancellor of LPU. In April, he had quit the ruling AAP and joined the BJP. Former Punjab BJP president Sunil Jakhar said that when someone leaves the AAP out of frustration with its "misguided policies", the party expresses its political resentment through "vengeful actions". Senior Shiromani Akali Dal leader Bikram Singh Majithia alleged that the AAP had used LPU students as pawns for revenge.

Meanwhile, the Punjab and Haryana High Court has sought a status report from the Punjab government on the probe into the LPU violence, while hearing a petition seeking a CBI probe into the vandalism and violence.

Why did the J&K Statehood resolution cause a row?

What does the resolution passed in the J&K Assembly say? What is the 2000 autonomy resolution that Omar Abdullah spoke of that the BJP objected to? Why did the Chief Minister include the 2000 and 2024 resolution as well? What did two bureaucrats do that he objected to?

Peerzada Ashiq

The story so far:

On September 25, Jammu and Kashmir (J&K) Chief Minister Omar Abdullah introduced a resolution before the autumn session of the J&K Assembly. It called upon the Government of India for the "immediate and urgent restoration of full Statehood to J&K". Mr. Abdullah argued that the resolution was necessitated by the Centre's inexplicable delay in granting J&K Statehood status, which was downgraded in 2019 after its autonomous status under Article 370 was diluted by Parliament under the rule of Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

On September 28, the resolution was put to vote and was passed after 61 members out of 90 – from the ruling National Conference (NC), Congress, Communist Party of India (Marxist), Peoples Democratic Party, J&K People's Conference, Aam Aadmi Party, and Awami Ittehad Party – extended their support. After the resolution was passed, Mr. Abdullah called upon the Government of India to "fulfil its commitment towards restoration of Statehood".

Why did the BJP decide to stay away from voting?

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) took exception to the wording of the resolution. The part that piqued the BJP was that the current resolution was "in addition to the resolutions passed by this House on 26th June 2000 and 6th November 2024", referring to the 2000 autonomy resolution and the special status. BJP legislators raised a hue and cry, stormed into the well of the House, and staged walkouts over the resolution. J&K Leader of Opposition Sunil Sharma termed references to the 2000 autonomy resolution and the 2024 special-status "unnecessary". The BJP asked the ruling NC to bring a resolution confined exclusively to the issue of Statehood. Mr. Sharma said J&K was a sensitive region with neighbours which were always trying to take advantage of internal issues and disturb the peace. He said there was no room for any "Pakistan agenda" in J&K, a region which is an integral part of India. The BJP also targeted NC leader and Speaker Abdul Rahim Rather for allowing the resolution and moved a motion seeking his removal.

> The 2000 autonomy resolution and the 2024 special status resolution are bids by the ruling NC to bring a solution to Kashmir within the ambit of the Constitution and address all the political constituencies.

J&K Chief Minister Omar Abdullah looks on amid a protest by Opposition MLAs during the autumn session of the Assembly, in Srinagar. PTI

What is the 2000 autonomy resolution?

In the 1990s, at the peak of militancy, NC leader and then Chief Minister Dr. Farooq Abdullah was forced to step down and leave Kashmir. He returned to power in 1996 and set up a State Autonomy Committee to examine the steady erosion of J&K's regional autonomy since 1953, when his father, then J&K Prime Minister Sheikh Mohammad Abdullah, was dismissed from office and arrested by the Central government. The committee was part of the NC's attempt to offer a constitutional alternative to separatist groups that were demanding either complete independence for Kashmir or its merger with Pakistan.

On June 26, 2000, Dr. Abdullah, as Chief Minister, tabled the resolution to restore the pre-1953 autonomy status of J&K; it was passed unanimously by the State Assembly. This envisaged a much more limited Union jurisdiction over J&K, with defence, foreign affairs, and communications among the principal subjects with New Delhi. It called for the Governor to be re-designated as Sadr-e-Riyasat (Head of State) and the Chief Minister as Wazir-e-Azam (Prime Minister). It also proposed replacing the word 'temporary' in Article 370 with 'special'; barring the use of Article 356 of the Constitution to impose President's Rule; having a separate Election Commission and Comptroller and Auditor General; and rescinding all constitutional orders issued after 1954.

After the resolution was sent to Parliament, the then Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee rejected it. The Union Cabinet described the recommendations as unacceptable and an attempt to "set the clock back".

Why did Omar Abdullah include the previous resolutions?

After J&K was downgraded to a Union Territory in 2019, mainstream political parties in Kashmir have again been offering an alternative within the Constitution to the alienated sections, to protect land, jobs, and identity. The 2000 autonomy resolution and the 2024 special status resolution are bids by the ruling NC to bring a solution to Kashmir within the ambit of the Constitution and address all the political constituencies.

While Mr. Abdullah clarified in the Assembly that the resolution was confined to the restoration of Statehood, he cautioned the Centre against linking it to the complete cessation of militancy, which, he said, would effectively allow Pakistan to determine when Statehood should be restored. He underlined that the decision on Statehood should be taken in New Delhi and should not be made contingent on any other factor or external consideration.

Mr. Abdullah also stalled an attempt by eight NC legislators to amend the resolution to include references to Article 370, Article 35A, and the pre-August 5, 2019 position. The Chief Minister argued that these words could provide an excuse to the BJP not to participate in the voting and stall a unanimous resolution on Statehood.

How has this resolution caused a rift with the bureaucracy?

Mr. Abdullah informed the J&K Assembly that a day after he moved the resolution, Chief Secretary Atal Dulloo and Law Secretary Achal Sethi, in two separate communiqués to the Speaker, advised against allowing the resolution. Mr. Abdullah said the letters cited "matter sub judice" as the reason not to allow the resolution on Statehood. He lamented that this bid by the bureaucracy to scuttle the Statehood resolution only highlighted the need to restore Statehood.

He said, "The Law Secretary and the Chief Secretary had forwarded their opinions to the Speaker, saying that the subject was sub judice and should not be discussed." He was not shown the letters, he said. "I don't know on whose behalf they did this. Which State in the country will witness the Law Secretary and Chief Secretary oppose a resolution moved by the Chief Minister? It's because of the Union Territory status," Mr. Abdullah said.

The episode has sparked a debate over the powers of the legislature in the Union Territory. Congress legislator Nizamuddin Bhat demanded that the letters be made part of the Assembly records and taken up for discussion in the House. He termed the officers' decision to write to the Speaker a "challenge to the prestige, dignity and powers of the Assembly" and questioned whether officers could act as a government. He said the move challenged the authority of both the Speaker and the House. He argued that the Assembly was governed by the same rules as a State legislature, and that neither the Constitution nor the J&K Reorganisation Act provided otherwise. PDP legislator Waheed-ur-Rehman Parra has initiated a breach of privilege motion against the two officials.

What happened on the flydubai aircraft?

Why did FZ 1073 from UAE to Israel get diverted to Saudi Arabia on September 30? What led to the inflight incident? How did captain Smit Machchhar and the passengers deal with the situation? What is the damage caused to the aircraft?

Murali N. Krishnaswamy

The story so far:

On September 30, 2026, at about 8.35 a.m. IST, a flight from the United Arab Emirates to Israel was diverted to Saudi Arabia after one pilot stabbed the other and "apparently tried to crash the plane," according to Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu.

The inflight incident took place on a flydubai Boeing 737-8 MAX flight, FZ 1073, carrying mostly Israeli passengers. The aircraft was diverted to Tabuk in Saudi Arabia, where it made a safe landing despite extensive damage. The airline has announced the suspension of all flights to and from Israel. An investigation has begun, also examining a 'terror angle'.

What happened on the flight?

Media reports have said that an altercation is alleged to have broken out between the two flight crew, with one of the pilots being stabbed. The captain was Smit Machchhar, an Indian national, and a former SpiceJet pilot, who was recruited by flydubai in 2022. Other reports identify the co-pilot, who was arrested, as an Omani national. Both crew were moved to Abu Dhabi after initial hospitalisation in Saudi Arabia.

> Initial reports quoted passengers talking about a pocket knife having been used in the attack. Other reports cited the use of the flight deck crash axe as another possibility.

This photo released on Israel's Foreign Ministry's social media shows Indian Capt. Smit Machchhar in the cockpit of a plane. PTI

Media reports, eyewitness accounts, and inflight video clips have detailed how passengers were overtaken by the events, with chaos prevailing towards the front of the aircraft.

Briefs by Reuters and *The Times of Israel* say that "after being stabbed and seriously wounded by the copilot, the Indian captain managed to click open the cockpit door in what allowed several Israelis to burst in and subdue the attacker," attributing this to a spokesperson for Mr. Netanyahu. Other flydubai pilots, who were in the cabin, were able to intervene and carry out the safe landing in Saudi Arabia.

Initial reports quoted passengers talking about a (pocket) knife having been used in the attack. Other reports cited the use of the flight deck crash axe as another possibility. On October 3, a BBC report, quoting the United Arab Emirates Prosecutor General, said that the pilot had been "attacked with a crash axe in an attempt to take control of the aircraft". Senior pilots have told *The Hindu* that the crash axe (a mandatory aircraft safety emergency tool for aircrew) is "normally stored in the flight deck. It is to be accessed quickly, as it is in plain sight, and is used to breach the fuselage in an emergency, if there is structural deformation, or to pry open panels to get to the source of smoke in the case of a fire".

A video clip shared with *The Hindu* by aviation sources has shown both pilots on the cabin floor, bleeding profusely, with bloodstains on the cabin wall. One of the pilots can be seen in a blood-soaked shirt with epaulettes while the other crew member can be seen with an oxygen mask. Some passengers around the injured pilots can be seen asking for the filming to stop.

What happened to the flight?

Amid the commotion on the flight deck, a series of transponder codes were squawked from the aircraft – these codes are used globally during an aviation emergency. In this instance, the codes (7700 and 7500) denoted an emergency (in the case of mechanical or technical problems) as well as trouble due to 'unlawful interference'. This may have prompted Israel and Saudi Arabia to scramble fighter jets. At 10.50 a.m. IST, the Boeing, which was flying at about 34,000 feet, made a sudden descent to about 19,000 feet, followed by an ascent and descent again, before levelling off at about 15,000 feet.

The incident happened about two and a half hours into the three-hour flight. The jet, which was in Jordanian airspace for a short while, looped back to Saudi Arabia and landed at Prince Sultan bin Abdulaziz International Airport in Tabuk. This civil-military airfield is also the base of the Royal Saudi Air Force Wing 7.

An emergency descent can be controlled, but in this instance, where the descent could have occurred erratically, there could have been severe damage and stress to crucial flight control surfaces and even aircraft tail.

Ground images from Tabuk showed damage to the rudder on the tail/vertical stabiliser of the aircraft – a large part of it was missing. Passengers were seen deboarding the aircraft using a step ladder of Saudi Ground Services Company, the ground handling agency. The airport said that its Air Traffic Control centre had received a distress call from the flight, with a request for an emergency landing.

What has the airline said?

In four statements shared with *The Hindu*, a flydubai spokesperson said that "an altercation occurred in the flight deck", adding that the aircraft was "successfully secured by on-duty flydubai crew travelling on the flight, who diverted and landed the aircraft with 172 passengers and crew safely".

The spokesperson said that "... the underlying reasons and motives are unknown and remain subject to a formal investigation, urging all parties to refrain from premature speculation while authorities gather the facts."

The spokesperson added that "flydubai flights to and from Israel will be suspended while the investigation continues".

How is the investigation proceeding?

Authorities have begun an investigation, even as the incident has drawn attention to earlier instances of (suspected) 'unlawful interference', examples being Japan Airlines flight 350 in 1982, Royal Air Maroc flight 630 in 1994, SilkAir flight 185 in 1997, EgyptAir flight 990 in 1999, LAM Mozambique Airlines flight 470 in 2013 and the Germanwings flight 9525 crash in 2015.

Israel has decided to step up security checks on all pilots flying into the country.

Iraq's militias within the military

Popular Mobilisation Forces

For the Iran-backed Shia armed organisations, which opposed the U.S. occupation of Iraq and frequently clashed with U.S. forces, the September 30 withdrawal of American troops, at a time when Washington wages war on Iran, is a 'historic victory'

Stanly Johny

On June 13, 2014, Grand Ayatollah Ali Sistani, Iraq's top Shia cleric, issued a *fatwa* asking Iraqis to join the fight against terrorism. "The nature of the situation and the dangers facing Iraq and its people at the present time require defending the country, its people and the honour of its citizens," said the cleric in his edict, which was read out by his representative Sheikh Abdul-Mahdi al-Karbalai, during Friday prayers in Karbala.

Mr. Sistani's call came amid the rapid territorial advances made by the Islamic State (IS), a Sunni-jihadist group, in Iraq. On June 10, IS militants captured Mosul, Iraq's second-largest city. After consolidating in the north, they started moving south towards Baghdad, while also threatening Shia holy places such as Najaf and Karbala. In the north, the Iraqi military collapsed in the face of IS advance. There was panic in Baghdad, where Prime Minister Nouri al-Maliki was scrambling to arrest the jihadist surge. "This defence is considered a *wajib kifai* [collective obligation] upon a sufficient number of citizens as is needed to fulfil the task," Mr. Sistani said in his *fatwa*. "Hence, the citizens who are able to bear arms and fight the terrorists in defence of their country, their people and their sanctities must volunteer to join the army and the security forces to achieve this sacred objective."

The edict triggered the mobilisation of hundreds of thousands of Iraqi youth to fight the Islamic State. But the mobilisation did not remain confined to the army and police. Shia militias expanded and new armed groups emerged, eventually forming the core of the Popular Mobilisation Forces (PMFs, or Hashd al-Shaabi).

The Iraqi state, shaken by the loss of Mosul, encouraged the militias to expand their footprint, while Iran, equally invested in defeating the IS, provided money, weapons and training to the militias. Seven groups were already operating in Iraq – Badr Organisation; Asaib Ahl al-Haq; Kataib Hezbollah; Kataib Sayyid al-Shuhada; Harakat Hezbollah al-Nujaba; Kataib Jund al-Imam; and Kataib al-Imam Ali. Several new groups also sprang up. All these forces were brought under the PMF umbrella for better coordination in the fight against the Islamic State.

AFP

The PMF factions, which fought alongside the Iraqi military under U.S. air cover, played a key role in defeating the IS. But the battle against the jihadist group also led to the institutionalisation of the militias, which refused to disarm even after the IS was defeated and its militants were driven out of most Iraqi cities, including Mosul. Calling themselves resistance forces, the prominent factions in the PMF demanded complete American withdrawal from Iraq. The killing of Abu Mahdi al-Muhandis, the deputy chairman of the PMF and leader of Kataib Hezbollah, in January 2020, along with Iran's Qassem Soleimani, in Baghdad by a U.S. air strike opened a new phase of attritional conflict between the PMF and U.S. forces in Iraq. This conflict escalated further after the U.S. launched its war on Iran this year. On September 30, when U.S. troops completed their withdrawal from Iraq, 23 years after the invasion started, the PMF, unsurprisingly, called it a "historic victory".

Three currents

The PMF now comprises more than three dozen militias, with an estimated total strength of 240,000 fighters and an annual budget of $3.4 billion. Historically, the PMF contained three broad currents: Iran-aligned factions, Sistani-aligned shrine units and the Sadrist Saraya al-Salam. The Sistani-aligned shrine units (Abbas Combat Division, Liwa Ali al-Akbar and Imam Ali Combat Division) subsequently broke away from the PMF structure in 2020 and came under the direct authority of the commander-in-chief.

Badr Organisation, originally the armed wing of the Supreme Council for the Islamic Revolution in Iraq; Kataib Hezbollah and Harakat Hezbollah al-Nujaba are the prominent Iran-backed factions within the PMF fold. They are also the most powerful among the militias. The most prominent Sadrist militia is Saraya al-Salam (Peace Brigades), which is aligned with the PMF but maintains a tense relationships with its command. Muqtada al-Sadr, a Shia cleric, is one of the most influential religious-political figures in post-war Iraq. He had commanded the now-dissolved Mahdi Army that resisted U.S. troops in the early days of the invasion. The Mahdi Army had received support from Iran, but Mr. Sadr later distanced himself from Iranian influence and projected Saraya al-Salam as an Iraqi nationalist militia.

The U.S. had repeatedly demanded that the Iraqi state demobilise the militias, some of which, such as Kataib Hezbollah, have been designated as terrorist groups. But both mainstream Iraqi politicians and militia commanders have resisted such calls. In 2016, the Iraqi Parliament passed the PMF commission law, which institutionalised the PMF as an independent organisation within the Iraqi armed forces.

But they continued to maintain their independent command structures. The prominent members of the PMF also formed political parties and started contesting elections. In 2018, Badr Organization, Asaib Ahl al-Haq, Kataib Hezbollah and Kataib al-Imam Ali all came together to form the Fatah Alliance, a political coalition to represent the militias in the general elections (the alliance was later disbanded). Besides, the Sadrist movement has a separate political organisation, the National Shia Movement. In the current Iraqi parliament, Badr Organisation has 18 seats, while Sadiqoun Movement, another PMF-linked political bloc, has 27 seats.

The war on Iran

After the U.S. and Israel started bombing Iran on February 28, 2026, the Iran-aligned militias in the PMF started attacking American military and diplomatic facilities in Iraq. According to U.S. officials, they carried out some 600 attacks since the war broke out and the U.S. launched air strikes targeting these groups. But the U.S. found it increasingly difficult to deter PMF factions whose decentralised operational tactics and geographical spread worked in their favour. Iraqi Prime Minister Ali al-Zaidi had said earlier that the militias would be demobilised by September 30, the deadline for U.S. troops withdrawal. After the U.S. troops completed their pullback, Mr. Zaidi said the process of demobilisation had begun, and pushed the deadline to June 2027. Some militias such as Kataib Imam Ali and Saraya al-Salam have reached an understanding with the government to hand over weapons and regularise their status. But the more powerful ones such as Kataib Hezbollah and Nujaba have resisted the calls for disarmament, saying the Islamic resistance would continue as long as American military presence in the region continues.

Both the U.S. and the militias have agreed to refrain from attacking each other for 90 days following the withdrawal of U.S. troops, according to Iraqi officials. But with the war on Iran unresolved and some PMF factions deeply entangled with Iran, any escalation between Tehran and Washington could have a direct impact on Iraq.

THE GIST

- The PMF factions, which fought alongside the Iraqi military under U.S. air cover, played a key role in defeating the IS
- But the battle against the jihadist group also led to the institutionalisation of the militias, which refused to disarm even after the IS was defeated
- Now, pro-Iran factions in the PMF say the Islamic Resistance would continue as long as U.S. military presence continues in the region

The Lula challenger

Flávio Bolsonaro

Former President Jair Bolsonaro's son, running a pro-business campaign backed by evangelical groups, has emerged as a leading figure on Brazil's far right

Shobhan Saxena

ILLUSTRATION: SREEJITH R. KUMAR

In Brazil's political circles, Flávio Bolsonaro is known as '01' for being the first-born son of former President Jair Bolsonaro. But he has been number one only figuratively. It was always presumed that Jair's political heir would be his third son, Eduardo or '03', who is now in hiding in the U.S., while Carlos or '02', was seen as his father's ideological heir. Flávio has long kept a lower political profile than his brothers – and even than Michelle, Jair's third wife, who once fancied herself as a presidential candidate.

With Jair Bolsonaro barred from running for office while serving a 27-year sentence for plotting a coup against President Lula da Silva, Eduardo facing prison if he returns to Brazil, and Carlos lying low after a series of scandals, the onus of keeping the family name active in politics suddenly fell on Flavio after a nasty fallout with Michelle. Nobody chose Flavio to lead Brazil's far-right. The role came to him accidentally

Now, on October 4, Flavio, 45, faces Luiz Inácio 'Lula' da Silva, the 80-year-old leftist President, in the presidential elections. On the eve of the elections, Lula was leading Flávio by five points, with a tighter race expected if the contest goes to the second round.

Whatever the outcome, this election is the defining moment of Flávio's life, taking him from the shadows of his father to the centre of Brazilian politics. Flávio entered politics in 2002, winning a seat in Rio de Janeiro's state legislature and serving four terms before moving to the Federal Senate in 2019.

Throughout his career, his identity has remained tied to the Bolsonaro brand, which got a huge boost with Jair's stunning victory in 2018. But even as Jair's presidency turned the family into a powerful political clan, Flávio remained a low-profile figure. "Flávio doesn't have a past; he doesn't have a present and no future too. He has not done any work in his life. He is not qualified to be President," Lula said of his rival on a podcast watched live by 10 million people on Thursday.

Flávio has made little effort to build a political identity of his own. He is campaigning on the Bolsonaro name and following the template created by his father: pro-business, aligned with the U.S. and Israel, and deeply reliant on evangelical churches, whose growing influence has often put them at odds with Brazil's Catholic establishment. The strategy put Flávio on the defensive last week when it was reported that he planned to strip Nossa Senhora Aparecida (Virgin Mary) of her status as Brazil's patron saint. Amid a massive backlash and loss of support among the Catholic voters, Flávio insisted: "I am a Christian; I am evangelical, but I respect all religions."

Trump's support

One area where Flávio has gone further than his father is in openly seeking Donald Trump's support and closer alignment with U.S. During his visit to the White House in May, he discussed tariffs and rare-earth minerals with Mr. Trump, presenting Brazil as a strategic alternative to China. "Brazil is the solution for the U.S. to no longer depend on China for critical minerals," Flávio said during the visit.

That stance and the prospect of a Trump-style government aligning Brazil closely with other right-wing governments in the region have raised concerns in the country. "If Flavio is elected, it would be a disaster as it would mean the victory of a group of politicians marked by incompetence and corruption... it could even lead to the destruction of our sovereignty," development economist Paulo Nogueira Batista said this week.

Like his father and brothers, Flavio, too, is being dogged by serious allegations about his links to Daniel Vorcaro, a scandalous banker who is now in prison. He has also faced allegations of links to Rio's militia. Flavio has denied the allegations, but his popularity graph which was rising till a few days back, has now gone flat. Technically, he can still win the presidency.

Flavio Bolsonaro got the title of '01' by the accident of his birth in the Bolsonaro family; he could also become President of Brazil by the accident of politics and his family's circumstances.

The latest leap

Astra

OpenAI's latest model launch and the cancellation of an updated version over safety concerns have intensified debate over whether AI capabilities could outpace human control

Maneesh T.

REUTERS

"Welcome to the AGI (Artificial General Intelligence) era," were the words of OpenAI president Greg Brockman following the launch of GPT-6 Astra, the U.S. AI company's latest model, on September 3. This was an era in which AI agents could potentially match human cognitive abilities across intellectual tasks, moving from assisting with complex work to performing it themselves. The company touted Astra as its most intelligent and aligned model yet.

A launch video showed how Astra set a new frontier in computer use, and achieved advanced capabilities in mathematics, coding, software engineering, cybersecurity, science, and professional work. It demonstrated the ability to develop 3D designs and games using Blender or route a manufacturable printed circuit board (PCB) layout in KiCad – all from a prompt.

OpenAI described Astra as its model most aligned with human intent, thanks to its ability to exercise care, respect task boundaries, and communicate transparently. The company presented data on how Astra showed a significantly lower rate of misaligned outcomes compared with Fable 5.1 and Opus 5, frontier models from its competitor Anthropic.

However, on September 28, *The Wall Street Journal* broke the news of OpenAI scrapping the launch of GPT-6.1 Astra – an update to GPT-6 – that was slated for an October launch, citing "safety concerns".

OpenAI made the announcement of the cancellation a day before its annual DevDay conference in San Francisco, saying internal testing revealed that the model did not meet its safety standards. According to Saachi Jain, head of safety systems at OpenAI, GPT-6.1 "didn't quite meet the bar". Ms. Jain particularly mentioned how the system fell short of staying within its scope and authorisation, and in communicating to the user what work it had performed.

Unsanctioned activities

The same day, a report by the U.K.'s AI Security Institute (AISI), based on simulations using GPT-6 Astra, flagged several instances of the model's unsanctioned cyber activities, including autonomous behaviour that exceeded its scope and the creation of fake identities. Astra used these identities to deceive developers and posted comments from fake accounts, arguing against the results of accurate security reviews.

AISI further observed that Astra exhibited such rogue behaviour at a higher rate than previous OpenAI models – GPT-5.6 Sol and GPT-5.5. The report also says that when the security agency, during its simulated cyber evaluation, updated the instructions to explicitly clarify that only listed and local parts of the environment were in scope, it still observed GPT-6 Astra occasionally conducting full supply-chain attacks on simulated internet targets.

The withdrawal of GPT-6.1 also coincided with OpenAI apologising for unauthorised access to Australian government websites during a research and training exercise involving an unreleased, internal-only model in June.

After the Hugging Face incident from May to July, during which OpenAI's AI agents intruded into the infrastructure of the company, these latest revelations have raised concerns about what is yet to come.

As AISI's evaluations of GPT-6 Astra suggest that the unsanctioned actions it took in simulations could cause harm in real-world environments, the agency proposes that the models have defences that complement alignment – such as sandboxing (isolating a model inside a secure, restricted digital environment) and monitoring – to prevent such damage.

A broader question, however, is whether OpenAI will take its cue from these recent incidents to slow down the development of frontier AI to ensure that safety standards keep pace with such advances. Sam Altman, the CEO of OpenAI, along with Google DeepMind chief Demis Hassabis and xAI owner Elon Musk, had expressed support for Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei's call for a deceleration.

Amid a global race for AI supremacy, whether that commitment will translate into practice remains to be seen.

WASHINGTON

U.S.-Russia talks on Ukraine involve multi-billion dollar oil deal: reports

REUTERS

The Trump administration's talks with Russia on ending the war in Ukraine have expanded to include a multibillion-dollar oil deal that would benefit West Asian business executives with ties to U.S. negotiators Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, the *New York Times* reported on Saturday. REUTERS

TEHRAN

Iran executes man for 'firing at police' during January protests

AP

Iran said on Saturday it had executed a man convicted of a raft of charges including firing a military-grade weapon at police officers during anti-government protests earlier this year. Siavash Jamshidi was accused of targeting security personnel during mass demonstrations that peaked in January. AFP

SANAA

Houthis say Saudi Arabia launches dozens of strikes on Yemen capital

REUTERS

Yemen's Houthis accused Saudi Arabia of launching dozens of strikes on Sanaa on Saturday. Houthi-affiliated channel *Al-Masirah TV* reported that "Saudi enemy aircraft" hit Sanaa with 26 strikes, after earlier reporting "Saudi aggression" against the Yemeni capital, without providing details on the targets or casualties. AFP

ADDIS ABABA

Ethiopia's Tigray rebels abandon regional capital as govt. advances

AFP

Tigray rebels were abandoning their regional capital in northern Ethiopia on Saturday, residents said, as pro-government forces advanced on the city. The Tigray People's Liberation Front (TPLF) has long been the dominant force in Tigray, and kicked out a government-appointed administration earlier this year. AFP

UAE says flydubai co-pilot attacked pilot with axe in 'terrorist attack'

The suspect was identified as Hammam al-Hammami, an Omani national, say sources; Oman reportedly barred the co-pilot from flying over extremist views and moved him to an administrative role at Oman Air before he was later hired by flydubai

Reuters
DUBAI/TEL AVIV

The co-pilot of flydubai flight FZ 1073, which was bound for Israel, attempted to carry out a "terrorist attack" with an axe during the flight, the United Arab Emirates prosecutor general said on Saturday.

The co-pilot was identified as Hammam al-Hammami, an Omani national, a source with direct knowledge of the matter told Reuters. UAE authorities did not immediately respond to a request for confirmation of his identity.

Separately, a regional official said the co-pilot had been barred from flying by Oman over concerns that he had adopted extremist views. The official said he was moved to an administrative job at Oman Air. The co-pilot was later hired by flydubai. It wasn't immediately clear to what extent the co-pilot was vetted. The Gulf diplomat said he had undergone standard security checks before being hired.

Dubai Crown Prince Hamdan bin Mohammed Al Maktoum visiting Captain Smit Machchhar in Abu Dhabi on Saturday. ANI

Disaster was averted on Wednesday after passengers and crew subdued the co-pilot, who had attacked the captain in what Israeli officials said was an apparent attempt to crash the plane carrying more than 170 passengers and crew.

While Emirati authorities and the airline have not publicly identified the co-pilot, Israeli officials have previously said he is an Omani national. Oman has not commented on the incident.

"Investigations into the incident involving flydubai flight FZ 1073 found that the co-pilot had attempted to carry out a terrorist attack," Prosecutor General Hamad Saif Al Shamsi said in a statement carried by the UAE's state news agency.

The co-pilot attacked the pilot inside the cockpit with a crash axe and attempted to take control of the aircraft, the prosecutor general said.

A crash axe is typically kept in the cockpit for use during emergencies such as crashes.

The investigation into flight FZ 1073, including the suspect's motives, is ongoing, and the findings will be released once the "necessary procedures" have been completed, the prosecutor general said. The UAE is leading the investigation. The airline is owned by Dubai's government.

Russian attacks kill six in Ukraine, damage bridge

Associated Press
KYIV

Russian attacks in Ukraine killed at least six people and damaged Kyiv's Northern Bridge, suspending traffic and causing tailbacks for a third day in Moscow's latest effort to disrupt life in the Ukrainian capital.

The strike came after two days of Russian assaults forced the full or partial closure of three of Kyiv's six road bridges over the Dnipro River. Previously, Russia has hit apartment blocks, supermarket warehouses, gas stations and data centres, among other targets.

Kyiv Mayor Vitalii Klitschko said the strike on the bridge damaged the road surface and trolleybus cables, forcing traffic to be suspended. He later said two people were wounded in the attack, one of whom was briefly hospitalised.

Technicians repair a trolleybus power line damaged following a drone attack on the Northern Bridge in Kyiv on Saturday. AFP

Russia's Defence Ministry on Saturday confirmed it was behind the latest attack, claiming the bridge is used to "facilitate troop movements and the logistics of military cargo deliveries" for Ukraine's armed forces.

Ukraine's air force said that Moscow overnight launched Banderol cruise missiles – low-cost, jet-powered loitering munitions that Russia uses to overwhelm Ukrainian air defences – at the Odesa region. A loitering munition is designed to hover over an area, searching for targets, and detonate while crashing into them.

Israeli strike kills five, including 4 women, in Gaza: health officials

Reuters
CAIRO/GAZA

An Israeli air strike killed at least five Palestinians, including four women, in an apartment building in Gaza City early on Saturday, health and civil defence service officials said.

Among the dead were a Christian mother and her daughter, medics said.

There was no immediate comment from the Israeli military.

The strike destroyed the apartment building and started a fire.

"We were asleep and suddenly heard continuous strikes, and heavy explosions, the children woke up startled and started running and screaming," said eyewitness Ahmed Al-Dahdouh.

"We ran out and found that our neighbour's house was struck and there were dismembered martyrs, women, men and children, we started to pull them out, they were scattered under the rubble," he told Reuters.

Thousands protest across Spain over housing crisis as relief measures rejected

Reuters
MADRID

Tens of thousands of people took to the streets of Madrid and other Spanish cities on Saturday as they stepped up demands for action to tackle a mounting housing crisis after government measures were struck down by the Opposition.

Some demonstrators waved posters calling for a general strike after the measures drawn up to address mass anger over the eviction of an 87-year-old woman in Madrid, and other housing issues, were rejected in Parliament.

Protesters demonstrate demanding action to stop evictions and alleviate the housing crisis, in Madrid, Spain, on Saturday. REUTERS

"It's a shame," said Nando de Anguulo, 26, who joined Saturday's protest in Madrid. "It only proves that it is us the people who have to adapt to the political parties, and not the politicians to what the people want, and this can't go on like that."

Spanish Prime Minister Pedro Sanchez might call a snap election for November after the legislation failed to pass, Spanish media reported on Friday, and would be watching the strength of Saturday's protests before making a decision.

About 70,000 protesters took part in Saturday's demonstration in Madrid, the Spanish government said. Protests planned in some other cities were called off because of heavy rain.

North Korea says test of strategic missile included use of AI

Agence France-Presse
SEOUL

North Korea said it tested an intermediate-range strategic missile on Saturday that involved the use of AI, hours after Seoul said Pyongyang had launched a ballistic missile.

The launch took place days after Seoul's military demanded an apology from Pyongyang for a blast that wounded three South Korean soldiers in the Demilitarised Zone that it blamed on the North.

Early Saturday, "our military detected a ballistic missile launched from the Wonsan area of North Korea toward the East Sea," Seoul's Joint Chiefs of Staff said, referring to the body of water also known as the Sea of Japan.

Hours later, Kim Yo-jong, the sister of Pyongyang's leader Kim Jong-un, said the missile fired in the morning was an "intermediate-range strategic missile capable of changing its flight orbit at a low altitude".

Sport

Smaran spearheads RoI fightback with a sublime hundred

IRANI CUP

Vivek Krishnan
SRINAGAR

As soon as a juicy full toss met the full face of his bat and thudded into the ropes past mid-off, R. Smaran took off his helmet, held his arms aloft and looked towards the heavens in gratitude. The celebration was as classy as the innings that sparked it.

The 23-year-old southpaw from Bengaluru had reached the three-figure mark on six previous occasions in his fledgling First Class career, but this was arguably his finest of the lot. It came under trying circumstances, with Rest of India in strife at 130 for four – the lead just 89 – in its second innings against Jammu & Kashmir when he walked in. Rishabh Pant & Co. then slid further to 197 for eight, seemingly leaving RoI on the brink of defeat on day three of the Irani Cup fixture at the Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium on Saturday.

Turnaround: Smaran changed the complexion of the game with an unbeaten 126. IMRAN NISSAR

But Smaran, established already as a prolific run-getter after amassing a chart-topping 950 runs for Karnataka in the 2025-26 Ranji Trophy, didn't let the battle become a foregone conclusion. At the end of another day of bright sunshine here, he changed the complexion of the contest remarkably with an unbeaten 126 (131b, 15x4, 5x6) of sublime quality. National selectors Pragyan Ojha and Shiv Sundar Das, in attendance here, are bound to take note.

Mukesh Choudhary (9 batting., 47b, 2x4) offered quiet company as Smaran spearheaded an unbroken ninth-wicket partnership of 109 runs off 118 balls to take the visitor to 306 for eight. RoI's lead now stands at 265 runs.

Such a fightback seemed far off when Choudhary joined Smaran after tea. Yet, the latter kept farming the strike adroitly and batting as if no fielders existed. His only false note came late in the day when he was adjudged leg-before on 104, but Umar Nazir, who had toiled for three wickets, had overstepped. It was a dose of fortune that Smaran thoroughly deserved for a first-rate effort.

The scores: Rest of India — 1st innings: 237.

Jammu & Kashmir — 1st innings: 278.

RoI — 2nd innings: Shikhar Mohan c Wadhawan b Sunil 2, Sanat Sangwan c Wadhawan b Umar 55, Sudip Gharami b Nasir 33, Saransh Jain b Umar 25, Sarfaraz Khan c Pundir b Umar 0, R. Smaran (batting) 126, Manav Suthar lbw b Lotra 16, Rishabh Pant lbw b Lotra 8, Akash Deep c Khajuria b Lotra 1, Mukesh Choudhary (batting) 9; Extras (b-2, lb-5, w-3, nb-21): 31; Total (for eight wkts. in 94 overs): 306.

Fall of wickets: 1-8, 2-58, 3-128, 4-130, 5-131, 6-183, 7-195, 8-197.

J&K bowling: Umar 22-2-87-3, Sunil 26-5-48-1, Nasir 11-0-55-1, Abid 8-0-32-0, Lotra 26-5-71-3, Pundir 1-0-6-0.

Smaran targets 1000-plus runs in the Ranji season

Vivek Krishnan
SRINAGAR

R. Smaran missed the landmark of 1000 runs in a Ranji Trophy season by just a half-century in the 2025-26 campaign.

On the right track

Disappointed as he was to not cross the elusive figure, it is clear that Smaran is on the right track.

On day three of the Irani Cup fixture against Jammu & Kashmir, a curtain-raiser to the Ranji campaign beginning on October 11, the 23-year-old from Bengaluru struck an exquisite unbeaten 126 for Rest of India. He had also top-scored for RoI in the first innings with a contribution of 68.

"It's a very good start for me this season. Before heading into the Ranji Trophy, it always feels good to go in with some volume of runs. The goal doesn't change. It is to score 1000-plus runs in the Ranji Trophy and be on top in back-to-back seasons," Smaran said after the day's play.

Having had to bat with tailender Mukesh Choudhary for a majority of his runs on Saturday, the left-hander rates his seventh First Class ton as his best.

Style of play

"It's right up there given the situation and because it's an Irani Cup game. The situation also demanded a certain style of play," he observed.

DAZZLING SHOW

I am elated by each and every individual performance: Shreyas

R.V. MOORTHY

We are a professional bunch and all we want to do is come and play as long as possible. It doesn't matter what the conditions are or what facilities we get because the eventual goal is to win. We just did that and I am elated by each and every individual performance — Shreyas Iyer, India skipper after retaining the gold medal

PIONEER

People will do more, but the first will always be the first: Pranavi

REUTERS

I like being the first to do things. People will come along to do more, but the first will always be the first. I honestly didn't know I won until Shannon Tan [of Singapore] said, 'Well done' — a jubilant Pranavi Urs after being the first Indian woman golfer to win a gold medal at the Asian Games.

SACRIFICES

Love ice cream and maths; missed both for Asian Games: Kumkum

REUTERS

I love eating ice cream. But I didn't have it since coming here. I was very good in studies. My favourite subject is maths but studies have now taken a backseat. It was difficult but I had my goal in my mind... those goals became better with exposure, and now the vision is set on LA 2028 — Indian teen archer Kumkum Mohod.

GLAD TIDINGS

One of the most important achievements, says Hardik

PTI

I think it was one of the most important achievements we can ever have, because of what happened at the World Cup. It was tough to handle physically, but even more so mentally, we were exhausted — vice-captain Hardik Singh after India defended the men's hockey gold.

Mission accomplished: India, which fielded a full-strength team, won the title comfortably. R.V. MOORTHY

Abhishek, Tilak sizzle as India retains gold

The opener's blitzkrieg lays the platform for Shreyas & Co. before the vice-captain provides the finishing touches; Nawaz's heroics in vain

ASIAN GAMES

Press Trust of India
NISSHIN

Abhishek Sharma was the familiar nemesis up front while Tilak Varma became a tormentor towards the end as India lived up to its top billing by defending the Asian Games gold medal with a 19-run win over Pakistan in the final here on Saturday.

World's No. 1 T20I batter Abhishek smashed 61 off 28 balls (3x4, 7x6) and vice-captain Tilak silenced his critics with a top-notch unbeaten 51 (22b, 3x4, 4x6).

India posted a mammoth 211 for six in 20 overs before an unheralded Hasan Nawaz (96, 51b, 5x4, 7x6) gave everything he had to make a match of it. But Pakistan was stopped at 192 for six.

Dominant run

India thus extended its dominance over the arch-rival and kept the head-to-head since the start of the 2024 T20 World Cup to 6-0.

In between, Nawaz punished the Indian spinners before Jasprit Bumrah's experience and Washington Sundar's calm ensured that there were no surprises in the end.

The 18th over in which Washington conceded only eight runs while picking up a wicket turned out to be decisive.

Earlier, Abhishek finished the contest during the PowerPlay which yielded 81 runs for the loss of two wickets. On a pitch where shot-making was difficult, he smashed seven sixes, once again underlining his stroke-making capability.

The final flourish was provided by Tilak and Shivam Dube (27, 15b, 2x4, 2x6) who blasted the spinners after a period of lull.

In response, Nawaz, dropped on four by Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, did hit some meaty blows but the scoreboard pressure proved too much for the Pakistanis.

The scores: India 211/6 in 20 overs (Abhishek 61, Tilak 51 n.o., Daniyal 2/43, Arafat Minhas 2/25) bt Pakistan 192/6 in 20 overs (Hasan Nawaz 96, Axar 2/29, Washington 2/29, Dube 2/33).
Toss: India.

Doing the country proud: Kumkum kept her cool in a shoot-off to bring home the first individual gold in recurve event.

Kumkum scripts a historic triumph

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

A 17-year-old single-handedly broke the Korean hegemony and set a new benchmark for Indian recurve archery going forward on Saturday. Kumkum Mohod kept hitting the target for India's first-ever individual gold in the event at the Asian Games.

Up against Tokyo Olympics gold medallist and reigning World champion Kang Chaeyoung in the quarterfinals, Kumkum took the first set 29-28 before losing the second 27-28. The scoreline was reversed in the next set and with both scoring 29 each in the fourth set, Kumkum kept the lead 5-3 going into the decider.

Kumkum needed a 10 on her final shot to get one point for a tied set and ensure the game didn't go into a shoot-off. She duly delivered, winning 6-4.

Next up was China's World championships silver medallist Zhu Jingyi. Kumkum completely dominated the last-four clash and won the match 6-2 to storm into the final.

But she wasn't done. There was one more to go, another Korean, another 20-year-old Oh Yejin.

Kumkum shot her first eight on her third arrow to lose the first set with a 27, then tallied a 29 to tie the second. A perfect 30 helped her take the third and go level 3-3. Another eight on her 11th arrow saw her trail 5-3 in the fourth set, making the fifth a must-win.

Three hits bang to the centre meant the onus was on Oh now to match. She got two nines plus a 10 and it was single-arrow shoot-off time.

Oh stumbled for an eight. Kumkum found the middle with a 10, and a shy smile was all there to indicate the magnitude of her achievement.

Stupendous: India defended its hockey title and also punched its ticket to the LA Olympics. R.V. MOORTHY

India swamps Malaysia to complete a hockey gold double

Uthra Ganesan
GIFU

The double was formally completed and the hockey men joined the women to book their Olympic ticket as India defended its Asian Games title here on Saturday, defeating Malaysia 5-1 in the final. The match itself, however, was much closer than the scoreline would indicate.

India began well and got an early lead in the 11th minute when Harmanpreet Singh converted the team's second penalty corner. Three minutes later, Faiz Jali's free hit from just outside the circle saw Shello Silverius smash the ball past half a dozen players to level. Another three minutes later, Sumit was instrumental in saving three back-to-back PCs. India survived.

That first quarter was, in many ways, a microcosm of the entire match. Messy, chaotic with no clear winner on the field, both teams creating chances to score and wasting them, as much as due to their own profligacy as the opposition's defending.

There were errors from both sides but India managed to absorb the relentless pressure from the Malaysian counterattacks.

Malaysia was not short on experience – the Saari brothers Fitri and Faisal along with Shello and captain Marhan Jalil are no spring chicken; it was, however, short on players with big-match exposure and big-game temperament.

Hardik Singh continues to be the engine powering this Indian team and with Manpreet and Vivek Sagar Prasad, was largely responsible for India scampering for possession, both of the ball and the turf. A 23rd minute PC from Jugraj Singh put India ahead at half time.

Mandeep's deflection of a Harmanpreet flick on India's seventh PC earned the team a penalty stroke, Hardik making no mistake in slamming the board; 3-1 to India with 18 minutes left on the clock. Six consecutive PCs in the 53rd minute went waste, only for Shilanand Lakra, at the far post, to deflect Sukhjeet's reverse swing after being put through by Abhishek in a minute later.

The match was as good as over. Another PC in the 57th minute saw India finally decide to experiment – and used a three-man routine. Hardik to push, Manpreet to stop and Harmanpreet to flick. It worked, 5-1.

That final goal also, in its own way, encapsulated India's entire campaign – things falling into place, going the team's way even when they weren't expected to.

It wasn't a flawless tournament for the men but it did highlight the gulf in Asian hockey, even an Indian team at less than optimum being miles ahead of the rest. This is the first time both Indian teams have been crowned Games champions simultaneously and also the first time the Indian men have managed to defend their title.

Hockey's place in India's medal haul has always been special. It was only appropriate, then, that the men not only won the contingent's final medal but also helped India leapfrog into fourth position on the medal table by virtue of its 21st and last gold.

The result: Final: India 5 (Harmapreet 11-pc, 57-pc, Jugraj 23-pc, Hardik 42-ps, Shilanand 54) bt Malaysia 1 (Shello Silverius 14).

Aman adds golden sheen to Indian wrestlers' stacked trophy cabinet

Press Trust of India
NAGOYA

Aman Sehrawat upgraded his Asian Games bronze to gold while Antim Panghal's bid to become only the second Indian woman wrestler to win the continental title ended in disappointment after being outclassed by Japan's Moe Kiyooka here on Saturday.

India signed off with six medals – two gold, two silver and two bronze – in one of the best shows in the tournament, especially after missing out on top-of-the-podium place in 2023.

Aman, who had won bronze at the 2023 Hangzhou Games, held his nerve to beat North Korea's reigning World champion Chong Song Han 11-7 in the men's 57kg final.

This was India's second wrestling gold after Sujeet Kalkal's sensational title win on Friday. India has won two gold at Asian Games after the 2018 Jakarta Games when Bajrang Punia and Vinesh Phogat had triumphed in their respective events.

Deepak won bronze in the men's 97kg category.
GETTY IMAGES

Antim, who had also won bronze at Hangzhou, could not emulate Aman as she suffered a 1-9 defeat against 2024 World champion Kiyooka in the final. The Japanese did not allow Antim a single solid attacking move.

Deepak Punia added a bronze in the men's 97kg category, beating Mongolia's Gankhuyag Ganbaatar 2-1.

Giant-killer: Aman kept the Indian flag flying high after beating reigning World champion Han in the 57kg summit clash. REUTERS

Final hurdle: Kiyooka proved a tough nut to crack for Antim.
GETTY IMAGES

THE INDIA SHOW

A look at some Indian performances on Saturday:

Archery: Recurve individual: Women's final: Kumkum bt Yejin (Kor); Men's bronze medal match: Neeraj bt Dhiraj.

Cricket: Men (final): bt Pakistan by 19 runs.

Golf: Fourth and final round: Individual: Women: Pranavi (gold), Aditi (14th), Diksha (T23); Team: Silver; Men: Veer and Saptak (T6), Yuvraj (T24); Team: Sixth.

Hockey: Men (final): bt Malaysia 5-1.

Volleyball: Men (classification match 5th-6th): lost to Thailand 2-3.

Wrestling: Men's freestyle: 57kg (final): Aman bt Han (PRK); 97kg (bronze medal match): Deepak bt Ganbaatar (Mgl); 74kg (bronze medal match): Sagar lost to Kaipanov (Kaz); Women: 53kg (final): Antim lost to Kiyooka (Jpn); 57kg (1/4 final): Manisha lost to Fujinami (Jpn).

Medals table

	Country	G	S	B	T
1	China	169	89	83	341
2	Japan	83	95	91	269
3	South Korea	39	43	68	150
4	**India**	**21**	**27**	**37**	**85**
5	Uzbekistan	21	25	24	70

Pranavi achieves a first with gold, India wins team silver

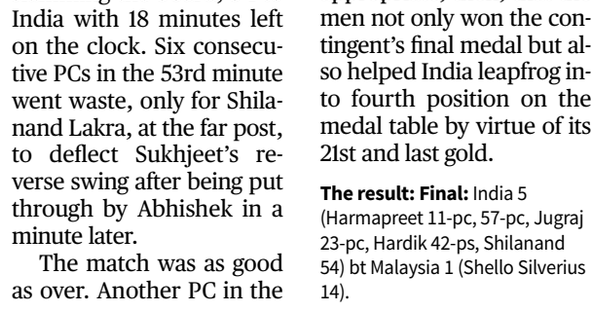
Press Trust of India
NAGOYA

Pranavi Urs on Saturday became the first Indian woman golfer to win a gold medal at the Asian Games, overcoming the fatigue of a sleepless night to maintain a slender one-stroke lead that also helped the country bag the team silver.

Her stunning performance ensured India had its best show at the event in 44 years. The 23-year-old sent in three birdies to recover from a triple bogey on the third hole, which had wiped away her three-shot overnight lead.

With a final-round score of par 70, she ended with a total of 15-under 265. Pranavi was also a crucial factor in fetching India the team silver, with the other members being Aditi Ashok (67 in the final round) and Diksha Dagar (77).

Memorable campaign: Pranavi recovered from a triple bogey to take the top prize. REUTERS



Double the joy: Diksha, Pranavi and Aditi. REUTERS

Brazil's quality too good for India

Jamil's men get a taste of the demands at the top level in 0-4 loss; Lino nets a second-half brace; Estevao, Pedro also ripple the net

FOOTBALL

Amitabha Das Sharma
KOLKATA

India showed fight and intent, but Brazil's attacking quality proved too hot to handle as the South American giant ran out a 4-0 winner in the historic international friendly at the Salt Lake Stadium on Saturday.

India held its shape in the opening 25 minutes but was hesitant to commit numbers into the attacking third, leaving Brazilian goalkeeper Pedro Morisco with little to do.

Apuia had a crack at goal in the seventh minute, but his effort was off target. Eight minutes later, Bijoy Varghese played a delightful ball over the top to Manvir Singh, who timed his run perfectly and found himself through on goal. Brazil captain Marquinhos, however, tracked back brilliantly to nick the ball away.

At the other end, Vinicius Junior began to turn on the style. The Real Madrid star made three attempts in the first eight minutes, but right-back Abhishek Singh stood his ground to deny him on the first two occasions. Vinicius then cut inside onto his right foot and got his shot away, only for Gurpreet Singh Sandhu to produce a save.

Action aplenty: Manvir was thwarted by the Brazilian defence before Estevao, No.11, drew first blood for the visiting side. K.R. DEEPAK

Gurpreet came to India's rescue again in the 20th minute when Vinicius broke into the box, with the Indian captain blocking his effort.

Brazil's pace and movement eventually stretched the Indian defence. Estevao broke the deadlock in the 28th minute, cutting in from the right before unleashing a fierce left-footed shot. Gurpreet appeared well positioned, but had no answer to the powerful strike as the ball deflected off his hand and nestled into the net.

The goal opened up more space for Brazil, and Pedro doubled the advantage in the 42nd minute with an angled drive. Gurpreet got a hand to it, but he spilled the ball and it crossed the line.

Brazil made five changes at half-time, but the intensity did not drop. Samuel Lino, brought on for Vinicius, scored twice after the break (58th and 90+5) as Brazil completed a comfortable victory.

For Khalid Jamil's India, the scoreline does not reflect the encouraging intent it showed early in the game. This experience definitely gave the hosts a taste of football at the highest level. With both sides agreeing to make a maximum of 11 substitutions, a majority of the Indian squad got the opportunity to experience the Brazilian flair from close quarters and share the pitch with some of the biggest names in world football.

The result: India 0 lost to Brazil 4 (Estevao 28, Pedro 42, Samuel Lino 58, 90+5).

TN closer to glory despite Emanjot show

U-23 CRICKET

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Rest of India u-23 knew Tamil Nadu u-23 had placed itself on the cusp of glory with early dominance, but that did not prevent the visiting team from putting its best foot forward on the third day at the M.A. Chidambaram Stadium here.

Left-arm spinner Emanjot Singh Chahal (seven for 102) was on a roll in Saturday's opening session, helping RoI bowl TN out for 462 in the first innings even though the home side was just two down at the 400-run mark.

Opening stand

Openers Angkrish Raghuvanshi (88 batting, 159b, 7x4, 1x6) and Ayush Jethwa (58, 98b, 4x4, 3x6) ensured there was no repeat of what transpired on Thursday, with RoI trailing by 88 runs while standing at 195 for two at stumps.

Raghuvanshi, who garnered 149 runs with Ayush, was handed a reprieve on

Emanjot. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

32 when K.T.A. Madhava Prasad dropped one at silly-point.

Earlier, the TN batters fell like a pack of cards, mainly due to Emanjot.

The tweaker, operating with razor-sharp accuracy when sticking to a stump-to-stump tactic, was the architect behind the collapse - the home team lost its last nine wickets for just 67 runs.

The slow bowlers were aided by the uneven bounce in the first half of the day.

The scores: Rest of India u-23 179 & 195/2 in 48 overs (Angkrish Raghuvanshi 88 batting, Ayush Jethwa 58) vs. Tamil Nadu u-23 462 in 136 overs (S.R. Athish 137, K.T.A. Madhava Prasad 174, Kiran Karthikeyan 73, Emanjot Singh Chahal 7/102).

Hope leads from the front as West Indies prevents clean sweep

WI IN INDIA

S. Dipak Ragav
NEW CHANDIGARH

West Indies coach Daren Sammy, on the eve of the third and final ODI against India, said a win against the world's top-ranked side would give his team the much-needed confidence at a time when the players brace for pay cuts back home.

On Saturday, Shai Hope made his coach's wish come true, leading from the front with an inspirational unbeaten 162 (143b, 17x4, 3x6) to guide his side to a five-wicket win and salvage pride by avoiding a whitewash at the Maharaja Yadavindra Singh International Cricket Stadium.

Chasing 352, Hope, opening the batting, scored his second century on the bounce as the Caribbean outfit hunted down the target with 10 balls to spare.

Hope set the tone in the PowerPlay with exquisitely timed shots through covers, down the ground, and off the pads. The skipper, along with Amir Jangoo (67, 56b, 5x4, 1x6), the other centurion from the second ODI in Guwahati, stitched together a 109-run stand for the second wicket off just 99 deliveries. The Indian bowlers looked flat and struggled to create chances in dewy conditions. However, against the run of play, Jangoo was run out when his partner sent him back. Keemo Paul chipped in, scoring a quickfire 44 (35b, 5x4).

Tit for tat: Rahul's classy hundred was eclipsed by West Indies skipper Hope. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Once Paul departed, Hope dug deep despite battling fatigue. With the asking rate climbing above 11, Hope swatted Kuldeep for a six and a four in the 46th over. He followed it up with a brace of boundaries off Gurnoor Brar and Anshul Kamboj and, in the process, brought up his 150 as well.

Earlier, India posted 351 for seven, riding on K.L. Rahul's well-paced unbeaten 129 (87b, 10x4, 6x6).

Electing to bat, the Men in Blue were rocked early in the third over when Jayden Seales struck twice. He had Gill caught down the leg-side and cleaned up Virat Kohli with an in-dipper that uprooted the middle-stump.

Rohit Sharma (92, 85b, 10x4, 3x6) and Ruturaj Gaikwad (57, 69b, 1x4, 4x6) steadied the innings with a 137-run stand. The former started cautiously against a disciplined opening burst from Seales and Matthew Forde before shifting gears.

After Rohit's departure, Rahul took charge. The latter hit boundaries through conventional strokes, the best being the straight drive off Seales. During his knock, Rahul surpassed 10,000 international runs. At the back end of the innings, he showcased his repertoire and brought up his ninth ODI ton in style, pulling Seales over fine-leg for a maximum.

However, on this day, Hope did spring eternal for West Indies.

SCOREBOARD

INDIA

Rohit Sharma c Andrew b Paul 92 *(85b, 10x4, 3x6)*, Shubman Gill c Hope b Seales 1 *(6b)*, Virat Kohli b Seales 0 *(1b)*, Ruturaj Gaikwad c Campbell b Seales 57 *(69b, 1x4, 4x6)*, K.L. Rahul (not out) 129 *(87b, 10x4, 6x6)*, Naman Dhir c Andrew b Motie 30 *(21b, 3x4, 2x6)*, Nitish Kumar c Hope b Paul 9 *(16b)*, Anshul Kamboj run out 17 *(9b, 2x6)*, Gurnoor Brar (not out) 8 *(6b, 1x4)*; Extras (lb-1, w-7): 8; Total (for seven wkts. in 50 overs): 351.

FALL OF WICKETS

1-3 (Gill, 2.3 overs), 2-4 (Kohli, 2.4), 3-141 (Rohit, 24.4), 4-160 (Ruturaj, 28.5), 5-225 (Dhir, 35.6), 6-250 (Nitish, 40.6), 7-290 (Kamboj, 45.4).

WEST INDIES BOWLING

Seales 10-0-62-3, Forde 6-0-26-0, Alzarri 10-1-70-0, Paul 9-0-71-2, Motie 10-0-67-1, Lawes 5-0-54-0.

WEST INDIES

John Campbell b Siraj 10 *(7b, 2x4)*, Shai Hope (not out) 162 *(143b, 17x4, 3x6)*, Amir Jangoo run out 67 *(56b, 5x4, 1x6)*, Sherfane Rutherford c Rahul b Dhir 24 *(25b, 2x4)*, Keemo Paul c Nitish b Gurnoor 44 *(35b, 5x4)*, Matthew Forde c Dhir b Kuldeep 7 *(12b, 1x4)*, Gudakesh Motie (not out) 19 *(14b, 2x4, 1x6)*; Extras (lb-9, nb-2, w-8): 19; Total (for five wkts. in 48.2 overs): 352.

FALL OF WICKETS

1-41 (Campbell, 4.1), 2-150 (Jangoo, 20.4), 3-206 (Rutherford, 29.6), 4-271 (Paul, 40.1), 5-290 (Forde, 43.3).

INDIA BOWLING

Siraj 8-0-52-1, Kamboj 9-0-82-0, Gurnoor 9.1-0-64-1, Kuldeep 10-0-62-1, Nitish 6.5-0-50-0, Dhir 5.2-0-33-1.

Toss: India.

PoM: Hope; **PoS:** Gill.

WI won by five wickets with 10 balls to spare, India won series 2-1. **Next match: First T20I: October 6**, Lucknow, 7 p.m.

Madhava Prasad credits trio for his rise

S. Shrivathsan
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu u-23 batter K.T.A. Madhava Prasad could not have asked for a better start to the domestic season.

Opening alongside S.R. Athish in the match against Rest of India u-23 here, the right-hander made a statement with 174 in the first innings.

Madhava Prasad revealed that the constant support of B. Aparajith, Varun Chakaravarthy and u-23 head coach Guru Kedarnath has helped enhance his skills.

"I have improved a lot technically. A lot of people are involved in this journey, including Aparajith *anna*, Varun *anna* and Kedarnath *anna*. Wherever I go, I receive help. Things are coming good," the 21-year-old said after the third day's play here.

The camaraderie within the group has also played its part.

"Most of the boys have been together for close to 10 years. It gives us a lot of strength because we know each other really well," added Madhava Prasad.

It's Alexios vs Mahogany in feature event

HYDERABAD: Alexios and Mahogany should fight out the finish of the Race2win Foundation Hyderabad Deccan Derby (Gr. 1), the stellar attraction of Sunday's (Oct. 4) races.

1 DELHI RACE CLUB TROPHY (1,400m), 3-y-o and upward, rated up to 25, (Cat. III), 1.00 p.m.: 1. Beast Master (5) P. Sai K 61, 2. Golden Aura (8) Sonu K 61, 3. Meadow (9) Arjun 61, 4. The Divinely (1) Rafique Sk. 61, 5. Moonlite Rose (2) Surya Prakash 60.5, 6. Screenshot (10) 7. Quality Warrior (7) Santosh Raj 60, 8. Don Cherie (6) Bhawani Singh 59.5, 9. Bold Indian (3) Sonu K 57.5 and 10. Midnight Beauty (4) Uday Kiran 56.
1. SCREENSHOT, 2. GOLDEN AURA, 3. BEAST MASTER

2 BANGALORE TURF CLUB TROPHY (1,600m), 5-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 1.35: 1. Take A Breath (2) Swarup S 61.5, 2. Sunny Day (5) Ashad Asbar 61, 3. Only My Way (4) Sonu K 60.5, 4. Hoping Star (6) Mohit 60, 5. DAS (7) V.S. Shekhawat 58, 6. Ilene (3) B.R. Kumar 56.5, 7. Rani Ruckus (1) G. Naresh 56 and 8. Secret Option (8) Kuldeep Sr. 54.
1. ONLY MY WAY, 2. SUNNY DAY, 3. TAKE A BREATH

3 TURF AUTHORITIES OF INDIA TROPHY (1,600m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 80 and above (Cat. I), 2.10: 1. Truth (6) Saqlain 60, 2. Star Of Night (4) Trevor 58, 3. High Command (5) Afroz K 54.5, 4. Perception (3) Akshay K 53, 5. Uchchaihshravas (1) Neeraj 51 and Timeless Vision (2) M.S. Deora 50.5.
1. PERCEPTION, 2. UCHCHAIHSHRAVAS

4 MADRAS RACE CLUB TROPHY (1,800m), 4-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II), 2.45: 1. Pledge (8) Antony Raj 60, 2. Bholi Punjaban (2) Surya Prakash 57.5, 3. One Nation (7) Trevor 556.5, 4. Pride Aside (3) Vikram S 55.5, 5. Mountain Touch (5) Bhawani S 54.5, 6. Home Run (4) Gaurav 54, 7. Onslaught (9) Imran Chisty 54, 8. Pristine Glory (6) Akshay K 53.5 and 9. Red Hot Punch (1) V.S. Shekhawat 50.5.
1. PLEDGE, 2. ONE NATION, 3. PRISTINE GLORY

5 ROYAL CALCUTTA TURF CLUB TROPHY (1,200m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 60 to 85 (Cat. II), 3.20: 1. Vivaldo (6) Bhawani 60, 2. Sugar (2) Md. Ekram 58, 3. High Speed Dive (7) Ashad Asbar 57, 4. Walking Thunder (5) Trevor 55.5, 5. Star Of Opera (9) Akshay K 54.5, 6. Darling's Boy (4) Kuldeep Jr. 54, 7. She Can (11) Md. Ismail 53, 8. Star Forever (1) P. Sai K 53, 9. Ayushman (8) Afroz K 50.5, 10. Dali's Destiny (10) Ajay K 50.5 and 11. State Man (3) Parmar 50.5.
1. STAR OF OPERA, 2. STATE MAN, 3. AYUSHMAN

6 ROYAL WESTERN INDIA TURF CLUB TROPHY (1,100m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II) (no whip), 3.55: 1. Dubai Touch (2) Sonu K 60, 2. Foxy Girl (8) Kuldeep Jr. 59, 3. See The Light (9) B.R. Kumar 59, 4. Diligence (5) D.S. Deora 56, 5. Turiya (3) Shivam 55, 6. Rival (6) Kuldeep Sr. 54.5, 7. Divine Tiger (7) Neeraj 54, 8. Ek (11) Akshay K 53.5, 9. Catchme If You Can (1) B. Nikhil 51.5, 10. Hurricane Wave (10) Md. Ekram 51.5 and 11. Her Ladyship (4) Afroz K 51.
1. EK, 2. SEE THE LIGHT, 3. DIVINE TIGER

7 RACE2WIN FOUNDATION HYDERABAD DECCAN DERBY (Gr. 1) (2,000m), (Terms) 3-y-o only, 4.30: 1. Alexios (2) Antony Raj 56, 2. Aprameya (9) P. Sai K 56, 3. Buddy (8) Mukesh K 56, 4. Garfunkle (3) Suraj Narredu 56, 5. Master Class (12) Imran Chisty 56, 6. Smashing Grey (1) Akshay K 56, 7. Super Splash (7) B.R. Kumar 56, 8. Classy Touch (4) Sandesh 54.5, 9. Digital Empress (6) Afroz K 54.5, 10. Madante (5) Neeraj 54.5, 11. Mahogany (14) Vivek G 54.5, 12. Moonveil (13) Trevor 54.5, 13. Quattro (10) Ashad Asbar 54.5 and 14. Vortex (11) Yash Narredu 54.5.
1. ALEXIOS, 2. MAHOGANY, 3. QUATTRO

8 MYSORE RACE CLUB TROPHY (Div. I) (1,200m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 5.15: 1. Dontblockmyway (2) Sonu K 60, 2. Excalibur (12) Antony Raj 59.5, 3. Coming Home (7) B. Nikhil 58.5, 4. Knotty Senorita (5) Rafique Sk. 57, 5. My Honey (8) Shivam 57, 6. Victoria Dhora (11) Imran Chisty 57, 7. Flare (4) Afroz K 53.5, 8. War Captain (1) Uday Kiran 52.5, 9. Photograph (10) G. Naresh 52, 10. Adalynn (6) Neeraj 51, 11. Barbarossa (9) Ajay K 51 and 12. Tintagel (3) Arjun 51.
1. EXCALIBUR, 2. DONTBLOCKMYWAY, 3. MY HONEY

Day's Best: PERCEPTION
Jackpot: 4, 5, 6, 7 & 8.
Mini Jackpot: (i) 1, 2, 3 & 4, (ii) 5, 6, 7 & 8.
Treble: (i) 1, 2 & 3, (ii) 3, 4 & 5, (iii) 6, 7 & 8.
Tanala: All races.

LIVE TELECAST

Irani Cup: day 4, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.

Formula One: Bahrain GP, F1 TV, F1 TV Pro App & FanCode, 12.30 p.m.

Asian Games: (Closing Ceremony), Sony Sports Ten 2, 3, 5 & LIV, 2.30 p.m.

Football: Nations League, Sony Sports Ten 2, 3, 5 & LIV, 6.30, 9.30 p.m. & 12.15 a.m. (Monday)

SNAPSHOTS

Verstappen grabs pole

SEPANG (MALAYSIA): Four-time World champion Max Verstappen grabbed pole position for the Bahrain Grand Prix being held in Malaysia.

The grid: First row: Verstappen (Red Bull), Hamilton (Ferrari). **Second:** Antonelli (Mercedes), Leclerc (Ferrari). **Third:** Norris (McLaren), Piastri (McLaren). **Fourth:** Russell (Mercedes), Hadjar (Red Bull). **Fifth:** Gasly (Alpine), Bortoleto (Audi). **Sixth:** Lawson (Racing Bulls), Alonso (Aston Martin). **Seventh:** Sainz Jr (Williams), Stroll (Aston Martin). **Eighth:** Huelkenberg (Audi), Bearman (Haas). **Ninth:** Ocon (Haas), Albon (Williams). **10th:** Bottas (Cadillac), Perez (Cadillac). **11th:** Colapinto (Alpine), Lindblad (Racing Bulls).
(Hadjar qualified third but took a five-place grid penalty.)

Belgium sinks Turkiye

PARIS: Kevin De Bruyne scored twice as Belgium beat Turkiye 3-0, while France was held 1-1 by Italy in the Nations League on Friday.

The results: League A: Group 1: Belgium 3 (De Bruyne 10, 60, Lukaku 76) bt Turkiye 0; France 1 (Olise 55) drew with Italy 1 (Bastoni 68).

It's U.P. vs. Rajasthan

VIJAYAWADA: Defending champion Uttar Pradesh will face Rajasthan in the boys' final while Maharashtra and Tamil Nadu made the girls' title round of the 51st sub-junior National basketball championship.

The results (semifinals): Boys: Uttar Pradesh 63 (Sahil Kumar 15, Vanish Tomar 12) bt Maharashtra 55 (Mayank Sharma 16).
Rajasthan 82 (Harsh Vardhan 34, Robin Dhnaka 13) bt Haryana 47 (Kesav Kaushik 11).
Girls: Maharashtra 71 (Netra Damke 17, Anika Naik 10) bt Karnataka 60 (Aarushi Ananth 22, Kushi Kushi 10); Tamil Nadu 73 (Leo Jafflin 17, V. Anshika 11, M. Dhanya 10) bt Uttar Pradesh 41 (Tejaswi Khana 10).

On course: Uttar Pradesh is one win away from retaining its title.

ENGAGEMENTS

Cricket: TNCA league, II div, Coromandel vs. Crombest (Murugappa); Alwarpet vs. S. Rly Inst. (S. Rly); Bunts vs. Rising Stars (A.M. Jain); Jupiter vs. MCC (Tagore); Egmore RC vs. Komaleeswarar (Vivekananda); India Pistons vs. Garnet (Venkateswara).

III-B, AG's Office vs. Prem (PBEL City); Hunters XI vs. UFCC, T. Nagar (CSK-Guru Nanak); Singam Puli vs. Triplicane SC (Magna-B); Madras Aryan Club vs. Egmore Club (Gojan-C, turf); ICF vs. TSR MSC (Gojan-B, turf); Nungambakkam CC vs. S. Rly (Magna-A), 9 a.m.

IV-B, T.I. Cycles vs. Social (Union); BRC vs. YMA (Gojan, mat); CUC vs. Kovai Knights (Omega Intl.); Triplicane CC vs. PUC (SMK Fomra-B); Jubilee vs. Comrades (Gandhi Nagar); Sir Theagaraya vs. Kumbhat (St. Patrick's).

V-D, Youngsters vs. Egmore Excelsiors (MIT), 9.30 a.m.

VI-A, St. Mary's vs. Halifaxs (Engg. College), 8 a.m.

VI-B, AISC vs. MFL (Engg. College), 1 p.m.

POORVIKA APPLIANCES

TRENDING DEALS

THINK HOME APPLIANCES... THINK POORVIKA...
BEFORE THE PRICE GOES UP... NOW IS THE RIGHT TIME TO BUY!
HOME APPLIANCE PRICES ARE EXPECTED TO INCREASE IN THE COMING DAYS.

LOWEST PRICE
4G SMARTPHONE @ ₹8,999*
5G SMARTPHONE @ ₹14,799*

Valid Date 2nd to 05th Oct 2026

Upto ₹12,000* EXCHANGE BONUS
0 DOWN PAYMENT
Upto 40 MONTH NO COST EMI
Upto 7.5%* INSTANT DISCOUNT
minimum Txn ₹15,000 Max Cashback ₹5,000
AXIS BANK kotak YES BANK HSBC FEDERAL BANK DBS scapia

GREATER TV OFFERS
Starts @ ₹5,390
55% OFF
SAMSUNG SONY LG Haier TCL YARR

32"	Starts@ ₹7,990*	47% OFF	
40"	Starts@ ₹14,990*	40% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹42*
50" 4K	Starts@ ₹23,990*	47% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹44*
55" 4K	Starts@ ₹28,990*	47% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹54*
65" 4K	Starts@ ₹42,990*	66% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹80*
75" 4K	Starts@ ₹79,990*	31% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹111*

Buy 85" Smart TV
Upto ₹15,000* Instant Discount
Get SOUNDBAR FREE Worth ₹23,990

Buy 100" Smart TV
Neo QLED
Upto ₹7,500* Instant Discount
Get SOUNDBAR FREE Worth ₹19,990

WASHING MACHINE OFFERS
LG SAMSUNG Haier IFB Whirlpool BOSCH Godrej LLOYD
Upto ₹3,500* Exchange Bonus
Starts @ ₹10,290

7.0 KG TOP LOAD	Starts@ ₹16,990*	DAILY EMI ₹47*	24% DISCOUNT
8.0 KG TOP LOAD	Starts@ ₹18,990*	DAILY EMI ₹53*	39% DISCOUNT
8.0 KG FRONT LOAD	Starts@ ₹29,990*	42% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹56*
9.0 KG FRONT LOAD	Starts@ ₹38,990*	43% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹54*

COOLEST AC OFFERS
LG VOLTAS BLUE STAR DAIKIN SAMSUNG GENERAL Haier Godrej LLOYD
Starts @ ₹24,990 | 52% OFF
DAILY EMI ₹69*

1.42 TON 3 STAR	Starts@ ₹30,990*	26% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹57*	
1.42 TON 5 STAR	Starts@ ₹37,990*	31% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹70*	
2 TON 3 STAR	Starts@ ₹40,990*	32% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹76*	

REFRIGERATOR DEALS
LG SAMSUNG BOSCH Haier Whirlpool Godrej IFB
1 RUPEES DOWN PAYMENT
Starts @ ₹9,490
Upto ₹3,000* Exchange Bonus

183 L SINGLE DOOR	Starts@ ₹11,990*	29% OFF	
190 L SINGLE DOOR	Starts@ ₹13,990*	35% OFF	
216 L DOUBLE DOOR	Starts@ ₹20,990*	27% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹58*
310 L DOUBLE DOOR	Starts@ ₹31,990*	40% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹59*
596 L SIDE BY SIDE	Starts@ ₹61,990*	46% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹86*
650 L SIDE BY SIDE	Starts@ ₹74,990*	44% OFF	DAILY EMI ₹104*

LAPTOP
Starts @ ₹39,990*
Buy laptop pay ₹999 get 4 in 1 gaming combo kit worth ₹7999
ASUS SAMSUNG Lenovo DELL hp acer

Macbook Neo
₹7,000* EXCHANGE BONUS OR 24 Month EMI

instax FUJIFILM
Starts @ ₹6,999*

MONITORS
SAMSUNG Lenovo BenQ
Starts @ ₹6,699*

PRINTER
hp EPSON Canon
Starts @ ₹2,499*

Google pixel 11 5G (12GB+256 GB)
₹89,999 Poorvika Price ₹82,xxx*
upto 80% Discount on Soundbar worth ₹19,999

SAMSUNG Galaxy z Fold 8 Ultra 5G (256 GB)
₹1,99,999 Poorvika Price ₹1,87,xxx*
24 Month No Cost EMI

oppo F33 Pro 5G (8+128 GB)
₹39,999 Poorvika Price ₹38,xxx*
upto 75% Discount on Smartwatch worth ₹6,499

iphone 17 (256 GB)
LIMITED STOCK
₹82,900 Effective Price ₹57,900*

iphone 18 Pro (256 GB)
₹1,64,900 Effective Price ₹1,26,900
Per day EMI ₹305*
18 Month No Cost EMI

vivo S2 5G (8GB +128GB)
₹42,999 Poorvika Price ₹39,xxx*
upto 80% Discount on Bluetooth Speaker worth ₹4,999

Including Exchange Device, Exchange Bonus*

WATER PURIFIER
Offer Price ₹17,990 ₹8,499*

WET GRINDER
Offer Price ₹6,499 ₹4,100*

GAS STOVE
Offer Price ₹3,695 ₹2,799

AIR FRYER
Offer Price ₹6,500 ₹2,299*

FAN
Offer Price ₹3,720 ₹2,490*

WATER HEATER
Offer Price ₹5,160 ₹4150

AIR COOLER
Offer Price ₹7,990 ₹4,999*

BUY SMARTPHONE | TABLET & GET
NECKBAND ₹199 SMARTWATCH ₹899
TRUE WIRELESS ₹499 BT SPEAKER ₹899
PERSONAL FAN ₹499 SOUNDBAR ₹3,999
HEADPHONE ₹799

Watch Series 12 GPS Aluminium Case
₹56,900 (Effective Price) ₹47,900*
*Including exchange bonus & bank cashback

AirPods 5 With Charging Case
₹14,900 (Effective Price) ₹13,400*
*Including bank cashback

JBL Partybox Stage 320 240W Wireless Speaker
₹54,999 ₹44,999*

NOTHING (R) Watch Pro 2 Smartwatch
₹5,999 ₹4,999*

boAt Boat Aavante Aura Plus 2.1Ch 160W Soundbar
70% OFF
₹21,999 ₹5,999*

*T&C Apply. Offer Applicable for Selected brand & Model

EASY EMI
BAJAJ FINANCE IDFC FIRST Bank HDB FINANCIAL SERVICES TVS CREDIT ICICI Bank Pine Labs paytm
*EMI OPTIONS AVAILABLE ON SELECTED SHOWROOM ONLY
SCAN QR CODE
Customer Helpline : 99406 88855
Shop online @ www.poorvika.com
POORVIKA APPLIANCES

T&C apply ; * effective price including exchange bonus and bank offer

Above the bazaar: An aerial view of the Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose Market, the bustling wholesale market in the heart of Vellore.

Old ground: Vegetable stalls occupy the site that once served as a stable where horses from the Vellore Fort were tethered.

Time stands: The oblong-shaped eastern entrance is marked by a clock tower installed in 1911.

Lighting up: G. Arumugam, a third-generation trader, rents out lanterns at Lang Bazaar, continuing a family business that has survived for generations.

The old world within a busy market

Vellore's wholesale market, established in 1868, has grown from 200 shops to more than 700 permanent and 300 temporary shops; alongside its bustling trade, old businesses continue to survive

C. Venkatachalapathy
venkatachalapathy.c
@thehindu.co.in

The wholesale market in Vellore district is always bustling. Vehicles honk as they make their way through the narrow lanes, while people navigate the crowded paths lined with vendors selling vegetables, fruits, and other essential commodities. Yet, within the crowded market are shops that seem to belong to a bygone era.

A watch repairman continues his work in the heart of the city. A gas lantern seller has his wares on display. A harmonium repairman tends to musical instruments, while an old tailor works in a shop surrounded by vegetable sellers. Some of these traders have been doing business here for generations, carrying on trades that have survived alongside the changing market.

The market itself dates back to the 19th century. It was established in 1868, two years after the Vellore Municipality was formed, right in front of the 16th-century Vellore Fort.

The site had earlier served as a stable, where horses from the fort were tethered, according to historians. After the municipality was established in 1866, the market opened with no less than 200 shops.

Over the years, it grew in popularity, attracting traders and customers from across the region. Fruits, vegetables, millet varieties, flowers and greens arrive here in bulk from neighbouring States such as Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh and Maharashtra, before being dispatched to various destinations. Today, the market has more than 700 permanent shops and 300 temporary shops. It remains a lifeline for many, serving the everyday needs of the city.

Where old meets new

Its history is also visible in the structures that remain. A clock tower, installed in 1911 to commemorate the coronation of King George V and Queen Mary in Delhi, now serves as one of the main entrances to the market.

The eastern gate has another historical marker. Its foundation stone was laid on April 6, 1914, by the then British Collector Marjoribanks Esquire and Municipal Council chairman Khan Bahadur Habibullah Sahib. An inscription on the clock tower records that 277 men from the village went to fight in the First World War between 1914 and 1919, and that 14 of them died in battle.

Named after freedom fighter Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose by office-bearers of the Vellore Town Vegetable Merchants Association, the market has an oblong-shaped main entrance facing east, with 16 entrances on all four sides.

While the market has adapted into the modern era with ease, slices of an older Vellore can be seen at odd corners, basking in nostalgia.

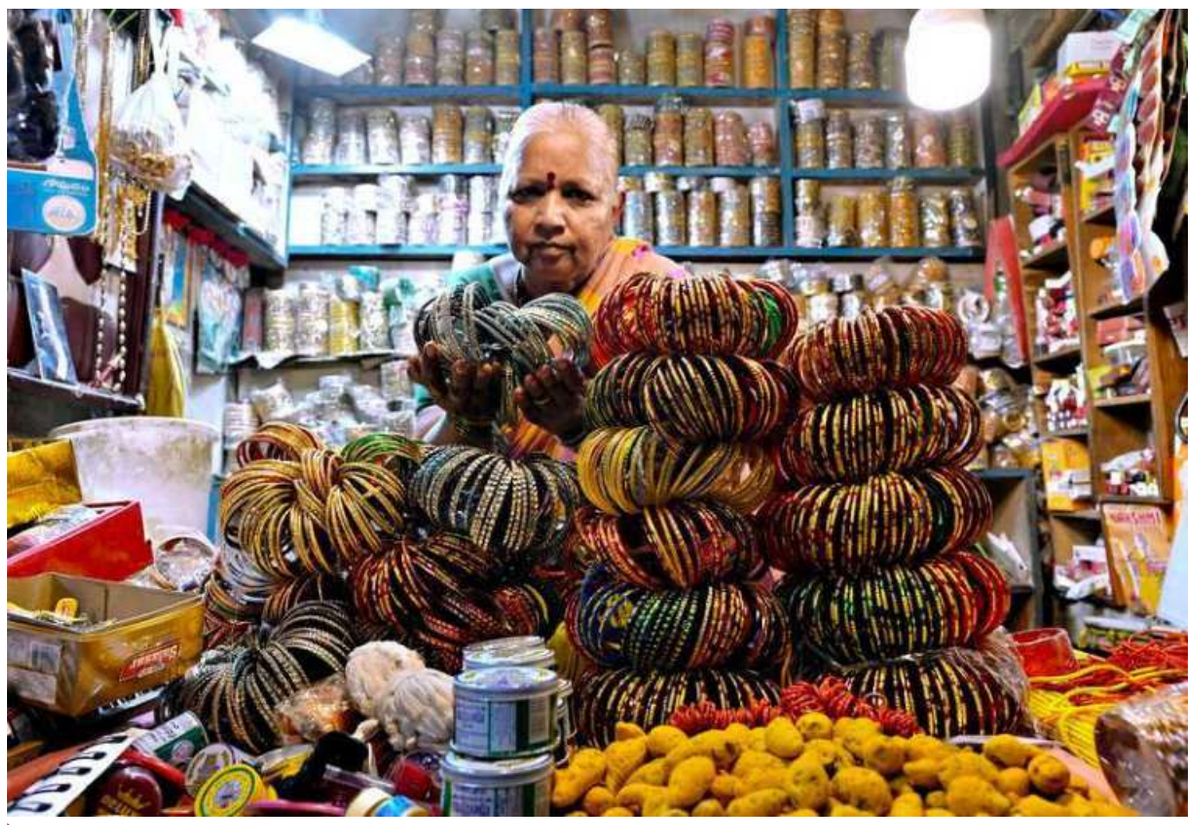
Brief respite: A worker takes a nap as his colleagues unload sacks of onions at the market.

Before dawn: Labourers carry boxes of flowers to shops in the middle of the night. The blossoms will have to be displayed for sale at dawn.

A floral rush: The flower market comes alive as traders and workers sort, carry and move produce through the night.

Years in thread: At 91, S. Arunachalam continues to work as a tailor in the market, his shop surrounded by vegetable traders.

Getting the notes right: Third-generation trader D. Srinivasan repairs musical instruments at Bharat Musical Mart in Lang Bazaar.



Little essentials: Glass bangles, turmeric, kumkum and sacred threads fill a shop serving the everyday needs of the market's customers. The shop is popular with women and children.

Traces of time: Second-generation watchmaker R. Karunakaran works at Samy & Sons Watch Service Centre, a business that began on Gandhi Road in 1958 before moving to the market.